

The Fellowship of the Green Book

A Campaign for Starting Adventurers in North-western Eriador



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Ian Clarke
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Introduction

The Fellowship of the Green Book contains five adventures that are intended to be used as an initial campaign for a group of starting adventurers, using Free League's *The One Ring* Second Edition rules. These adventures directly reference material from *The One Ring* (especially Chapter 9, The World), together with details in *The One Ring Starter Set*, so you would need to own both to use this module effectively.

This module also contains hooks that link to other works published by Free League, *Ruins of the Lost Realm* and *Tales from the Lone Lands*. It is not necessary to own these works and references to them can be ignored, but the intention is that they can be used to lead the Player-heroes into wider adventures across Eriador.

Overview

The adventures in this module are intended to be played in the order they are set out.

- *The Inheritance* provides a reason for the Player-heroes to join together and involves travel across the breadth and depth of the Shire, before ending up in Bree.
- *Into the Woods* leads the companions through the Barrow Downs and into the Old Forest in search of an ancient treasure.
- *Library Looting* and *Firework Theft* both find the company being tasked with retrieving some stolen goods.
- Finally, *The Prodigal Daughter* sets the company off on a quest to find the long-lost relative of an acquaintance, who can help them to find a great treasure!

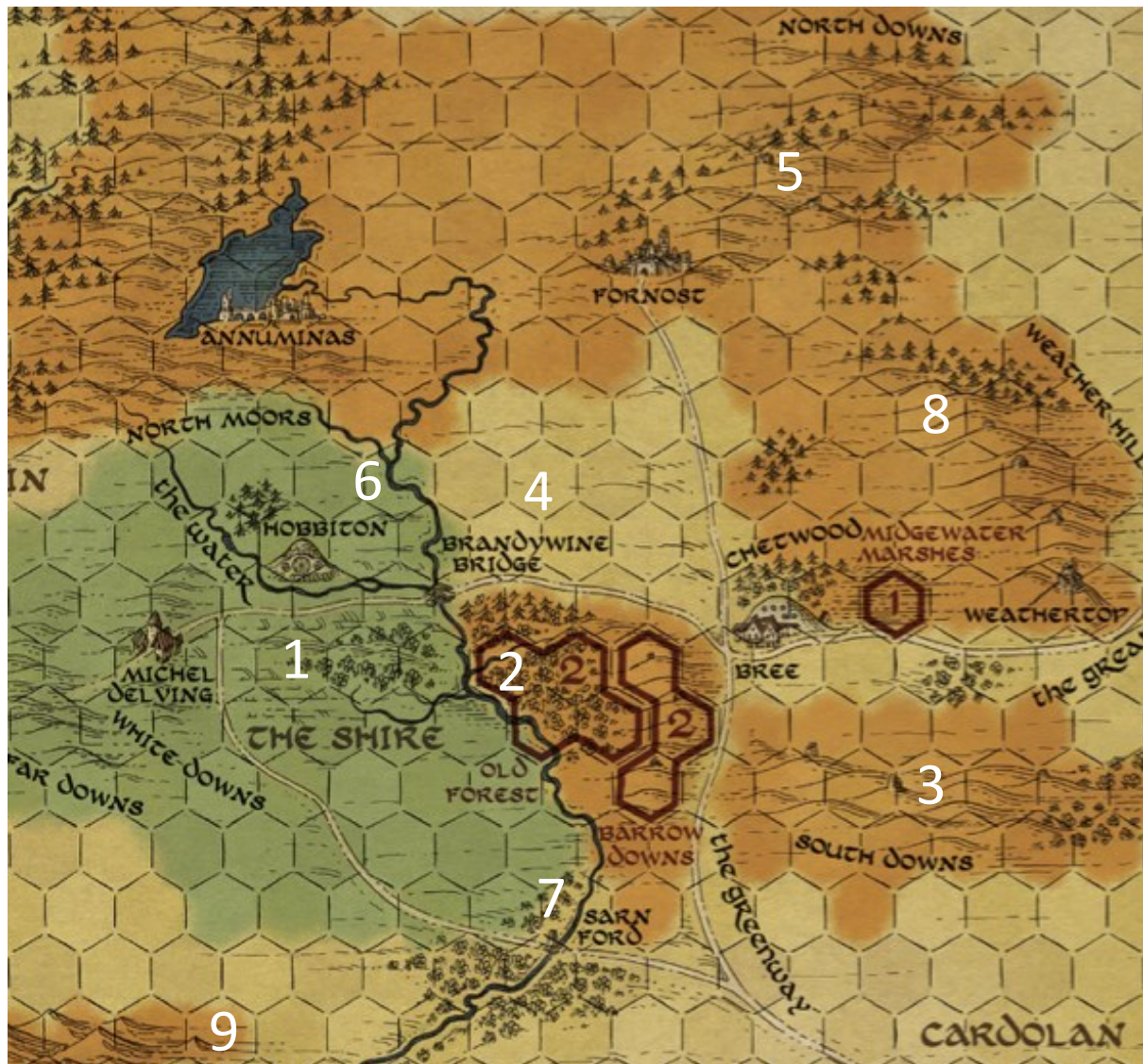
The campaign starts in the year 2965, the default start date for *The One Ring* (Second Edition). It is recommended that the first three adventures are played back-to-back and at the rate recommended in the core rules, the schedule would be as follows:

- Late Spring / early Summer 2965 – *The Inheritance*
- Late Summer 2965 – *Into the Woods*
- Autumn 2965 – *Library Looting*

The final two adventures can continue directly from the third adventure, taking place in the late spring and autumn of 2966. Alternatively, they could be interspersed with one or two other adventures inspired by content in *The One Ring*, *Ruins of the Lost Realm* or *Tales from the Lone Lands*. The suggested schedule could proceed as follows:

- Spring 2966 – additional adventure
- Summer 2966 – *Firework Theft*
- Autumn 2966 – *The Prodigal Daughter* or another additional adventure
- Early 2967 (Winter) – *The Prodigal Daughter*, if an additional adventure was played the previous autumn.

The map below shows where the adventures are located, together with the locations of some recommended potential additional adventures.



1. The Inheritance
2. Into the Woods
3. Library Looting
4. Firework Theft
5. The Prodigal Daughter
6. "Mines of Brokenbores": Adventure by Ryan of the North
7. "Tindailin – An Elven Refuge": Landmark from *Ruins of the Lost Realm*
8. "A Troll-hole, If Ever There Was One": Adventure from *Tales from the Lone Lands*
9. "Star of the Mist": Landmark from *The One Ring*

The Loremaster should feel free to swap any of the suggested optional adventures for others. For example, if someone in the party is keen to obtain an Archet Hunting Bow, a short adventure could be added in pursuit of this goal. Be wary of having more than four

adventures in a year, as Yule Fellowship Phases are important milestones for the development and advancement of Player-heroes.

The Shadow of the Past

A key conceit of this campaign is that each of the Player-heroes is the heir of a deceased member of a previous company of adventurers. The players can build this into their characters' back-stories in whatever way they see fit, but none of them will know much about these previous adventures – their relatives didn't like to talk about their younger, wild days.

During the course of the campaign, the players will learn more of some of these previous events. Inspiration for these has been taken from the adventures in the *Bree* book for the One Ring First Edition. This builds on the links already contained in Chapter 9 of *The One Ring* as a number of characters, including Cole Pickthorne, Oswald Brecker and Fitch Talltree's father, all first appear in the *Bree* book.

The original company included a Shire-hobbit called Tobias Goldworthy, a man from Eskerdale called Oswin, a woman from Bree called Becky Treare and the other forebears of the Player-heroes. The following timeline describes some key events in their lives.

Year	Events
2898	Oswald Brecker is born.
2900	Emma Foxglow is born.
2912	The Fell Winter. Floods in the following spring sweep away the bridge at Tharbad.
2913	Gorlanc, a scholar of ill-repute, starts to gather a band of treasure-hunters and thieves to loot the tombs of the Dunedain of the North.
2918	Oswin of Eskerdale is born.
2919	Oswald Brecker and Emma Foxglow are married.
2920	The Rangers drive Gorlanc and his band out of Eriador. Caty Brecker is born.
2938	Tobias, Oswin, Becky and the rest of the company meet in Bree. They are encouraged to seek adventure to the south by Gandalf and head off down the Greenway to Tharbad and then to Lond Daer. Becky and Oswin fall in love.

Year	Events
2941	After three years away, the company returns to Bree. They hear that Gandalf has headed east with a party of Dwarves and decide to investigate the rumour of a barrow that has been left open on the Barrow Downs. Becky's mother hears of her daughter's return and ventures into the Barrow Downs to try to dissuade her daughter from entering a barrow. But Becky's mother is killed by a Barrow Wight herself, not knowing that her daughter and the others had already been saved by Tom Bombadil. Becky is stricken by grief and guilt. She leaves the company but cannot face returning home, so Oswin takes her back to Eskerdale where they are married.
2942	The rest of the company hears the news of the death of Smaug and decide to seek their fortune in Wilderland.
2943	Oswin becomes Chieftain of Eskerdale.
2949	The company returns to Bree in the autumn, in the company of Balin and Gandalf.
2950	Gorlanc re-enters Eriador. The company is involved in the events of the adventure "Old Bones and Skin" (from the <i>Bree</i> module).
2951	The company is involved in the events of the adventure "Strange Men, Strange Roads" (from the <i>Bree</i> module). In the winter, Rangers and Elves from Rivendell break the power of Gorlanc, but he escapes capture.
2952	The company is involved in the events of the adventure "Holed Up in Staddle" (from the <i>Bree</i> module). They are responsible for the final defeat of Gorlanc and decide to retire from adventuring.

Sabian, the Recurring Antagonist

A main antagonist for the companions in this campaign will be Sabian, the spy mentioned in the Star of the Mist Landmark in *The One Ring* Rulebook. However, this campaign makes one significant change – Sabian is spying for Saruman, not the men from Umbar. Saruman has not completely fallen under the Shadow yet and his minions will act accordingly.

Sabian has set up a base (at the Star of the Mist Landmark) to keep an eye on the southern borders of the Shire for Saruman. He has a standing brief to also obtain any information pertaining to magic rings. Sabian is intelligent and will employ stealth and larceny to achieve his goals in preference to direct violent conflict – at least in the more civilised environs of the Shire and Bree-land, where brute force would draw far too much unwanted attention.

In the earlier adventures, the presence of Sabian will be no more than a shadow in the background. The Player-heroes will become more aware of him as the campaign progresses. From Sabian's point-of-view, the Player-heroes will likely thwart his plans on a number of occasions, fostering a hatred for them within him as Saruman perceives his failures. He will become more desperate to get back into Saruman's good books as the campaign progresses. This will eventually lead to direct confrontation in one or two of the later adventures. So, try to keep him alive until then!

Sabian, Spy for Saruman

Cunning, Hardened, Secretive

ATTRIBUTE LEVEL

ENDURANCE

16

MIGHT

1

RESOLVE

4

PARRY

+1

ARMOUR

2

COMBAT PROFICIENCIES: Short Sword 3 (3/16, Pierce)

Axe 2 (5/18, Break Shield)

FELL ABILITIES: *Fierce Folk.* Spend 1 Resolve point to *gain (1d)* and make the attack roll *Favoured*.

Hatred (the Player-heroes). When targeting any Player-heroes, all attacks are *Favoured*.
Only after the adventure *Library Looting*.

Session Zero Considerations

It is common for campaigns to begin with an initial session where players create their characters and make decisions about the initial formation of their fellowship. As this module is specifically designed for starting a campaign, there are some things that need to be considered.

Cultures

It should be possible to use a character from any of the officially designed Cultures. The players just need to think of a reason that their forebear was a member of Tobias Goldworthy's company. This should be easy for any of the Cultures listed in *The One Ring*, who's forebears could have been founding members with Tobias. For a Hobbit Player-hero, they could be a direct relative of Tobias himself.

If a player wants to use a Culture from *Peoples of Wilderland*, then perhaps their forebear joined the company later, when they were travelling in that region. The important thing is that there is no lore, mechanical or other reason why any Culture should be excluded from these adventures.

Starting Gear

The Loremaster should make a note of one of the initial Useful Items chosen by each Player-hero. They will need this information at the beginning of the first adventure.

Patron

It should be possible for the players to choose any of the starting Patrons listed on page 52 of *The One Ring*, depending on the Cultures chosen by them for their characters. For example, it would probably not really be plausible to have Cirdan as a patron if the Company does not include any Elves.

The choice of most Patrons can be explained by assuming they were also previously a Patron of Tobias' company, so have taken an interest in the Player-heroes. If the players want to choose Tom Bombadil and Lady Goldberry, then the first adventure can introduce them (don't allow the Patron benefits until they have met).

Safe Haven

The initial Safe Haven for the Company will be Bree.

The Inheritance

In a hole in the ground there lived a Hobbit. This was a comfortable hole, and the Hobbit was a retired adventurer, but he was not the infamous Mr Bilbo Baggins. The burglary career of Mr Tobias Goldworthy was far longer than the famed Mr Baggins, if less successful in purely financial terms. His exploits were also far less well-known, and he was all the more respectable for it.

Now Mr Goldworthy has passed away at the relatively young age (for a Hobbit) of 80, and he may be about to become far better known than he ever was in his lifetime. There are rumours of a memoir that he was writing, with tales of adventures involving trolls, wizards, and a magic ring, no less!

Part 1: Grubb, Grubb and Burrowes

It is a fine spring morning in the bustling town of Michel Delving, which passes for the capital of the Shire. An unusual collection of diverse individuals (the Player-heroes) finds themselves waiting in the reception room of the offices of Messrs Grubb, Grubb and Burrowes. Each of them is holding an identical letter.

*Messrs Grubb, Grubb and Burrowes,
3 High Street,
Michel Delving,
West Farthing,
The Shire*

Dear ...

I regret to inform you of the passing of Mr Tobias Goldworthy, late of Pincup, South Farthing. As the appointed executor of his affairs and in accordance with his wishes, I write to request your attendance at the reading of his Will. Please present yourself at my office at 10 o'clock on the morning of 10th May 1365 S.R.

Your Humble Servant,

*Griffo Grubb,
Senior Partner*

The Reading of the Will

At precisely the appointed time, as the clock in the office chimes ten, the door to the office of Griffo Grubb opens and he beckons the Player-heroes in. He sits down behind a large desk and invites the Player-heroes to take a seat. Then he asks each of them in turn to confirm who they are.

After these introductions, Mr Grubb will begin to read out Tobias Goldworthy's Last Will and Testament. Each of the Player-heroes is a named beneficiary and Mr Grubb will hand them a small item that they have been left (these are the items that the Loremaster made a note of during character creation in Session Zero).

Mr Grubb now says that there is an additional clause in the Will, which applies to all of the Player-heroes. They will each inherit 10 Treasure (the equivalent of a Marvellous Hoard) if they deliver The Green Book of the Southfarthing to Oswald Brecker of Coombe in Bree-land. He explains that the book was the memoir of Tobias, and that the Player-heroes will need to find it in his home in Pincup. The smial has been locked up since Tobias' death and the key is held by Folco Noakes, one of the Shirrifs of the Southfarthing. Folco regularly frequents the Sparrow's Nest.

Mr Grubb gives the Company a Letter of Introduction to Folco and another to Oswald Brecker. He explains that they need to get Mr Brecker to sign his letter, as confirmation of receipt of the book. Then, the letter should be returned to him, so that he can arrange for the funds to be released to them.

Now, Mr Grubb asks the Player-heroes if they have any questions. Some questions that may occur to the Player-heroes follow. A *COURTESY* Skill roll should be made for each question, and if a *Tengwar* is obtained on a successful roll it may be spent to gain Insight (without having to make a separate *INSIGHT* Skill roll).

How did Tobias die? – The simple answer is that he died of old age. If the *COURTESY* roll was successful, Mr Grubb will tell them that there was nothing suspicious.

A successful *INSIGHT* roll will indicate that Mr Grubb is not trying to hide anything.

What is in the Green Book? – Mr Grubb will say that it was well-known that Tobias had been writing his memoirs for several years, but that he had not let anyone read it while he was still working on it. If the *COURTESY* roll was successful, Mr Grubb will say that it was rumoured that the Tobias had almost finished when he died.

A successful *INSIGHT* roll will indicate that Mr Grubb suspects that Tobias had reasons for not sharing his memoirs during his lifetime. A Great Success, or a successful follow-on *PERSUADE* roll will reveal that Mr Grubb thinks it must contain details that would damage Tobias' reputation in the Shire. On a failed *PERSUADE* roll, Mr Grubb will say "I'm sorry, but I do not wish to speak ill of the dead."

Where is the Sparrow's Nest? – Mr Grubb will provide the Player-heroes with directions to the Sparrow's Nest, an Inn in the Southfarthing that is frequented by pipe-weed merchants from all quarters of the Shire and beyond. If the *COURTESY* roll was successful, Mr Grubb will also recommend that the Player-heroes try the strawberries and cream.

A successful *INSIGHT* roll will indicate that Mr Grubb is not trying to hide anything.

Who is Oswald Breeker? – Mr Grubb will tell the Player-heroes that Oswald Breeker is a wealthy landowner in the village of Coombe. Tobias must have become acquainted with Mr Breeker “when he was on his travels.” If the **COURTESY** roll was successful, Mr Grubb will also warn the Player-heroes that Oswald Breeker has a reputation for being cantankerous.

A successful **INSIGHT** roll will indicate that Mr Grubb does not appear to know anything more, but a Great Success will reveal that he does think it is strange that Tobias left the book to a man.

To the Sparrow’s Nest

The Sparrow’s Nest is about 40 miles from Michel Delving and the journey will take two days. This is not a major journey and the rules for Hobbit Walks on page 10 of *The Shire* supplement from the Starter Set can be used. One roll is required, checking for Fatigue on the ‘Summer and Spring’ column. Each Player-hero may make a **TRAVEL** roll to reduce any Fatigue gained and may further reduce Fatigue by the Vigour of their mount if they have one.

As the Company approaches the Sparrow’s Nest in the late afternoon, they can see what appears to be a small, crumbling watchtower. However, as they get closer it becomes clear that only the upper stories of the watchtower are in disrepair – the ground floor is well-maintained and has been extended using some of the stonework from the higher parts of the tower. The chatter of small birds can be heard all around and they can be seen flying in and out of the eaves of the tower. Above the door hangs a sign displaying a nest with two small birds perched on it.

When the Player-heroes enter they will be greeted by the proprietor, by the name of Bungo Brownlock, “Good evening, masters, and what may you be wanting?” Mr Brownlock can provide the company with food, drink and a room for the night – he even has some man-sized rooms in the old tower wing. If the Player-heroes ask for Folko Noakes, Brownlock will reply “He isn’t here right now, but he’ll be in later no doubt. Why don’t you have a bite to eat and then join everyone in the common room for a pint while you wait?”

Anyone who takes Mr Grubb’s advice (or asks for the special) and tries the strawberries and cream is in for a treat. The strawberries are in season and the first time anyone tries the dish at the Sparrow’s Nest, they regain 1 point of Hope.

The common room is busy this evening and the air is already hazy with pipe-weed smoke. There are several groups of Hobbits, and a man is sat at a table with two Hobbits. There are also two men sitting in a corner, smoking their pipes and nursing their drinks. If the Player-heroes ask Brownlock, he will say that the men are pipe-weed merchants from the south. There are also pipe-weed merchants from the Westfarthing and the Northfarthing in, as well as the usual locals, so he’s rather busy this evening!

The main topic of conversation on this evening centres around a Hobbit by the name of Bosco Rumble. He is telling his friends about his recent experiences down near Sarn Ford, after seeing some customers back to the borders of the Shire.

"I tell you, as soon as I was on me own this badger bounded out of the bushes and reared up over me! Claws as big as a weed fork! I thought I was done for, until one of the Big Folk appeared out of nowhere, whispered something to the beast and shooed it off. I didn't get a good look at 'im – he pulled his 'ood up before you could blink. But I do remember those fierce eyes over a dark beard."

"And another thing. There was a whole flock of crows from down south watching the whole time. When the badger ran off, they lost interest and flew off themselves."

Bosco's friends seem to be quite sceptical about his account and are enjoying making jokes at his expense.

A Player-hero making a successful **AWARENESS** roll will notice that the two men in the corner seem to be paying close attention to Bosco's story. This roll will *lose (1d)*, due to these men's *Secretive* Trait.

The two men sitting in the corner are Hallas and Halbarad, the Rangers mentioned on page 28 of the *Shire* sourcebook. They are disguised as merchants from Tharbad and are not using their real names.

The other man is Sabian, who is also disguised as a merchant from the south.

After a short while, Bungo approaches the Company's table accompanied by a stout, serious-looking Hobbit and introduces him as Folco Noakes. Folco says "I hear you've been asking after me." The meeting with Folco should be run as a Council. The main goal of the Player-heroes will be to get Folco to give them the key to Tobias' home in Pincup.

Resistance: The Player-heroes are making a reasonable request, so the Resistance for this Council is 3.

Introduction: **COURTESY** is the only ability that is appropriate in this situation. Mr Grubb's letter of introduction will allow this roll to *gain (1d)*.

If the Introduction Skill roll is a failure, the Player-heroes will have a time limit equal to 3. If it is a success, the time limit will be equal to 4, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled on the Success dice.

Interaction: Folco's default attitude will be **Open**. This will improve to **Friendly** for Hobbits, or everyone if the company thought of buying Folco a half-pint during the Introduction, in which case rolls *gain (1d)*.

The most obvious skill to use is **PERSUADE**, but clever players should be able to use any of the useful skills listed on page 107 of *The One Ring*.

The following outcomes are possible:

Success: Folco hands over the key and wishes the Player-heroes a safe journey.

Success with Woe: Folco hands over the key only at the end of the evening, by which time the Player-heroes have all had a bit more to drink than they originally intended. As a result, they do not get a good night's rest and fail to recover any Fatigue.

Disaster: Folco does not trust the Player-heroes and refuses to give them the key. They must think of another way to get the key or make their way to Pincup without it.

Folco Noakes

Folco is one of the three Shirrifs responsible for the Southfarthing.

NAME: Folco Noakes

OCCUPATION: Shirrif

TRAITS: Keen-eyed, Rustic

A Player-hero making a successful **AWARENESS** roll during or immediately after the Council will notice that the two men in the corner and the man with the Hobbits seem to be trying to hear what is being discussed. This roll will *lose (1d)*, due to these men's *Secretive* Trait.

The following morning the Player-heroes awake, having recovered 1 point of Fatigue unless they drank too much the previous evening. Hopefully they now have the key in their possession. If they don't have the key, they have several options.

The Company may decide to steal the key from Folco. This would not count as a Misdeed for gaining Shadow, as the Player-heroes are entitled to the key. However, even if the theft is initially undetected, Folco will eventually notice the key is missing and suspicion will fall on the Player-heroes, lowering their reputation in the Shire. If the attempt to steal the key fails, their reputation will spread more quickly.

The Company could go back to Mr Grubb or write to him (there is an excellent postal service in the Shire). If Mr Grubb speaks to Folco directly, he will hand over the key. This will delay the Player-heroes for several days, but they are in no real hurry.

Finally, the Company could just set off for Pincup without the key, in which case proceed directly to Part 2.

Part 2: Pilfered Paperwork in Pincup

The journey by road from the Sparrow's Nest to Pincup is about 54 miles and would normally take 3 days, with a stay in Longbottom on the first night. Cutting across country could reduce the distance significantly and take only 2 days, but this would require a successful **EXPLORE** skill test.

If travelling by road, or if cutting across country and the **EXPLORE** skill test was a failure, roll twice for Events on the Hobbit Walks table on page 10 of *The Shire*, checking the 'Summer and Spring' column for Fatigue points gained. If cutting across country and the **EXPLORE** skill test was a success, then only one roll is required. Subtract 1 from the total Fatigue gained if travelling by road, due to the comfortable overnight stay in Longbottom. Each Player-hero may then make a **TRAVEL** roll to reduce any Fatigue gained and may further reduce Fatigue by the Vigour of their mount if they have one.

A couple of hours after the Company sets out, they will notice a large crow perched in a nearby tree that is apparently watching them. An hour later they will notice another crow (or perhaps the same one) perched on a rock. This will become a common sight during the journey.

Searching the Smial

The Company will arrive in Pincup in the late afternoon. An old gaffer tending his garden will point them in the direction of Tobias' smial. As they approach, a murmuration of crebain will settle in the eaves of the trees at the edge of the nearby Woody End.

The home of the late Tobias Goldworthy is a comfortably sized (for a Hobbit) smial. Not nearly as substantial as Brandy Hall or the Great Smials in Tuckborough, or even as large as Bag End, it is still the grandest property in Pincup. It is built into a hillside close to the edge of the woods of Woody End.

As the Player-heroes walk up the garden path towards the front door, they will notice that it is slightly ajar. A successful **SCAN** test will reveal that the door has been forced, using something like a crowbar. Anyone searching around outside for clues with a successful **HUNTING** roll will find some footprints, and a Great Success will reveal that they were all left by one man. Anyone succeeding an **AWARENESS** test will sense that they are being watched by the crebain roosting nearby.

Venturing inside, it soon becomes clear that the library has been ransacked. A thorough search of the room will confirm that the Green Book of the Southfarthing is not there. A Player-hero making a successful **SCAN** test will notice that most of the books strewn across the floor have green covers, while many still on the shelves don't. A successful **RIDDLE** test will allow a Player-hero to deduce that no books are actually missing from the library, as there is no space left on the shelves when all the books are put back.

The study has also been worked over. The draws of Tobias' writing desk are all open and various papers are scattered everywhere. A successful RIDDLE test will allow a Player-hero to deduce that the research notes for the book are missing.

Allow each Player-hero to be involved up to once in a roll for each of the skill tests to search Tobias' home. This can be either to make the skill roll themselves, or to assist another Player-hero by spending a point of Hope.

Most of the other rooms are relatively undisturbed, although the chest-of-drawers in the master bedroom has clearly been searched. The Player-heroes will notice an opened letter on the mantelpiece of the Morning Room:

*5 Puddle Lane,
Nobottle,
West Farthing,
The Shire*

8th March 1365

Dear Tobias

Thank you for sending your book, which I enjoyed reading very much. I checked the family trees carefully, as you requested, and couldn't find any errors for our side of the family. I've sent the book on now, as you asked.

My job is keeping me busy, but not as much as my fellow Bounders in the Northfarthing, who seem to have a new story to tell each week. I'll be taking a walk to Needlehole this afternoon, so I expect I'll hear another one by tomorrow.

I look forward to seeing you at the Free Fair this summer. You can tell me more tales of your adventures over a drink or two!

Your Loving Cousin,

Hamson

P.S. Don't forget to bring your golf clubs this time.

Hopefully, by now the Player-heroes should have pieced together what has happened. A man has broken into Tobias' home, searching for the Green Book of the Southfarthing. He didn't find the book because Tobias sent it to a relative (perhaps for proof-reading), but he stole the research notes. The book has now been sent on to another unknown person.

By now it will be getting late. Pincup is a small village with no Inn, but there is enough room in Tobias' home for Player-heroes (although the beds are a bit small for anyone taller than a Dwarf). Staying here will count as a Prolonged Rest, but due to the break-in and the sense

that they are being watched from the nearby woods, the Player-heroes will not feel safe and secure enough to recover any Fatigue.

Next Steps

The Company will need to decide what their next course of action should be, either that evening or over breakfast the following morning. Some possible options follow but be prepared for the players to come up with another idea entirely.

Head Directly to Nobottle

The Company may decide to head straight to Nobottle, to call on Hamson. They can set out north until they reach the Stock Road, then follow the road to Bywater the next evening. There, they can stay at the Green Dragon Inn and the Loremaster can roll on the Inn Gossip Table page 14 of *The Shire* for rumours or events that evening.

From there, they could either head to Nobottle by passing through Hobbiton and following the Bywater Road, or take the East Road as far as Waymeet, before taking the road towards Little Delving. This journey would require 1 roll for Events on the Hobbit Walks table on page 10 of *The Shire*, checking the 'Summer and Spring' column for Fatigue points gained.

Report the Break-in

The Company may think that they should report the break-in to the authorities. This would mean finding a Shirrif, so going back to the Sparrow's Nest to talk to Folco would be the obvious course of action. The journey can be run in the same way as the journey from the Sparrow's Nest to Pincup, except cutting across country would not require an **EXPLORE** roll if this was passed on the previous journey.

Unless the Player-heroes are all Hobbits, Folco will be suspicious and ask them to accompany him back to Pincup. If he did not give them the key, he will be very suspicious and tell them to stay at the Sparrow's Nest until he returns after making his own enquiries. In either case, if the Player-heroes do not comply then news will quickly spread across the Shire that they are troublemakers, which will impose a minor complication on all interaction skill tests, which will *lose (1d)*.

If the Company was originally given the key and does accompany Folco back to Pincup, his investigations will quickly confirm their story and their reputation in the Shire will not be affected.

Who is Hamson?

The Company may wish to find out more about Hamson before they meet him. His full name is Hamson Smallburrow. He is a Bounder for the Westfarthing who lives in Nobottle and is a cousin of Tobias. There are several ways that the Player-heroes could find this out. A simple search of the study will reveal more correspondence between Hamson and Tobias that confirms Hamson's surname. There is also a book on family genealogy in the library that can be found and understood with a

successful **LORE** roll. Hobbit characters will also know that the Mathom House in Michel Delving contains comprehensive records of Hobbit family trees.

A direct journey to Michel Delving that does not retrace the steps of their travels so far would require 1 or 2 rolls for Events on the Hobbit Walks table on page 10 of *The Shire*, checking the 'Summer and Spring' column for Fatigue points gained. When the Player-heroes have arrived in Michel Delving, if they don't include any Hobbits in their number, they will have to convince Malva Slowfoot, the custodian of the Mathom House, to let them check the records. This would require a successful **PERSUADE** or **RIDDLE** roll. Checking the records themselves would require a day of research and a successful **LORE** roll.

Finally, they could just ask around. At any Inn in the Westfarthing, someone will have something to say about him.

"Old Hamson Smallburrow? Yes, he's a decent enough chap, considering he lives in Nobottle. Getting a bit long in the tooth for a Bounder, mind!"

Whatever they decide, the Company should eventually find themselves in Nobottle. Make a note of how many days the journey takes. If the Player-heroes did not report the break-in to the authorities, or if they did but they did not manage to avoid being considered troublemakers, then their reputation will spread across the Shire:

- They will be considered to be troublemakers everywhere in the Southfarthing 1 week after they arrived in Pincup.
- They will be considered to be troublemakers everywhere in the Westfarthing 2 weeks after they arrived in Pincup.
- They will be considered to be troublemakers everywhere else in the Shire and Buckland 3 weeks after they arrived in Pincup.

When recognised as troublemakers in an area, this will impose a minor complication on all interaction skill tests, which will *lose (1d)*, until the Player-heroes can restore their reputation.

Part 3: The Stubbornness of Dwarves

Nobottle is a tiny village with just one street, so the Player-heroes will have no trouble finding 5 Puddle Lane. They will get some suspicious looks from the locals, even if they are not officially recognised as troublemakers, but are greeted by a smile when their knock on the door is answered. The open, friendly face belongs to Hamson's wife Gilly Smallburrow, and two Hobbit children can be heard playing in the Hobbit-hole behind her. When the Player-heroes ask for Hamson, Gilly's smile will fade slightly as she replies:

"I'm sorry, he's not at home. He's been called away to help out with some trouble over at Tighfield. You can take the footpath across the fields if you're in a hurry."

Trouble in Tighfield

The footpath to Tighfield is easy to follow and takes between two and three hours to walk. If they haven't already, Player-heroes should make a **TRAVEL** skill test to reduce Fatigue gained on the journey from Pincup, not forgetting to add their mount's Vigour rating to the reduction.

When they arrive in Tighfield, the Player-heroes find the place in uproar. The events outlined in the 'Theft at the Rope Factory' section on pages 13 to 15 of *The Shire* have begun. Ergi Broadbeam and his two fellow Dwarves are barricaded inside Birba Muggins' farmhouse on the edge of the village. An angry mob led by Andy Roper is outside, being egged on by Birba and her son, Bobbin. The two sides are currently being kept apart by Hamson Smallburrow and a couple of other Bounders.

The initial meeting with Hamson should be run as a Council. The main goal of the Player-heroes will be to get Hamson to tell them where he sent the Green Book.

Resistance: Hamson is currently rather busy with more important matters, making this a bold request with a Resistance of 6.

Introduction: **COURTESY** is the obvious choice, but in the situation the Player-heroes could use **AWE** to impress Hamson.

If the Introduction Skill roll is a failure, the Player-heroes will have a time limit equal to 3. If it is a success, the time limit will be equal to 4, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled on the Success dice.

Interaction: Hamson's default attitude will be **Open**. This will improve to **Friendly** for Hobbits, allowing them *gain (1d)* on all rolls. However, if the Player-heroes have a reputation as troublemakers, his attitude will be **Reluctant** towards all of them, including any Hobbits, leading them to *lose (1d)* on all rolls.

The following outcomes are possible:

Success: Hamson tells the Player-heroes that he sent the book to his second cousin, Posco Puddifoot, who lives at The Old Mill in the village of Deephallow, in the Eastfarthing.

Success with Woe: Hamson says he's too busy right now, so the Player-heroes will have to wait until this bother is all over. If they lend a hand, he may be able to sort things out more quickly.

Disaster: Suspicions begin to fall on the Player-heroes that they may be in league with the Dwarves in some way. They will need to prove their innocence by solving the mystery before Hamson will give them the information they have asked for. If they didn't already have a reputation as troublemakers, they do now.

Hamson Smallburrow

Hamson is an experienced Bounder for the Westfarthing.

NAME: Hamson Smallburrow

OCCUPATION: Bounder

TRAITS: Honourable, Rustic

If the Company succeeds in this Council, they may proceed to Part 4 immediately and leave Hamson to sort out the current crisis in Tighfield. However, if they stay to help and their current reputation in the Shire is poor, they can improve it. Whatever the outcome of the Council, if the Player-heroes help Hamson to end the crisis satisfactorily, they will lose their reputation as troublemakers.

Lines of Inquiry

The background to the current situation is described in the 'Theft at the Rope Factory' section on pages 13 to 15 of *The Shire*. There are several approaches that the Player-heroes could take, and some are suggested here.

Parley with the Dwarves

This can be run as a Council. The Dwarves do not let the Player-heroes closer than ten paces outside the farmhouse kitchen door.

Resistance: The Resistance will depend on the objectives of the Company: Just asking the Dwarves to tell their side of the story is a reasonable request (Resistance 3).

Asking to search the farmhouse is a bold request (Resistance 6).

Demanding the Dwarves surrender is an outrageous request (Resistance 9).

Introduction: The Player-heroes could choose **COURTESY**, **AWE** or **RIDDLE**. The Dwarves will not accept an Introduction from a Hobbit (treat this as an automatic failure but allow the players to make an **INSIGHT** roll beforehand if they seem to think this would be a good idea). If a Dwarf Player-hero makes the Introduction, they will *gain (1d)* for the roll.

If the Introduction Skill roll is a failure, the Player-heroes will have a time limit equal to 3. If it is a success, the time limit will be equal to 4, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled on the Success dice.

Interaction: The Dwarves' default attitude will be **Open** towards Dwarf Player-heroes and **Reluctant** towards others, leading them to *lose (1d)* on all rolls.

This will improve to **Friendly** towards Dwarf Player-heroes (allowing them *gain (1d)* on all rolls) and **Open** towards others if the Company's objective is only to get the Dwarves' side of the story.

Tensions are high, so the following outcomes are possible:

Success: The Player-heroes achieve their objective. This will count as one additional success for an investigation skill endeavour.

Failure: The Dwarves refuse to cooperate with the Company.

Disaster: The Dwarves shoot a couple of arrows at the Player-heroes who failed the most rolls, before slamming the door shut. Any future interactions the Company has with Dwarves from the Halls of the Dwarves will suffer a complication, leading them to *lose (1d)* on all rolls until they can restore their reputation.

Assault the Farmhouse

This is a very risky and ill-advised course of action. The Player-heroes should be warned that if any of the Dwarves are killed there will be consequences for all taking part:

- Each Player-hero will gain 4 Shadow Points for a Misdeed
- Any Hobbit of the Shire will be arrested and sentenced to pay compensation to the Dwarves' relatives – their Standard of Living will drop to the next lower level. If their Standard of Living drops to Poor because of this, the player must retire their character.
- Any other Player-heroes will be banished from the Shire and be escorted to the border by Bounders.
 - Resisting this expulsion would be a Misdeed gaining 3 Shadow Points.
 - Re-entering the Shire before the banishment is lifted would be a Misdeed gaining 1 Shadow Point. If caught, resistance would be a Misdeed gaining 3 more Shadow Points.
- The Dwarves' family will declare a feud with the Company. The Eye Awareness rules on pages 169 to 173 of *The One Ring* can be used to manage the effects of this feud. It can be ended after the first Revelation Episode if all Player-heroes who have not already paid compensation reduce their Standard of Living by one level as payment of wergild. If their Standard of Living drops to Poor because of this, the player must retire their character.

This will cause a lengthy delay to the Company's progress. If Hamson has not already given them the information they need, he will refuse to cooperate with the Company now. He would provide the information to Mr Grubb, if the lawyer writes to him to formally request the information. By that time, the Player-heroes may find it very difficult to use the information. The Loremaster will need to carefully consider how the Company can continue this adventure.

If they go ahead with the assault, they will find the Dwarves well prepared. The Dwarves will each shoot twice in Opening Volleys. Player-heroes armed with bows

may also shoot twice and those armed with spears may throw them. All of the Player-hero shots will be severely hindered and *lose (2d)*.

One or two Player-heroes must forgo opening volleys as they charge the door to break it in. This requires an **ATHLETICS** skill test (the second Player-hero may assist the first). If the roll is successful, then the Player-heroes will not suffer complications in the Close Quarters rounds. If it is a failure, attack rolls for Player-heroes in a close combat stance will be moderately hindered and *lose (1d)*.

During the Close Quarters rounds, only one Player-hero may take a close combat stance unless two both take a Forward stance. Player-heroes armed with bows may take a Rearward stance, but shots will be severely hindered and *lose (2d)*.

The Dwarves will have a defensive position prepared with two of them in close combat and one behind, shooting their bow. Their position gives them a moderate advantage, allowing all rolls to *gain (1d)*. They will lose their advantage (and the close combat Player-heroes will lose their initial hindrance) as soon as one of them in close combat is knocked out.

If a Dwarf is reduced to zero Endurance, they will be knocked unconscious but not killed. If they are Wounded, they will be killed. They will surrender as soon as at least one Dwarf is killed, knocked unconscious or exhausted.

Whatever the outcome of the assault, future interactions the Company has with Dwarves from the Halls of the Dwarves will suffer a complication, leading them to *lose (1d)* on all rolls until they can restore their reputation.

Carry Out an Investigation

This can be run as a Laborious Skill Endeavour, with a Resistance of 6. The time limit will depend on the result of the Council with Hamson:

- If the Council was a Success, the Company has plenty of time, and the time limit is 6.
- If the Council was a Success with Woe, the Company has enough time, and the time limit is 5.
- If the Council was a Disaster, the Company has a short time, and the time limit is 4.

Various skills may be used to gather clues during the execution:

SCAN could be used to look for clues at the Ropewalk.

HUNTING could be used to search for tracks between the Ropewalk and the farmhouse.

INSIGHT could be used to provide details of the state of mind of witnesses being questioned.

PERSUADE or **AWE** could be used to get suspects to tell the truth during an interrogation.

RIDDLE could be used to piece together other clues already obtained.

The players are free to suggest other appropriate skills. The Risk Level of all rolls is Standard.

If the Player-heroes succeed in the Skill Endeavour, they will have gathered enough evidence to satisfy Hamson of the identity of the true culprits. Their reputation will be enhanced, and they will no longer be considered troublemakers.

Searching the Farmhouse

If the Player-heroes get the opportunity to search the farmhouse, a successful SCAN roll will allow them to find the stolen rope. This will count as one additional success for the investigation skill endeavour, plus another success per *Tengwar* rolled.

If the outcome of the Player-heroes' actions is that their investigation failed, but they captured the Dwarves anyway, they will lose any troublemaker reputation they have in the Shire but gain 1 Shadow Point from a Misdeed. Whatever the outcome, Hamson will now give them the details of where he sent the Green Book to the Company, and they may continue their quest.

[Down to Deephallow](#)

The journey to Deephallow will take the Company all the way from the northwest of the Westfarthing to the southeast of the Eastfarthing. They will need to head back to Waymeet or Bywater, then follow the East Road as far as the Brandywine Bridge. Instead of crossing the bridge, they will follow the road south through Stock and Rushey to Deephallow. This is a trip of over 140 miles and will take about a week.

Two rolls for Events will be required on the Hobbit Walks table on page 10 of *The Shire*, checking the 'Summer and Spring' column for Fatigue points gained. Before the second Event, make a roll on the East Road Encounters table on page 34 of *The Shire*. Feel free to roll on the Inn Gossip Table (page 14) and/or the Waymeet Journey Table (page 23) of *The Shire*, to help add flavour to the journey.

After arriving in Deephallow, each Player-hero may make a TRAVEL roll to reduce any Fatigue gained and may further reduce Fatigue by the Vigour of their mount if they have one. The Company can ask for directions to the Old Mill, but when they get to the end of Mill Lane, they can see a sign on the gate that says "Gone fishing".

Part 4: The Mithe

Rumour

There's good fishing in the Mithe. Aye, and good hunting too, with the waterfowl flying out of the Overbourn Marshes. But you don't want to go into the marshes – there's odd things hidden in there. Shadows in the reeds and whispered echoes of strange songs carried on the breeze. Some say it's the Forgotten Foxglove calling for her long-lost love. Best stick to fishing off the Steps when the mist starts to roll in.

Old Lore

The Mithe Steps have been the main harbour for Deepphallow and Hobbits in the south of the Marish since before anyone can remember. It is said that the River-woman gave her blessing to the original builders of the landing. The Overbourn Marshes to the south are an ancient wilderness that is avoided by the Hobbits. The willow trees that line the banks of the Overbourn remind them of the malevolence of the nearby Old Forest.

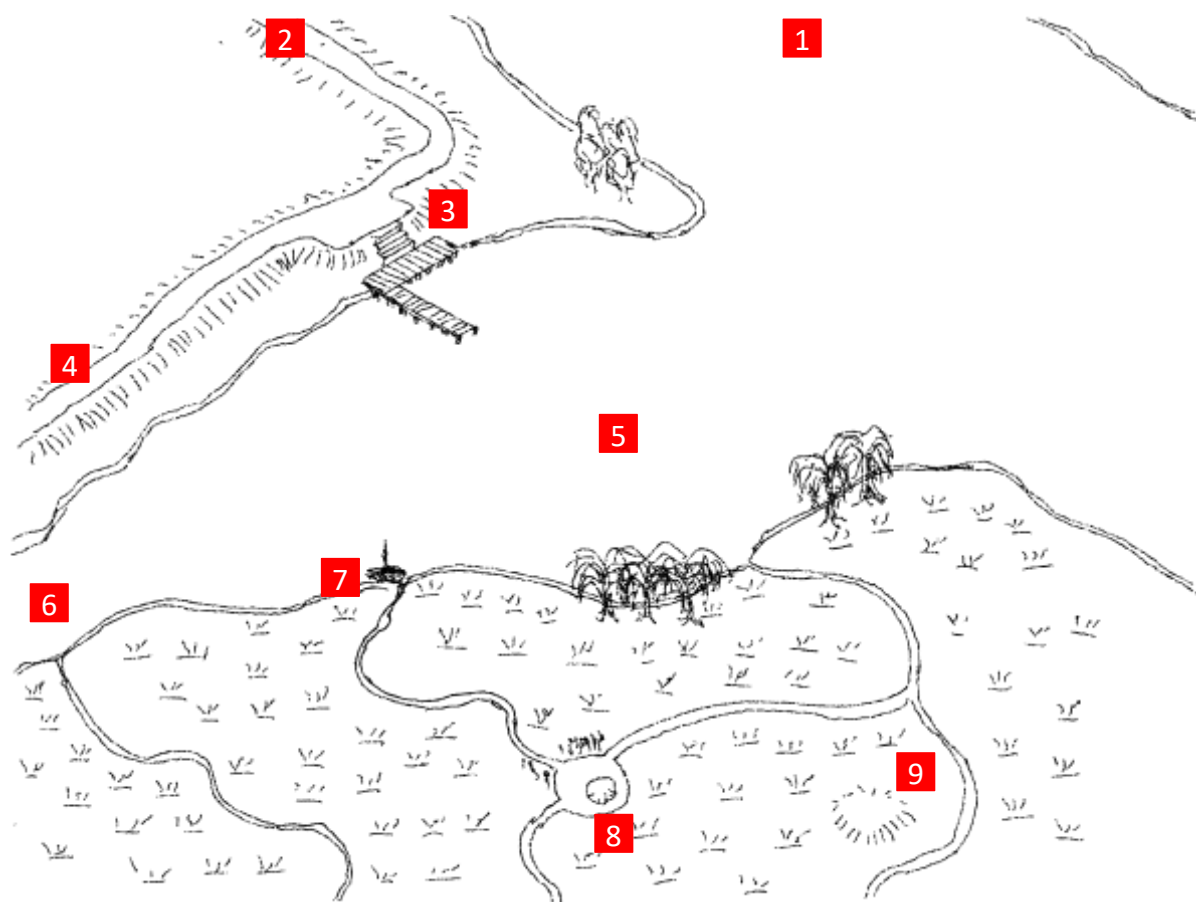
Background

The Mithe was one of the main reasons that Hobbits built the settlement of Deepphallow. This wide pool at the confluence of the Shirebourn and the Brandywine offered a safe place for boating, even for Hobbits. Because of this, the Mithe Steps date back as far as Deepphallow itself.

Tom Bombadil has been known to use the Mithe Steps on visits to the Shire. He also collects rushes for his house from the marshes to the south. He has decided that it is time he cut some fresh rushes, but he doesn't have any oars for his boat. So, he has sent a message to his friend Posco Puddifoot, asking for a lift over.

Posco has dropped Tom off on the south bank of the Mithe and was planning to do some fishing while waiting for Tom to return. But not long after Tom bounded off into the rushes, Posco heard an enchanting voice and couldn't resist venturing into the marsh himself, to find the source of the song. Now he has fallen under the spell of the Forgotten Foxglove, dreaming strange, disturbing dreams...

Locations



1. The Brandywine River

Two or three boats can be seen on the river, each with one or two Hobbits fishing from them. If they are asked whether they have seen Posco, they will say that he isn't here, but he prefers fishing in the Mithe. They are all getting in some practice before the annual fishing competition with Haysend.

Asking to be ferried across to the south shore of the Mithe will require a successful **COURTESY** or **PERSUADE** roll. The Player-heroes can gain (1d) for this test if they tell the Hobbits that they have seen an empty boat and want to search for Posco.

2. Deephallow Road

This road sits on top of an embankment and leads to the village of Deephallow, just 100 yards to the north.

3. The Mithe Steps

There are no boats tied up at the landing. A boat can be seen to the south-west, on the opposite bank of the Mithe. This is Posco's boat.

4. Mill Lane

This lane runs alongside the north bank of the Overbourn for another 300 yards, until it reaches The Old Mill, Posco's home.

5. The Mithe

The Mithe is a wide pool of water where the Overbourn meets the Brandywine. It is normally quite calm and allows boats to be manoeuvred easily.

It would take three successful **ATHLETICS** tests to swim across the Mithe. These tests are at a Standard Risk Level, due to the calmness of the waters, so a Failure can be turned into a Success with Woe. In either case, the Player-hero will suffer a Severe Endurance loss due to drowning (see the **Sources of Injury** table on page 134 of *The One Ring*).

Any Player-hero that successfully swims across can make it to Posco's boat.

6. The Shirebourn River

The Shirebourn enters the Mithe here. As it is narrower than the Mithe, it would only take one **ATHLETICS** test to swim across. However, the current is a bit stronger and more unpredictable, so the Risk Level is Hazardous. A Failure with Woe will result in the Player-hero suffering a Severe Endurance loss due to drowning. If they are still conscious, they may climb back out on the north bank or attempt another **ATHLETICS** test to swim across.

Once across the river, it isn't possible to follow the riverbank to Bosco's boat. A safe path will need to be found wading through the reedbeds, which tower taller than a man. This will require a successful **EXPLORE** test. A failed test can be turned into a Success with Woe, but the Player-hero will gain a point of Fatigue as they spend an hour or two stumbling around in deep water with the mud sucking at their feet below.

7. Posco's Boat

This boat is quite large by Hobbit standards and could carry up to four people at a squeeze. The oars have been neatly stowed and there is some fishing tackle in the stern. Anyone making a successful **AWARENESS** test will notice a kingfisher perched on a nearby log. It appears to be watching the Player-heroes.

The boat can be used to ferry people across the Mithe without any rolls being necessary. The Player-heroes may think of other ingenious ways of retrieving the boat without swimming across. A Magical Success on an **ATHLETICS** test would be required to throw a rope and grapple that far, but it may be possible to attach a cord to an arrow and shoot this at the boat – let the players use their imagination and suggest appropriate skills themselves.

There is a trail leading from the boat and heading roughly southwest into the marshes. A successful **HUNTING** test will reveal that there are two sets of tracks following the trail, one set of which are from a Hobbit.

If the trail is followed, after a short while it begins to bend round to the south. At this point, the two sets of tracks split. One set heads into the reeds to the west, while the other continues to follow the trail. A successful **HUNTING** test will confirm that the Hobbit tracks follow the trail. A failure can be converted to a Success with Woe, at the cost of a point of Fatigue for the Player-hero.

8. Duck Island

The trail from Bosco's boat leads to a small pool with a little island near its south bank. A family of ducks have made their nest on this island. This is one of the Forgotten Foxglove's favourite locations, as she likes to watch the ducklings swimming in the pond as she sings her eerily sad songs to herself.

The Player-heroes could try to sneak past the Forgotten Foxglove, which would require successful **STEALTH** rolls from everyone. These skill checks would *lose (1d)* because the Forgotten Foxglove is Wary. Another **HUNTING** roll would also need to be made, to follow the hobbit tracks along a trail heading east to the Foxglove Mound.

If the Player-heroes end up in combat with the Forgotten Foxglove here, there will only be time for one opening volley as she swiftly approaches them. Fighting in the pool will count as a complication which moderately hinders all close combat attack rolls, causing them to *lose (1d)*. This complication can be removed for the rest of the fight with a successful **BATTLE** roll (which would be the Player-hero's main action for the round), allowing them to fight from the island. Any *Tengwars* rolled can be used to widen influence to other Player-heroes.

After four close combat rounds or after the Forgotten Foxglove has been defeated, whichever is earlier, a blur of red and blue flashes in front of the Player-heroes and they hear something crashing through the reeds behind them. A short man wearing a blue coat, a hat with a blue feather and yellow boots appears, singing a song.

*Hey dol! Merry dol! Ring a dong dillo!
Ring a dong! Hop along! Fal lal the willow!
Tom Bom, jolly Tom, Tom Bombadillo!*

If the Forgotten Foxglove has not been defeated yet, Tom waves his hands and sings:

*Poor little Hobbit-lady, your pretty head you bow,
Take your flower posy, and leave the Duck Pond now!*

The Forgotten Foxglove will immediately stop any attacks and swiftly float off into the reeds.

Now Tom will introduce himself and ask the Player-heroes who they are and what they are doing. Tom will tell the Company that they must go and fetch his friend Posco Puddifoot. "Follow my friend Fisher Blue, he will lead you", he says, pointing to the kingfisher perched nearby. "If you see little Foxglove again, sing this song to her", says Tom, and he teaches the Player-heroes a song.

"Tom must prepare the way, but if you need his help then just call for him", he adds, and he teaches the Company a short rhyme.

If the Player-heroes need Tom's help, they may now spend all of their remaining Fellowship points to call for him with the rhyme. This works exactly the same way as if Tom was the Company's patron, as described on pages 52 and 221 of *The One Ring*.

9. Foxglove Mound

A small hillock of dry land rises from the marshes here. There are many patches of foxgloves growing on its slopes and any Player-hero with the *Rustic* trait will know that this is very unusual, as they are more commonly found in open woods, woodland clearings and hedge banks (or Hobbit gardens).

Lying on top of the mound is the sleeping body of Posco Puddifoot. As the Player-heroes begin to climb the mound, the Forgotten Foxglove will emerge from the other side of the hill, her strength fully restored. She will immediately attack anyone approaching the sleeping Posco.

If the Player-heroes have fought the Forgotten Foxglove before, they *gain (1d)* for the Strike Fear Shadow test at the beginning of this combat. There are also some specific conditions that apply to combat on the Foxglove Mound:

- One Player-hero may sing the song Tom taught them from a Rearward stance. They may be supported by another Player-hero spending a point of Hope as usual. A successful *SONG* test will reduce the Forgotten Foxglove's Resolve by 1, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled.
- A Player-hero may attempt to pick up Posco by taking a Forward stance and making a successful *ATHLETICS* roll. Anyone taking this action will become the focus of the Forgotten Foxglove's attacks.
- The Player-heroes may flee from the area once they have Posco. If the Forgotten Foxglove has not yet been defeated, they can use the rules in the 'Fly, you fools!' box on page 104 of *The One Ring*.



The Forgotten Foxglove

The Forgotten Foxglove haunts the northern reaches of the Overbourn Marshes. For more background information about the Forgotten Foxglove, see page 35 of *The Shire*.

The Forgotten Foxglove

The Forgotten Foxglove will not immediately attack when first encountered unless the Company includes a Hobbit. Instead, she will ask “Have you seen my sweetheart?” A direct offer to help her find him will be accepted, but any other response will make her suspect the Company are trying to keep her apart from her love, so she will attack. At the start of any combat, the Forgotten Foxglove’s Thing of Terror Fell Ability will be invoked. Then during combat, she will target any Hobbit, by attempting to seize them with her Chilling Touch if in close combat, or with her Dreadful Spell if she can’t reach them.

The Forgotten Foxglove

Swift, Wary

ATTRIBUTE LEVEL

ENDURANCE

16

MIGHT

1

Resolve

4

PARRY

+1

ARMOUR

2

COMBAT PROFICIENCIES: Chilling Touch 2 (4/12, Seize)

FELL ABILITIES: *Deathless.* Spend 1 Resolve to cancel a Wound. When an attack inflicts damage to the Forgotten Foxglove that would cause her to go to zero Endurance, spend 1 Resolve to bring her back to full Endurance instead.

Heartless. The Forgotten Foxglove is not affected by the Intimidate Foe combat task unless a Magical Success is obtained.

Thing of Terror. At the start of the first round of battle, all players in sight of the Forgotten Foxglove gain 3 Shadow Points (Dread). Those who fail their Shadow test are daunted and cannot spend Hope for the rest of the fight.

Dreadful Spells. Spend 1 Resolve to make one Hobbit Player-hero gain 3 Shadow points (Sorcery). Those who fail their Shadow test or who are Miserable fall unconscious and may be roused only with a SONG roll. Otherwise, they wake up after one hour.

Denizen of the Marshes. All attack rolls are *Favoured* while in the Overbourn Marshes.

Fear of Fire. The Forgotten Foxglove loses 1 Resolve at the start of each round she is engaged in close combat with an adversary wielding a torch or other sort of burning item.

It is very difficult to defeat the Forgotten Foxglove permanently. She is a very unusual kind of wraith. Some way would need to be found to allow her soul to depart the world, but this would be a quest in itself.

The Forgotten Foxglove will only rest in peace when the rivalry between the towns of Deephallow and Haysend is finally settled (see pages 35 and 43 of *The Shire*). Then, someone must pick a bouquet of foxgloves from a glade in the Old Forest and lay it on the Foxglove Mound, while singing a song of reconciliation.

Part 5: To Bree!

After the events in the Overbourn Marshes, Tom will lead the Company back to the Old Mill and stay with them for the evening to make sure Posco recovers. He leaves the next morning, taking Posco's boat.

Posco will be very grateful to the Player-heroes for rescuing him. He will give them the Green Book and explain that Tobias asked him to check the genealogies for his branch of their family tree. The Player-heroes may stay up to two more nights as guests of Posco's hospitality.

Staying with Posco at the Old Mill counts as a sheltered and safe refuge for Fatigue recovery (see page 111 of *The One Ring*), so all Player-heroes may recover 1 Fatigue for each night they stay.

The Road Goes Ever On

Eventually, the Company will need to leave and make their way to Bree-land. This will mean leaving the Shire, so the Journey rules on pages 108 to 114 of *The One Ring* will be used. This will be the first Journey where the Player-heroes need to choose journey roles.

Journey Path

The most obvious journey path will be to head north to the East Road, then follow it to Bree. This is a journey of 6 hexes, all by road.

Marching Tests

It is late Spring, so the first event will occur two hexes into the journey if the Guide fails their first TRAVEL test. This will be on the East Road, somewhere between the Brandywine Bridge and Bree. If a second event occurs before the Company reaches Bree, it will happen further along the road. It is not possible to have more than two events on this journey before the Player-heroes arrive in Bree.

Event Resolution

It is a good idea to prepare for journey events before the session. In this case, prepare two events, although it may only be necessary to use one. Roll for the target of the event and then roll on the Journey Events table on page 112 of *The One Ring*. This second roll uses one

Feat die because the event will be in a Wild Land, unless the Company has taken Gilraen as their Patron, in which case make a *Favoured* Feat die roll.

When the players are resolving the events, remember that their rolls *gain* (1d) because they are travelling by road.

End of the Journey

The journey will take 3 days if the Player-heroes all have a mount, or 6 days if some of them are walking. This may be adjusted by journey events. The Company is in no hurry, so there is no need to make a forced march.

Each Player-hero may make a TRAVEL roll to reduce any Fatigue gained and may further reduce Fatigue by the Vigour of their mount if they have one.

The Sign of the Prancing Pony

The Company will eventually arrive in Bree on a fine late Spring evening and find themselves outside a large building, staring up at a sign with a prancing pony on it. The Player-heroes can stay here for the evening, before walking over to Coombe to deliver the Green Book to Oswald Breker in the morning.

More details of the Prancing Pony and its landlord, Barnabas Butterbur, can be found on pages 181 to 183 of *The One Ring*. It would be appropriate to roll on the table on page 182 for encounters in the common room that evening.

Any Player-hero who specifically states that they are looking out for anything may make an AWARENESS roll to spot anyone they recognise. This roll will *lose* (1d) because Sabian is Secretive but if it is successful, they will recognise him as one of the men they saw at the Sparrow's Nest. If spotted, Sabian will leave before the Player-heroes can do anything else.

The House of Oswald Breker

The following day the Player-heroes can follow directions leading them over Bree-hill to the village of Coombe. This deep valley remains in shadow for most of the day and the quiet is only broken by the bleating of the sheep on the slopes. An old man working in his garden grudgingly points the Player-heroes to Oswald's house, as he looks at them suspiciously. When they knock at the door, it is opened by a timid servant, who ushers them into a reception room.

The servant leaves the Player-heroes in the room and a minute later an old man enters. He is finely dressed but bent over and supported by a walking stick. More details of Oswald Breker are given on page 186 of *The One Ring*. Oswald asks "Well, what service may you be to me?"

The Player-heroes should choose one of them to be their spokesman, who will introduce them with a COURTESY roll. This skill test will *gain* (1d) for Mr Grubb's letter of introduction. This is a standard risk test, so a failure may be changed into a Success with Woe, in which

case any Oswald will take a reluctant attitude to any future interactions with the Player-heroes, causing any rolls to *lose* (1d).

Oswald will read the letter of introduction carefully and then sign it. He will say:

"It says here that I should let you use my library. Well, so be it. Go back to the Prancing Pony and wait until I send word that it is convenient."

He hands the back the letter to the Company's spokesperson and the servant shows them out.

Epilogue

The Company may now enter their first Fellowship Phase. Barnabas Butterbur can help them arrange for the letter with Oswald's signature to be posted back to Griffio Grubb. Two or three weeks later, the Player-heroes' inheritance is delivered by some Dwarves on their way from their home in the Blue Mountains to the Lonely Mountain. They also deliver a letter from Mr Grubb, addressed to 'The Fellowship of the Green Book'.

*Messrs Grubb, Grubb and Burrowes,
3 High Street,
Michel Delving,
West Farthing,
The Shire*

Dear Friends

I congratulate you on completing the unusual conditions specified in the Will of the late Mr Tobias Goldworthy. There is one further clause that I can now execute, which is to pass on to you the following message from beyond the grave.

Tobias wanted you to know that there are clues contained in Oswald Brecker's library, which could lead you to treasures that his Company failed to recover.

I wish you the best of luck on your future ventures.

Your Humble Servant,

*Griffo Grubb,
Senior Partner*

The following guidance can be applied to the Fellowship Phase:

Duration

The next adventure in this campaign is set two or three months later, in the late summer of 2965.

Destination

The Company will be staying in Bree, which is their initial safe haven.

Updates

Players may spend any experience earned. They will have amassed approximately 1 Experience Point per hour of play during the previous adventure.

Player-heroes will also recover Hope points equal to their HEART score, (apart from Rangers, who only recover half of their HEART score, rounding up).

Saving Posco can be considered to have at least marginally interfered with the return of the Shadow, so all Player-heroes (apart from any High Elves of Rivendell) will remove 1 Shadow point.

Undertakings

This is not a Yule Fellowship Phase, so the Company may choose one Undertaking, plus a second Free Undertaking that is allowed by the callings of the Player-heroes.

If Tom Bombadil and Lady Goldberry are not already the Patrons of the Company, the 'Meet Patron' Undertaking may be chosen to add them. If so, Tom will meet the company in a private parlour at the Prancing Pony, on one of his visits to see Barnabas Butterbur.

If the Player-heroes choose the 'Gather Rumours' Undertaking, they may hear the rumour described at the beginning of *The Withywindle and the House of Tom Bombadil* Landmark in the next adventure. They will also hear that Oswald Breker murdered his daughter, then when his wife found out he killed her too. He buried them in the ruined High House at the end of the valley of Coombe and they haunt the place.

Into the Woods

Oswald Breeker has been true to his word, allowing up to two companions at a time to use his library on Tuesdays and Thursdays. He doesn't appear to be very happy about the arrangement and completely avoids the Player-heroes as much as possible.

The more scholarly members of the company have been reading the Green Book and researching the events described in them, looking for clues to the treasure mentioned in Griffo Grubb's last letter. They learn the basic details of the events since 2938 described in the table on pages 7 and 8 of the Introduction. Their particular attention has been drawn to events around Bree in 2951.

Tobias and his companions were investigating the death of a friend who had been murdered at the Forgotten Inn. They found the culprits travelling in disguise with a caravan bound for Bree. Both of those responsible were followers of a scholar of ill-repute from the south called Gorlanc. It seems that they were carrying a great treasure to Gorlanc, called the Ring of the Seven Jewels, and were prepared to kill to keep this secret.

The Ring of the Seven Jewels

This Ring of Power was one of the last lesser rings forged by the Elves in the Second Age, before the creation of the Great Rings. It was made by a jewel-smith called Nethig as a gift for her lover. Like most of the lesser rings, it is a plain band of gold. It was designed to reinforce skills most valued by the wearer. It is a Wondrous Item with Blessings for the two Skills selected as *Favoured* by the wearer when they chose their Calling.

Unfortunately, the lesser rings were all made with the assistance of Sauron, so the Ring of the Seven Jewels is cursed with a Shadow Taint – the bearer gains 2 Shadow points. This curse will only be lifted with the destruction of *the One Ring*.

The Ring of the Seven Jewels was named after another item of jewellery that was designed to carry it called the **Naugantdolen**. This is a green enamelled silver locket, set with one yellow gem surrounded by six long white gems in the image of a white daffodil. Inside, the navy-blue velvet lining is perfectly indented to hold the ring. This artefact was made by Hanar, a Dwarven craftsman from Khazad-Dum who was a great friend of Nethig. It is a Marvellous Artefact with a Blessing for ENHEARTEN.

The locket requires a successful RIDDLE roll to discover the secret to open it, which loses (2d) for anyone who is not a Dwarf. The gems need to be pressed in a specific order.

Berelas recited an incantation that Gorlanc had taught her when she discovered the ring. This bound a Cold Spirit of Shadow to the ring. The death of Gorlanc severely weakened the spirit, which is currently trapped in the locket. However, the spirit imparts a curse of Darken onto the locket, which is triggered when the locket is opened.

However, Tobias discovered that one of the rogues, the one carrying the ring, was only a reluctant ally of Gorlanc. Her name was Berelas and she used the power of the ring to help save the lives of two sick Bree-landers. Tobias and his company persuaded Berelas to repent, but they needed to hide the ring from Gorlanc. They decided to take the ring to Tom Bombadil, as it would have no power over him.

It is not clear what happened to Berelas afterwards, but surely the Ring of the Seven Jewels must be the treasure that Tobias was referring to?

Part 1: Over Grass and Over Stone

The companions have enjoyed a pleasant time in Bree while researching in Oswald's library, but a couple of months have passed since the Summer Smoke Ring Festival and the nights are starting to draw in. They now have enough information to try to find some of the treasure hinted at in Griffo Grubb's last letter. It seems to be a simple case of going to visit Tom Bombadil and asking for the Ring of the Seven Jewels that he was looking after.

A Trip to Tom

If the company has taken Tom Bombadil and Lady Goldberry as Patrons, then they will know where Tom's cottage is. Otherwise, its location seems to be common knowledge in Bree, although it is extremely difficult to find anyone who has actually been there. The one piece of advice that anyone will give the companions for free is not to venture onto the Barrow Downs after dark.

Tom's cottage is between the Old Forest and the Barrow Downs, at the head of the Withywindle. The Barrow Downs are described in more detail on pages 194-5 of *The One Ring*. When planning the trip, the Journey rules on pages 108 to 114 of *The One Ring* will be used. The Player-heroes must decide what Journey Roles each of them will take.

Journey Path

Taking the starting point of the journey on the map as the crossroads at Bree, the destination is only two hexes away.

Marching Tests

It is late Summer, so the first event will occur two hexes into the journey if the Guide fails their first TRAVEL test. This would usually mean that the company would arrive at their destination without any Travel Events. However, the Barrow Downs are a Perilous Location that would normally require two rolls on the Journey Events table on page 112 of *The One Ring*. As the company is only skirting the edge of this area, roll just once for this journey.

Event Resolution

This journey will only require one event to be prepared. Roll for the target of the event and then roll on the Journey Events table on page 112 of *The One Ring*. This second roll will be *Ill-favoured* because the event will be in a Dark Land, unless the target of the Event is an Elf with the *Memory of Ancient Days* Cultural Virtue, in which case make a normal Feat die roll.

On the other hand, if the Company has taken Gilraen as their Patron, then it is a *Favoured* Feat die roll.

When the players are resolving the events, remember that their rolls *lose (1d)* because the Barrow Downs are difficult terrain.

End of the Journey

The company will also need to set out early if they want to get to their destination before sunset. This will count as a Forced March (see page 112 of *The One Ring*), adding 1 to the Fatigue gained by all Player-heroes.

Each Player-hero may make a **TRAVEL** roll to reduce any Fatigue gained and may further reduce Fatigue by the Vigour of their mount if they have one. Apply Travel Fatigue before the following encounter.

Fog on the Barrow Downs

In the early afternoon a mist starts to creep out of the Old Forest and over the Barrow Downs. This has an unnatural feel about it and starts to play tricks on the eyes of the companions as they wind their way through the downs. The standing stones on top of some of the hills seem to grow and even move, making it difficult to keep on track.

Within a couple of hours, the mist has developed into a thick fog and the companions are at risk of becoming separated. Each Player-hero must make a **SCAN** roll. A success means they have found (or remained in touch with) one other random companion. For each *Tengwar* rolled, they find an additional companion. The risk level of this test is Hazardous, so a failed roll will result in Failure with Woe. Therefore, when determining the companions found by a successful roll, other Player-heroes who also succeeded should be prioritised – anyone who failed their roll will be the last to be found. While this is happening, any mounts will be spooked and run off.

For example, in a party of three Player-heroes, two succeed their **SCAN** roll and one fails. The two who succeeded find each other in the fog, but the one who failed is lost. If one of the players had rolled a great success, they would have also found the 'lost' Player-hero.

It is now that the Barrow-wight strikes.

Barrow-wight

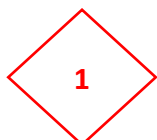
Cunning, Vengeful

ATTRIBUTE LEVEL

ENDURANCE



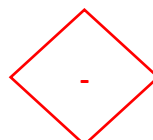
MIGHT



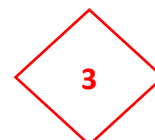
Hate



PARRY



ARMOUR



COMBAT PROFICIENCIES: Ancient Sword 3 (5/16, Pierce)

Chilling Touch 2 (4/12, Seize)

FELL ABILITIES: *Deathless.* Spend 1 Hate to cancel a Wound. When an attack inflicts damage to the Barrow-wight that would cause it to go to zero Endurance, spend 1 Hate to bring it back to full Endurance instead.

Heartless. The Barrow-wight is not affected by the Intimidate Foe combat task unless a Magical Success is obtained.

Thing of Terror. At the start of the first round of battle, all players in sight of the Barrow-wight gain 3 Shadow Points (Dread). Those who fail their Shadow test are daunted and cannot spend Hope for the rest of the fight.

Dreadful Spells. Spend 1 Hate to make one Player-hero gain 3 Shadow points (Sorcery). Those who fail their Shadow test or who are Miserable fall unconscious and may be roused only with a SONG roll. Otherwise, they wake up after one hour.

Hate Sunlight. The Barrow-wight loses 1 Hate at the start of each round it is exposed to the full light of the sun.

The Barrow-wight will target any Player-hero who has become separated in the fog. If no Player-heroes are on their own, he will target the smallest group. He will attempt to ambush the group targeted, so the Player-hero(es) must make an AWARENESS roll. This roll *loses (2d)* because of the fog.

- If a Player-hero succeeds in their test, they may make one Ranged attack as an Opening Volley, but the attack roll will *lose (2d)* as the shadowy figure emerges from the swirling thick fog.
- Next, all Player-heroes in the group targeted must make a Shadow test for the Barrow-wight's *Thing of Terror* Fell Ability.
- After this, any Player-hero who was not surprised may draw a weapon (as a secondary action) and attack (as a primary action). This attack will *lose (1d)* because of the fog.

If wounded, the Barrow-wight will spend a point of Hate to cancel it. If not, he will spend a point of Hate to activate their *Dreadful Spells* Fell Ability, preferably against a Player-hero who was daunted after failing their *Thing of Terror* Shadow test.

*Cold be hand and heart and bone,
and cold be sleep under stone:
never more to wake on stony bed,
never, till the Sun fails and the Moon is dead.
In the black wind the stars shall die,
and still on gold here let them lie,
till the dark lord lifts his hand
over dead sea and withered land.*

If any of the Player-heroes in the targeted group are still standing, the Barrow-wight will attack them. He will use his Ancient Sword if he is engaged with a Player-hero who has drawn their own weapon, otherwise he will use his Chilling Touch attack and try to seize his opponent. If all of his opponents are unconscious, the Barrow-wight will lift up one of the bodies and carry it off into his barrow.

Any Player-heroes that are not in the targeted group may make either an **AWARENESS** or a **SCAN** roll to find the group being attacked, as they hear the mournful singing and possibly the faint clinking of rings, or the short screams of terror from their comrades. This roll *loses (1d)* as the fog seems to play tricks with the sound. It is a Standard risk level test, so a Failure can be converted into a Success with Woe.

- Player-heroes that succeed in their roll will find the location where their companions were engaged by the Barrow-wight the next round. If any of their companions are still standing, they may join the combat.
- If the Player-heroes Succeeded with Woe, treat them as surprised in the first round.
- Either way, they will need to make a Shadow test for the Barrow-wight's *Thing of Terror* Fell Ability before anything else.

The aim of the Barrow-wight is to bring the sleeping or unconscious body of a victim down into his barrow, so they can be sacrificed later that night. he will not try to defeat the entire company if he doesn't need to. He will give up if reduced to zero Hate.

If the Barrow-wight defeated all of his opponents in the first round, then the other Player-heroes will find anyone left unconscious on the ground, or perhaps just a dropped pack and weapon if a lone lost companion has been carried off. Player-heroes may use **AWARENESS**, **HUNTING** or **SCAN** skills to track the Barrow-wight as he carries their companion back to his barrow. This test is at Standard risk level, so a Failure can be converted to a Success with Woe. Rolls *lose (1d)* due to the fog:

- A **Success with Woe** results in the Player-heroes following the dreary singing, which starts to sound like it is coming from underground. They find the entrance to the barrow, but the entrance is barred by a heavy stone door.
- An ordinary **Success** is similar to a Success with Woe, but the entrance to the barrow is still open.
- If a **Great Success** or **Extraordinary Success** is obtained, one of the *Tengwars* can be spent to Make Haste, allowing the Player-heroes to catch up with the Barrow-wight outside the entrance to the barrow.

Combat will proceed in the same way as before, but Player-hero attack rolls inside the barrow will *lose* (2d) because of the almost unnatural darkness, rather than (1d) for the fog. Inside the barrow, any Player-hero carrying a light source (a torch or lantern) will cancel the darkness penalty for themselves and *reduce it by* (1d) for any other Player-heroes without a light. Anyone who has not yet made a Shadow test for the Barrow-wight's *Thing of Terror* Fell Ability will need to roll now.

If the entrance to the barrow is shut, then combat will be delayed as it will require a Skill Endeavour to open. This is a Laborious task, requiring 6 successes. The time limit is varied:

- After a time limit of 3, the companion inside will start to wake as the sun sets;
- After a time limit of 4, the Barrow-wight will attack the companion who has just woken inside the barrow;
- Player-heroes may continue to make attempts after this – one per combat round.

The Player-hero inside the barrow will have been dressed in a white robe, with a circlet on their head and a gold chain belt about their waist. Gold rings have been placed on their fingers and a long knife (a dagger) is at their side. A shield lies at their feet. If they wake before their companions have opened the entrance, they will feel themselves lying on cold stone in the pitch dark.

- The Player-hero may make an *AWARENESS* or *SCAN* roll to find and pick up the shield at their feet the round before the Barrow-wight attacks them, but this roll *loses* (2d) because of the darkness.
- The next round the chamber starts to illuminate with an eery green glow, before the Barrow-wight attacks. The Player-hero may now pick up the shield as their main action for the round if they are not already holding it.
- The Barrow-wight will attack with its Ancient Sword.
- The Barrow-wight will spend a point of Hate to activate their *Dreadful Spells* Fell Ability against Player-heroes who succeed in opening the entrance and enter the barrow.

If the Barrow-wight is defeated at his barrow, the fog quickly begins to disperse, and the stars shine down on the Player-heroes. They will discover a Greater Hoard inside the barrow worth 7 Treasure each. This includes the following Precious Items:

- A string of pearls, worth 5 Treasure.
- A golden goblet encrusted with red gems, worth 4 Treasure.
- A silver necklace set with blue sapphires, worth 6 Treasure.

A Player-hero who survived being brought back to the barrow by the Barrow-wight will recover all of their enhanced equipment (but not their clothes). The Loremaster may also take this opportunity to award any Player-hero an item from their Magical Treasure Index.

Combat with a Barrow-wight can be very challenging for an inexperienced group of Player-heroes, as they will find it difficult to pass Shadow tests with Wisdom and Valour being only 1 or 2. The following tips could prove useful:

- The Loremaster could remind players that they can spend Hope to *add (1d)* to Shadow test rolls.
- The Loremaster could remind players of benefits that their Patron may give them:
 - Gandalf allows players to spend a Fellowship point to make a Shadow test *Favoured*.
 - Cirdan allows players to spend a Fellowship point to reroll all of the dice in a roll.
 - Tom Bombadil and Lady Goldberry allow the companions to spend all of their remaining Fellowship points to call on Tom to intervene and save them.
- The Loremaster may allow a Player-hero who is a Champion with the Distinctive Feature **Enemy Lore (Undead)** to know about using SONG to wake victims of the Barrow-wight's Dreadful Spell.
- The Loremaster may allow any Player-hero to make a LORE roll to remember about using SONG to wake victims of the Barrow-wight's Dreadful Spell, because of their previous encounter with Tom Bombadil.

If all else fails and it looks like the Barrow-wight is going to defeat the entire company, a kindly Loremaster may allow them to be saved by Tom Bombadil, even if he is not their Patron. In this case, they should not be rewarded with any Treasure.

The Player-heroes will also see a warm, glowing light shining up from behind a hill to the south. Following this will lead them to Tom Bombadil's house.

Part 2: Down the Dingle

When the Player-heroes look down from the crest of the hill into the valley below, they see a familiar figure standing in front of a house, with a welcoming light streaming out of the open door behind him.

Hey! Come derry dol! Hop along, my hearties!

From inside another voice can be heard, clear and bright and gentle:

*Now let the song begin! Let us sing together
Of sun, stars, moon and mist, rain and cloudy weather,
Light on the budding leaf, dew on the feather,
Wind on the open hill, bells on the heather,
Reeds by the shady pool, lilies on the water:
Old Tom Bombadil and the River-daughter!*

Hearing the song of Goldberry seems to drive the darkness away. Hearts are lightened by the joy of her presence and the fairness of her voice, and all Player-heroes regain 1 point of Hope.

The Hospitality of Tom

Tom welcomes the companions into his home, and they find themselves in a long, low room lit with many lamps hanging from the beams. A table of dark polished wood is set with places for each of them and at the other end sits Lady Goldberry.

- For more details of Tom Bombadil's house, see Location #6 of the Landmark described in the next section.

Tom invites the companions to sit down, eat, tell tales and sing. Any Player-hero making a successful SONG roll will regain 1 Hope, plus 1 Hope per *Tengwar* rolled.

The Player-heroes have come to Tom's house to ask him for the Ring of the Seven Jewels. This will be managed as a Council. This can begin after the meal.

Resistance: The Player-heroes are making a reasonable request, so the Resistance for this Council is 3.

Introduction: COURTESY is the only ability that is appropriate in this situation. If the Player-hero making the introduction made a successful Song roll at dinner, they *gain (1d)*.

If the Introduction Skill roll is a failure, the Player-heroes will have a time limit equal to 3. If it is a success, the time limit will be equal to 4, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled on the Success dice.

Interaction: Tom's default attitude will be **Open**. This will improve to **Friendly** if he is the company's Patron, in which case rolls *gain* (1d).

It will quickly become clear that Tom no longer has the "pretty locket". He remembers it and he had it with him when Badger-brock pulled him into his burrow. He dropped it there. The outcome of the council will determine how helpful he is.

The following outcomes are possible:

Disaster: Tom can give the Player-heroes general directions to Badger-brock's Sett (see Location #7 of the Landmark in the following section). He does not seem to remember anything else useful.

Success with Woe: Tom can give the Player-heroes general directions to Badger-brock's Sett, as above. In addition, he remembers seeing Badger-brock's wife wearing the locket – Badger-brock gave it to her as a present.

Success: Tom can give the Player-heroes general directions to Badger-brock's Sett and remembers seeing Badger-brock's wife wearing the locket, as above. In addition, he warns the Player-heroes not to try opening the locket before they return to his house.

After the discussion, the companions are shown to their room. There are freshly made beds for everyone. Tom's house is a Safe Haven, so in addition to the normal benefits of a Long Rest, all Player-heroes recover 1 Point of Fatigue.

Preparing for the Old Forest

The Player-heroes may spend the following day preparing for their journey down the Withywindle valley (the Dingle, as it is known in the Shire). Tom will allow the company to stay at least one more night, while they prepare. This will be extended to as many days as required for any wounds to heal, if Player-heroes were injured on their journey.

The Player-heroes must consider the following when contemplating their journey:

- They cannot use Tom's boat to travel down the river because he has lost his oars.
- Tom's path is considered normal terrain, not difficult, for the purposes of calculating travel time only. This means that Badger-brock's Sett could only be reached in one day if the company forced marches.

The company will also need to decide how they are going to retrieve the locket when they find the Sett. Some approaches are outlined below:

Bartering

The Player-heroes could try to buy the locket back from Badger-brock. This can be run as a Council after they have found one of the entrances to the Sett. In this case, the Resistance will be determined after the Introduction.

Introduction: COURTESY or RIDDLE could be used. AWE could also be used, if the company wants to emphasise that Badger-brock did not obtain the locket legally.

If the Introduction Skill roll is a failure, the Player-heroes will have a time limit equal to 3. If it is a success, the time limit will be equal to 4, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled on the Success dice.

Resistance: This will depend on what the Player-heroes are offering in return for the locket. Badger-brock's wife will only be interested in some sort of jewellery in exchange for her brooch, not just points of Treasure:

- If the Player-heroes offer two or more Precious Items in exchange, Badger-brock will consider this a reasonable request, so the Resistance will be 3.
- If the Player-heroes offer only one Precious Item in exchange, Badger-brock will consider this a bold request, so the Resistance will be 6.
- If the Player-heroes don't offer anything in exchange, Badger-brock will consider this an outrageous request, so the Resistance will be 9.

Interaction: Badger-brock's attitude will be **Reluctant**, so rolls *lose (1d)*.

The most obviously appropriate skill is PERSUADE. A Player-hero may use INSIGHT to recognise that Badger-brock will let his wife make the final decision. A roll of ENHEARTEN or SONG could be used to flatter Badger-brock's wife.

The following outcomes are possible:

Disaster: The Player-heroes find themselves surprised by a host of Badger-brock's sons and pulled down into holes in the secret badger home. They may be ransomed in exchange for a Precious Item.

Failure: No agreement is reached, and the badgers retire back into their home.

Success with Woe: A Failure can be turned into a Success with Woe by offering one more Precious Item than agreed when the Resistance was set.

Success: The deal is agreed.

Brute Force

This is a dangerous option. The Player-heroes should be warned that if they follow this approach, they will all earn at least 1 Shadow point (Misdeed). Any Player-hero

killing a badger will earn an additional 4 Shadow points (Misdeed) for killing harmless folk.

Player-heroes will have to enter the Sett and find Badger-brock with a successful **EXPLORE** or **RIDDLE** roll at a Hazardous risk level. Failure with Woe will result in the Player-hero suffering severe Suffocation damage, due to a minor cave-in.

To succeed in a confrontation with the badgers, the Player-heroes must roll three successful attacks in the same round. There will be no opening volleys and only one-handed weapons can be used in the confined environment.

- Any Player-hero inflicting a Piercing Blow will kill a badger.
- Any Player-hero rolling an Eye will be overwhelmed and captured. They are dragged off and sealed in a hole, to be ransomed.

A Player-hero may make a **BATTLE** roll as their main action for the round, to manoeuvre themselves closer to Badger-brock. This will allow them to automatically take Badger-brock hostage the following round. Threatening Badger-brock in this way will gain the Player-hero 2 Shadow points (Misdeed) for manipulating others and deliberate cruelty.

Burglary

This approach will not earn any Shadow points for misdeeds, because the locket does not really belong to Badger-brock.

- After they have found one of the entrances, a Player-hero will need to enter the Sett and find the chamber of Badger-brock's wife with a successful **EXPLORE** or **RIDDLE** roll at a Hazardous risk level.
- Failure with Woe will result in the Player-hero suffering severe Suffocation damage, due to a minor cave-in.
- If any *Tengwars* are rolled, one of them can be spent to go stealthily, otherwise a **STEALTH** roll will also be required at a Hazardous risk level. If this roll is failed, the Player-hero is captured and held for ransom in a sealed hole.
- If they find the chamber without being detected, the Player-hero must make a **SCAN** roll at Standard difficulty. A Failure can be changed to a Success with Woe – the Player-hero breaks a vase and must succeed at an **ATHLETICS** roll at a Hazardous risk level to quickly get out without being caught (Failure with Woe will result in capture, as above).

Riddle Competition

The Player-heroes could challenge Badger-brock to a Riddle competition. They can issue the challenge after finding one of the entrances. This can be treated as a Laborious Skill Endeavour (Resistance 6). There is no time limit required. However,

the Player-heroes will need to offer a suitable reward for if they lose, such as a Precious Item.

- All rolls use the RIDDLE skill, at a Hazardous risk level. If any roll fails, the Player-heroes have not guessed Badger-brock's riddle and so have lost the competition.
- Any *Tengwars* rolled represent Badger-brock becoming flustered by a tricky riddle, which will reduce the number of additional rolls required by the Player-heroes.

The Loremaster should reward good roleplay by awarding a bonus Success die for a good riddle, or two if he can't guess the answer. The Player-heroes still have to roll, as Badger-brock may be smarter than the Loremaster.

All other guidance required to manage a trip along the Withywindle is detailed in the Landmark described in the next part of this adventure. It should be noted that travelling through the Old Forest can result in various additional sources of Shadow point gain. The Loremaster could remind players of the Harden Will rule described on page 137 of *The One Ring*, if players are worried about this.

Part 3: The Withywindle and the House of Tom Bombadil

Rumour

*"Many strange things come down the River, Badgers, Fisher Birds, Otters, and Swans of White Feather.
Of a River Daughter and a tree, Old Man Willow, But strangest of all is one Tom Bombadillo.
Take a boat up the River you can paddle,
But rest assured you'll be back with a waddle. So stay all day and night behind the Grind,
You'll wake up the next morn, best of kind."*

Old Lore

*"When the year turns brown, when the west wind bellows and leaves do their feather falling,
Woodman Tom paddles past on down Breredon, High Hay and Deephallow,
To Shirebourn way some say he be a calling."*

*Three arrows in his hat, Tom stumped along, Past Haysend, the Marish and to Bamfurlong.
Old Farmer Maggot and Merry Jolly Tom, over fine food and malt drink ales,
Swap stories, songs, and riddles, until fast asleep they rested on bales."*

Background

The brown waters of River Withywindle flow in a southwesterly direction from the western edge of the Barrow-downs, bisecting the Old Forest almost in equal halves. It joins the Brandywine River just north of the confluence of the Brandywine and Shirebourn River. The

settlement of Haysend sits at the river mouth, directly opposite Deephallow on the other side of the Brandywine. A couple miles north of Haysend, past the thick hedge called The High Hay, Breredon is almost all but forgotten, a tiny community of fisher folk who reside within the borders of the Old Forest itself. The Grindwall is a natural barrier that protects it and extends into the water.

The Withywindle carves out a valley, referred to by Hobbits as the Dingle, through the Old Forest, and is an odd place best avoided by any travellers, Hobbit, and tall folk alike. All manners of oddities are said to come out of there, from fish, beast, and birds of the feather, not the least of which of course is the River Woman's Daughter, Goldberry and the Master of the Wood himself, Tom Bombadil. And lest anyone forgets where they are, for one may tire and fall asleep, with Old Man Willow, pulling them under its roots forever.

The Dingle is a deep cut valley, with high, and sloping edges, with small streams and springs flowing down and feeding into the Withywindle. The ground is generally soft and boggy at the bottom, with small brooks that trickle and babble through weedy beds. The trees that make up the Old Forest overhang like arches over the slops and the valley below. Anyone standing near the river's banks will generally be met with a warm and gentle westerly breeze, rustling the many patches of hobbit height reeds, and the creaking of willow-boughs all above and around them.

A foot path runs parallel on the north side of the river and extends from the edges of the forest in the west all the way up to the House of Tom Bombadil. Anyone who finds and treks along it will find it easy to follow, as it guides the traveller past bogs and pools over sounder, firmer grounds, passing up and over hills and into gullies and out of the higher forestlands. Tree-trunks and bundles of brushwood lay carefully across any impassable areas, such as deep boggy grounds, streams, and pools as described earlier.

At the eastern end the path is lined with stone, and over a grassy knoll, and resting on another rise in the ground, is a split level, stone house, sheltered by an overhanging hill-brow, where the headwaters and falls of the Withywindle flow down from the Barrow-downs. This is the House of Tom Bombadil his wife, Lady Goldberry.

But water, old trees and a jolly merry fellow are not everything that weary travellers happen on as they travel through the river valley. Willow warblers, kingfishers, swans, otters, and maybe even a fairy may be encountered, especially if any have any fey blood within them!

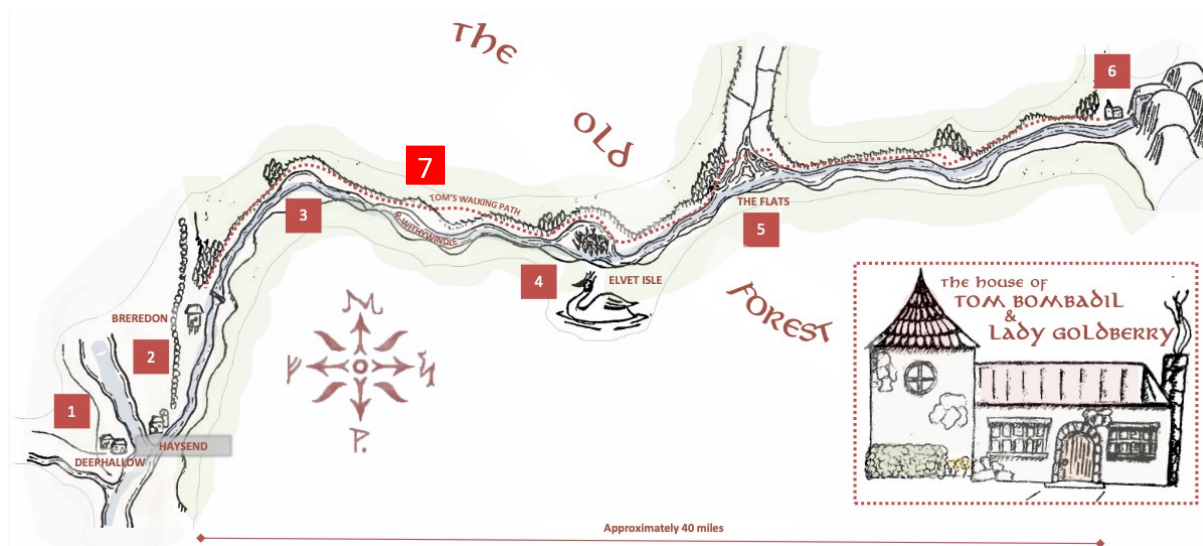
Journey Event

When travelling along the banks, Bombadil's Path or on the Withywindle by boat itself, the Company experiences two journey events due to its perilous nature, using the Withywindle Journey Events table found below. This is to be used instead of the standard journey events table found in the core rule book on page (112) or the Strange Encounter in the Old Forest table found in the Shire booklet from *The One Ring Starter Set*.

Withywindle Journey Events Table

FEAT DIE	EVENT	CONSEQUENCES OF THE ROLL	FATIGUE POINTS GAINED
Eye	Terrible Misfortune	If the roll fails, the target is Wounded.	3
1	Despair	If the roll fails, everyone in the Company gains 1 Shadow point (Dread).	2
2-3	Ill-Choices	If the roll fails, the target gains 1 Shadow point (Dread).	2
4-7	Mishap	If the roll fails, double the time it takes to travel half the <i>Dingle</i> .	2
8-9	Short Cut	If the roll succeeds, reduce the time it takes to travel half the <i>Dingle</i> by half.	1
10	Chance-meeting	If the roll succeeds, no Fatigue is gained, and the Loremaster improvises an encounter favouring the Company (Such as meeting <i>Tom Bombadil</i>)	1
Gandalf	Joyful Sight	If the roll succeeds, the light singing of a fair maiden is heard and they are met by the <i>River-Daughter, Lady Goldberry</i> . Everyone in the Company regains 1 Hope.	-

Locations



1. Deephallow and Shirebourn River

The Shirebourn River opens into the Brandywine just south of the confluence of the Withywindle and Brandywine. Deephallow is nestled the point where of the Shirebourn and Brandywine meets and is directly opposite Haysend to the east. Similar to disposition to others of the Marish and their counterparts directly across the water, residents of

Deephallow can be overtly cantankerous and show little love for merriment, in part due to the constant longstanding feud over-fishing rights with the residents in Haysend.

- The *Shire* supplement from *The One Ring Starter Set* provides more detail on the communities of Deephallow, Haysend, Breredon, and the Old Forest than what will be presented in this landmark supplement. Loremasters should have that booklet handy if the company finds themselves wanting more detail than what is presented here.

2. Haysend and Breredon

The two small communities are essentially shunned by most others of the Shire, even those who live close in Buckland. “There must be something mad in ye if ye want to live near those waters, least the Old Wood!” some say, as most Hobbits stay as far away as possible from both communities. Residents from either village don’t mind it one bit, thankful in fact, as they’d rather be left alone to fish, sing of strange tales, and of course blow smoke rings as they sit on the wooden benches, feet crossed, overlooking the river any time of day.

As evening draws however, all are quick to head back inside the safety of their homes, locking the doors at night as rumour tells of many of strange things that happen along the Withywindle, from eery singing on the wind, splashes along the water near the shoreline, and the swooping of winged beasts in the night, and not to mention the dreaded *River Wym*, a large monster that swallows boats whole!

Just north of Breredon and crossing the width of the Withywindle is the Withy-weir, a low-headed dam that since its construction long ago by Hobbits, altered the height and flow of the river itself. Just to the south and along the northern bank was the Grindwall (or landing) with a fence that stretched into the water, with Breredon itself, sitting on the rising ground behind the landing.

Two long, and rounded wooden poles stick out of the water close to the shoreline just south of Breredon. Rumour has it that these are in fact paddles, and belong to *Old Woodman Tom*, who left them there when he didn’t return back from a visit to the Marish a while back, and his boat was made away with by unsavoury, and mischievous looking otters.

3. The Withywindle River

The brown and deep river starts at a quiet falls on the western edges of the Barrow-downs where they meet the eastern treeline of the Old Forest. The river then flows past the House of Tom Bombadil and meanders its way down the Dingle, or valley bisecting the Old Forest in two. As it flows down in a south-westerly direction towards the Brandywine, tall slopes and even cliffs, with overhanging willows and other ancient trees, border both sides of the river. The valley ranges from 100-150 feet across at its narrowest to 400 to 500 feet at its widest, one such area being where the Elvet Isle resides in the middle of a large pool.

The current gradually slows as it nears the Brandywine allowing for easy paddling up stream in any type of watercraft, or if one is daring enough to swim in the waters.

Travelling on the Withywindle

If travelling by boat, one player-hero amongst the Company makes an **ATHLETICS** roll at Standard Risk Level (Simple Failure, or Success with Woe may cause damage or an undesirable result as deemed appropriate by the Loremaster) After a successful roll, the players will have navigated to the Elvet Isle safely, proceeding either upstream to the falls or downstream to the Withy-weir depending on where they started their journey. Another roll is required to make the second leg of the trip.

If the player-heroes attempt to swim the Withywindle, to cross it or to safely get to shore after capsizing a boat, or falling into it by other means, each makes an **ATHLETICS** roll at Hazardous Risk Level (Failure with Woe may cause serious damage or negative consequence upon such a failure. Note Sources of Injury on page 134 of *The One Ring*.) After a successful roll, the players will manage to swim safely to shore, or climb aboard the boat, or other suitable situation that is deemed appropriate by the Loremaster.

The Loremaster should still roll on the ***Withywindle Journey Events Table*** in addition to the above, as described earlier.

The Withywindle is an enchanted waterway, either owing to some fey permutations, by will of Tom and Lady Goldberry, or by Ulmo, the Lord of Waters, no one truly knows. Suffice it to say, it is enchanted, even if it's just the relative beauty as compared to the rest of the Old Forest. Depending on the time of year, one will find beautiful growing water lilies and other wildflowers growing freely along its banks. Trout and other fish swim up and down the river, resting in the many small pools that dot its path. Birds and butterflies fly from one side of the valley to the other, and on the warmest and clearest of mornings, bird song can be heard throughout. Hobbits are quick to warn any eager tween who want to swim in or drink of the waters of the Withywindle of its dangers, either being pulled down below its surface and drowning, or hallucinating and going mad in the mind!

- Besides the obvious issue of most Hobbits not knowing how to swim, no hobbit has been pulled under the water, yet. If someone does drink the waters of the Withywindle, they will experience two things: First, for the following week they will experience vivid, colourful dreams, usually involving fairies and all matter of fey, and will have the uncontrollable urge to pick any lily or blooming flower they see to give to the River Daughter. Second, they receive an extra bonus dice on their next Shadow Test (Dread) roll, as the fey tainted waters seem to lighten even the darkest of thoughts and fears.

If any of the party are actively making an **AWARENESS** roll to spot or find any form of track or trail, on a success will spot a walking path that lies relatively parallel to the river on its northern bank. If any *Tengwars* are rolled, they will notice that the path is made from some man-sized creature wearing boots. The path is Tom Bombadil's and starts from his house at the headwaters of the river, down to the Withy-weir just before Breredon. The path is relatively easy to navigate once you find it, with tree stumps, bundled grasses or placed

rocks helping to bridge streams, boggy grounds, with areas to sit and rest for one to hear the soothing rustling of the river on a warm Summer's Day.

- If any stop and rest their weary feet, anywhere along the trail and river, their eyes begin to become heavy as they have the unyielded urge to take a nap, no matter the time of day. Player-heroes eventually fall fast asleep but wake up hours later (deemed appropriate by the Loremaster) and feel well rested. Reduce any Fatigue points by 1.

4. The Elvet Isle

At roughly the mid-way point of the start of the Withywindle to the confluence where it joins the Brandywine lies the Elvet Isle. This large, reed filled island is home to a bank of beautiful and majestic white swans. Any who happen on the island, whether by boat or walking along the river's banks will see a large black headed old Swan proudly swimming peacefully around the island. On seeing any of the company however, or if any of the company engage with the old Swan in any manner, it will give them a loud snort, and a black look as it eyes them suspiciously and follows their every move while they remain there.

This is the Old Swan King of the Elvet Isle, and of the swans who live on it and all creatures in and on the waters of the Withywindle. The Old Swan King will not be aggressive, unless any Player-hero attempts to make their way to the isle. If they do attempt to get on the island, they will be met by a fierce call by the Old Swan King, with many swans now coming out from the isle from their nests in the reeds or swooping down from up and down the river if already in flight, attacking the player-heroes. Any Hobbit in the party now recalls old stories told to them as tweens and gain 1 point of Shadow (Dread) as they recoil in fear. If the party presses to the isle, they are now met with fierce opposition as all the swans and other animals converge on them to fend off and push them back into the waters and to the river's banks. If the players defend themselves, and draw weapons, they will hear another strong and loud call from the Old Swan King. The Player-heroes now notice a fog start to develop around the isle and the trees of the Old Forest begin to wave back and forth, the wood creaking and groaning in apparent anger. If any Player-heroes attempt to strike at an attacking animal and succeed on hitting it, they kill it regardless of the weapon used. They immediately take 2 points of Shadow (Misdeed), and an overwhelming sense of regret and the urge to flee back to the river's edge waves over them.

If this occurs, the forest, the river and the animals are angered. Any skill roll made by the Player-hero will lose (1d). The Old Swan King and the Old Forest will always remember what had happened to one of its own, and this complication of the player-hero will last until such a time they can atone for what they had done.

5. The Flats

Opening from a small brook fed by many springs along a deep, cliff like gully which slopes deep from within the north side of the forest, lies the flats, a marshy, small delta that flows into the Withywindle. The flats are home to an army of flies, not as large or thick as in Rushock Bog in the Northfarthing but bothersome, nonetheless. Whether heading east or

west along the banks, Tom Bombadil's trail provides a safe and dry path through the wet and boggy land.

Usually digging deep its roots on the western side of the flats, but sometimes to the north deep in the forest or eastwards on the other side, is *Old Man Willow*, who drinks of the waters of the river and lays in wait for any trespassers to the forest. Any who travel past him as he lays in wait, makes a Shadow Test (Sorcery), and on a failure gains 2 points of Shadow and drowsily falls asleep against the roots and trunk of the great old willow.

Old Man Willow is an old and ancient tree and is full of malice and hate. As long as one member of the Company is still awake, they can attempt to open the roots that have pulled any down in the ground, or attempt another way to open them up, such as lighting a fire under the wood. Using the rules of Skill Endeavours on page 132 of *The One Ring*, with a Resistance of 6, Time Limit 6, and using any skill deemed appropriate by the Loremaster or as suggested by the player, will cause Old Man Willow to release any captives. However, trying to burn or cut the wood only angers Old Man Willow more and it proceeds to crush any it has pulled under it and swing its branches at the player-heroes, therefore any skill rolls to complete the Skill Endeavour is *Ill-Favoured*.

If a Player-hero has a white swan feather of the *King*, they may try and convince the old willow to release their companions. The Loremaster sets a council with the Player-heroes, using the rules found in *The One Ring*, with a Resistance 9. *Old Man Willow* has been brooding for a very, very long time and will be hard to convince, even with the help of the *Old Swan King's* feather in their cap!

Old Man Willow

Old Man Willow is an ancient, sentient wood that loathes any interlopers who venture into the forest, especially little, pesky, wood burning Hobbits. His swaying branches cast a spell on those near him, causing a tired weariness into their full body and all they can do is rest their heavy heads on the willow's roots and trunk. Then, as they slumber, Old Man Willow pulls them under, never to be seen again.

NAME: Old Man Willow

OCCUPATION: Sentient Tree

TRAITS: Hateful, Brooding

- For more on *Old Man Willow*, check out the description on page 52 of the *Shire Booklet* in *The One Ring Starter Set*.

6. The House of Tom Bombadil

Sitting on a rise above the north banks at the headwaters of Withywindle River, and just below the falls that feed it from the Barrow-downs is the House of Tom Bombadil. This

warm and inviting stone and wood capped house is a sight to behold amongst the grey and usually foggy downs behind it, and the dark and brooding trees of the Old Forest in front of it. On first spotting they see a split-level cabin made of stone with a pointed wood capped roof, and a tall chimney that soft, lightly coloured smoked seems to constantly rise from it. All along the outside, lush freshly cut grasses surround it, and fenced off to the north corner and behind to its eastern walls are two beautiful gardens, one for flowers of all colours and species, and the other for herbs, vegetables, and fruits. A stone-lined walkway leads from the forest path up to the main door to the house that opens directly westward, as well as around to the back of the house. From there a path leads to the stables nestled against the tall rock wall, with one leading to the river, and another that switches back and forth up to the top of the adjacent down.

At any given time, as one draws near, they hear the melody of soft and sweet singing, with the occasional braying of a pony from the stables seemingly singing in chorus. The air is filled with the scent of lavender and mint, with a sprinkling of other herbs and fine spices. Other times, one may also here the jolly laughter and the rhyming songs of the Master of the house himself, Tom Bombadil.

By some means mystical, only a few have ever laid eyes on the House of Tom Bombadil, and if they have it's usually not by chance, but by invite. Even if they seemingly by chance happen to stumble upon, it is still only by the will of Tom himself that they have found it. Any visitor is greeted with a jolly laugh and a warm smile, that of Tom Bombadil, and accompanying him by his side is the angelic and beautiful River-daughter, Lady Goldberry.

- Further information about Tom Bombadil and Lady Goldberry can be found in the *Shire Booklet* found in *The One Ring Starter Set* as well as under the Patron section in *The One Ring*, starting on page 219.

Anyone finding themselves with the gracious hosts, will find their minds are clear, hearts warmed and their bellies full. If they have brought any ponies or horses with them, they will find they are well taken care of, if not better!

- In addition to the information about Tom and Goldberry found in *The One Ring* and *The One Ring Starter Set*, the House of Tom Bombadil can be considered a "Safe Haven" and therefore off the road. All rules pertaining to recovery of Fatigue are applicable at Tom's house.

7. Badger-Brock's Sett

Badger-brock's home is dug into a hillside above the northern bank of the Withywindle, about five miles downstream from the Elvet Isle. The ground of this wooded area is covered in brambles and thorny briar roses, which hide the many entrances to the Sett. The Sett itself is huge, with many chambers linked by a network of tunnels. Much of Badger-brock's extended family lives with him.

Badger-brock

Badger-brock is the patriarch of all of the badgers in the Old Forest. He is very old for a badger and can speak the common tongue. Badgers are not evil creatures, but Badger-brock's primary concern is the interest of his own folk, so he values their privacy highly.

NAME: Badger-brock

OCCUPATION: Badger Chieftain

TRAITS: Secretive, Fatherly

Badger-brock's Sett can be safely bypassed by anyone sticking to Tom's path. Trying to find one of the entrances requires a **SCAN** or **HUNTING** roll at a Hazardous risk level. Failure with Woe will result in the Player-heroes involved in the roll finding themselves surprised by a host of Badger-brock's sons and pulled down into holes in the secret badger home.

If an entrance is successfully found, Player-heroes can enter the Sett to explore it. The tunnels are larger than in most badger Setts, but still quite restrictive:

- Hobbits and Dwarves with the *Durin's Way* Cultural Virtue may explore the tunnels without penalty.
- Other Dwarves will lose (1d) on all skill and attack rolls within the Sett.
- All other Player-heroes will lose (2d) on all skill and attack rolls within the Sett.
- If fighting, only one-handed weapons can be used.

Exploring the Sett will require a successful **EXPLORE** or **RIDDLE** roll at a Hazardous risk level. Failure with Woe will result in the Player-hero suffering severe Suffocation damage, due to a minor cave-in. If any *Tengwars* are rolled, one of them can be spent to go stealthily, otherwise a **STEALTH** roll will also be required at a Hazardous risk level. If this roll is failed, the Player-hero is captured and held for ransom in a sealed hole.

Schemes and Trouble

Hobbit Residents of Haysend

Whether Hobbit or Tall-Folk alike, make their way and visits the small hamlet of Haysend, they're met with scowling looks and curt responses, and being shoved away and back with whence they came as soon as possible. They don't want any more competition than they already have with the likes of those across the Brandywine in Deephallow, as Haysender's believe they should have sole rights to the fishing grounds around them!

Adventurers may find themselves, especially if they've travelled by boat across the river, to find missing oars, maybe a large hole in the bottom of their boat or find it drifting away with the current and on its way to Sarn Ford. If they question any near them, they're just met

with blank looks, shrugging shoulder's and "Why don't ye ask them folk over there in Deephaller".

However they've arrived there, any welcome is quickly overstayed and unless adventurers want to find more wrecked or missing gear, or worse a quick swim in the water, they best be leaving as promptly as they entered.

Hobbit Residents of Breredon

Unlike their counterparts over the High Hay in Haysend, residents of Breredon are as they say a "fey lot". Heavy smokers, and quick to break into a game of riddles or an oration of rhyming song.

Adventurers will find a warmer welcome, but as much help as those in Haysend. Any mention of heading up the Dingle, whether by boat or by foot will be met with trepidation, fear-mongering and tales of bad omens if they do. One tale in particular will be about the great *River Wyrms* that roams the deep waters of the Withywindle, and only by the grace of the Withy-weir has it never entered and terrorized up and down the Brandywine.

The *River Wyrms* is in fact a fish, an ancient Sturgeon to be more precise, and is large and real. If any would be angler wishes to fish for it, they do so at great personal peril.

First, the angler must find it, and if they do, they must bait and coax it to bite. Once on the hook, the angler must then make the hard and difficult task of landing it safely to shore, or if lucky enough on their boat. That has its own perils, as they soon realize the large fish dwarfs their watercraft and threatens to capsize it!

Fishing for the River Wyrms

Anglers first must travel up and down the river and make a successful **AWARENESS** roll to find a suitable spot to cast their hooks. Then the angler is required to attempt a Skill Endeavour at Resistance 9, this is one tough fish to catch! The skills used are up to the Player and Loremaster, but **HUNTING**, **SCAN**, even **BATTLE** (especially when fighting to land the fish!) can be used. If at any time an Eye is rolled and the skill roll is a failure, the line or rod breaks and the equipment must be repaired before attempting the whole endeavour again from the start. Furthermore, an angler can only attempt the skill endeavour once per day as the fish dives deep and up or down the river away from them.

If a Player-hero or heroes actually land the great fish and are able to bring it back to Breredon (it requires at least 4 hobbits or 3 dwarves/elves/men, with a max Load rating to carry it and with a successful **ATHLETICS** Check each to lift and carry it over land!), are met with awe and jubilation, and quickly a great feast is prepared. Word reaches the residents of Haysend of the catch and the Angler and Company are promptly invited to the next derby as special guests of Haysend! (They want to win the next year's competition by a long shot and think the player-heroes are their winning ticket!).

Badger-brock of the Badger Folk

Badger-folk have a hidden home in the ground, not some hobbit-home but a dirty, and filthy hole located along the edges of the Withywindle. Lead by *Badger-brock*, who can speak the tongue of mortals, sporting a snowy-forehead and dark blinking eyes. Any who chance on their territory are quickly met with a great host of badgers, sons of Badger-brock, and are quickly overwhelmed and pulled down hidden and just large enough holes, and into the secret badger home, which is covered with thorny briar roses on the surface.

The captives are there kept in ransom, and only with quick wit, some treasure, and maybe *SONG* does *Badger-brock* set them free.

Otters of the Withywindle

Otters swim and roam up and down the Withywindle and are loyal allies of the Old Swan King, and love to mingle and play with Lady Goldberry, especially when she's alone and not with Old Tom! Unlike the otters found in Swanfleet, (see insert on page 19 of *Ruins of the Lost Realm*), they cannot converse with mortals, unless of course they sport one of the *Old Swan King's* feathers in their cap.

Unlike most of the fauna along and in the Dingle, the Otters are surprisingly helpful and curious of any visitors and will be playful to any who wish to play with them. Like Hobbits, they're always looking for the next opportunity to eat and are more than happy when someone gifts them food.

The Otters will always help a friend in need, and if befriended by them, will aid any who have fallen in the water and safely pull them to shore.

The Oars that Tom Bombadil Left

The man size wooden oars stick out of the mud like two branchless trees at the mouth of the Withywindle and appeared the last time Tom Bombadil was seen in the Shire proper. He had been gone 3 days when the Old Swan King, along with some otters, grabbed the rope tied to the boat and pulled it up the river. How they got it up and over the Withy-weir is anyone's guess but none in Breredon had seen how they done it.

Although Tom Bombadil doesn't mind a good jolly jaunt along the river, he does occasionally like to cock his feet up over the gunnels of the boat as he lays back with his hat pulled over his eyes, humming a tune, and chewing on a reed in the deep hot of Summer. He of course can't do that without having his oars again and owing it's not time yet to make a visit to Old Farmer Maggot and not wishing more arrow holes in his hat, he tasks the player-heroes to go and fetch the oars back!

Part 4: Homeward Bound

After the Player-heroes have retrieved the locket, they will want to return home. The first stage will be to follow Tom's path back up to his house.

Consequences

When the Player-heroes get back to Tom's house, they will find that all of their mounts have been safely gathered and looked after. Tom may even have named them.

If the Player-heroes show the locket to Tom before trying to open it themselves, he will twirl it around his fingers, and it will spring open. The Players will feel a slight chill and sense a faint shadow flying off to the north, before noticing that the locket is empty! Tom will say "Oh yes, I gave it back to the lady who brought the locket to me."

If the Player-heroes open the locket without showing it to Tom first, the effects are more dramatic. The light fades while surrounding shadows darken, and the temperature seems to suddenly drop. All Player-heroes gain 1 Shadow point (Dread) as the Cold Spirit that has just been released searches them for the ring. The Player-hero who opened the locket *loses (1d)* from their Shadow Test, because of the Darken curse. After a moment, the light and warmth return, and the Player-heroes sense a shadow passing to the north.

The Naugantdolen

After the locket has first been opened and the Cold Spirit released, the curse of Darken is lifted from it. However, the lingering taint of evil leaves another curse on the item, a curse of Ill-luck, and the release of the spirit adds a curse of Ill-omen to the Ring of the Seven Jewels. Both the curses of Ill-luck and Ill-omen can be removed by exposing the locket to "the light of hope restored" while the ring is inside it.

The Naugantdolen provides an additional benefit to the bearer of the Ring of the Seven Jewels. While the ring is carried inside the locket, the bearer does not suffer from any of its curses (although any curses on the locket itself still apply).

If any badgers or swans were killed by the Player-heroes, Tom and Goldberry will withdraw their patronage from the company until they have atoned for the misdeed. The Loremaster will need to decide exactly what this could be and fulfilling it would probably need an Adventuring Phase dedicated to it.

Epilogue

The Player-heroes will probably have a lot of questions after the last adventure. Where is the Ring of the Seven Jewels? Who was the lady that Tom mentioned? Where did that shadowy spirit go, and will it come back? Unfortunately, they will not have much time to find any answers. The following guidance can be applied to the next Fellowship Phase:

Duration

The next adventure in this campaign is set only one week later, in the autumn of 2965.

Destination

The Company will be returning Bree, their initial safe haven.

Updates

Players may spend any experience earned. They will have amassed approximately 1 Experience Point per hour of play during the previous adventure.

Player-heroes will also recover Hope points equal to their HEART score, (apart from Rangers, who only recover half of their HEART score, rounding up).

High Elves of Rivendell do not remove any Shadow points. If the Player-heroes defeated the Barrow-wight, it can be considered to have actively hindered or damaged the Enemy, so other Player-heroes can remove 2 Shadow points unless they are an Elf of Lindon, who may remove 1 point.

Undertakings

This is not a Yule Fellowship Phase, so the Company may choose one Undertaking, plus a second Free Undertaking that is allowed by the Callings of the Player-heroes.

If the Player-heroes choose the ‘Gather Rumours’ Undertaking, they may hear the rumour described at the beginning of the *Tindailin – an Elven Refuge* Landmark from *Ruins of the Lost Realm*. Alternatively, they may hear news of the betrothal of Primula Brandybuck to Drogo Baggins – their upcoming wedding is expected to be the social event of the decade in the Shire.

The Undertaking ‘Study Magical Items’ could be used to find out about the locket Naugantdolen. This will reveal both its Blessing and current Curse, plus some details about its crafting as described in the insert on page 35. It will not reveal any more details about the background of either Hanar or Nethig.

Nethig is a key character in “The Hill of the Sleeper” Landmark in *Ruins of the Lost Realm*, so this could be used as a plot hook for adventures that follow the ones detailed in this module.

Library Looting

Crime is not unheard of in Bree-land – far from it. However, major crimes are big news, and the recent incident is the talk of the town. Oswald Brecker’s mansion in Coombe has been burgled! This theft will prevent the Player-heroes from being able to investigate further clues in the Green Book until it is solved.

The Burglar and the Crime Lord

Some background is necessary for the Loremaster. Sabian has not been idle since the events of the first adventure. He has been plotting how to get his hands on the Green Book. He has contacted elements of the local underworld and engaged them to execute his plan.

Sabian has hired a local thief and outlaw called Jon-a-Leaping to break into Oswald Brecker’s home and steal all of the books with green covers from the library. He has provided Jon-a-Leaping with a pony, purchased from John Ferny, to carry the loot. Jon-a-Leaping has been instructed to take the pony to the Forsaken Inn, where he will receive payment in exchange for the pony, from a man who will identify himself with a cloak-pin fashioned with the emblem of a white hand. This man will take the loot directly south, over the South Downs. Meanwhile, Sabian has already left Bree and is heading down the Greenway, to resume his watch on the Southfarthing.

Jon-a-Leaping is a major character in the fourth adventure of *Tales from the Lone Lands*, “Not to Strike Without Need”. It is unlikely that the Player-heroes will meet him in this adventure, but it can be useful to foreshadow characters that they may encounter in the future.

Part 1: The Scene of the Crime

Early one morning, a week after returning from their recent jaunt into the Old Forest, the Player-heroes are summoned to Oswald Brecker’s house by his servant, Poppy Goatleaf. She seems to be very nervous and says, “You must come quickly!” She won’t answer any questions directly, but just keeps repeating “The Master says you must come straight away!” and “Oh dear, such a mess!”

Poppy Goatleaf

Poppy is a girl in her late teens and her family has served the Breckers for generations. She lives in the servant quarters of Oswald’s house with her mother and father.

NAME: Poppy Goatleaf

OCCUPATION: Servant

TRAITS: Timid, Loyal

Smashed Glass and Broken Relationships

When the Player-heroes arrive at Oswald's house, he is waiting outside for them. It is plain to see that he is furious.

"Look at this mess! I agree to let you use my library and this is how I'm rewarded. Thieves breaking into my house and stealing my precious books! I've a good mind to call the Reeve and have you driven out of Bree-land."

"It's obvious that you led the thieves here, and who's to say you're not in league with them? Now, get out of my sight and don't bother coming back without my books!"

With that he turns his back on the Player-heroes and storms off back into his home, slamming the door behind him. Poppy waits for a moment and then says:

"Please help him. His bark is really much worse than his bite!"

The Player-heroes can see a broken window to the library where Oswald had been pointing. A successful **SCAN** roll will allow a Player-hero to find some footprints in the flowerbed outside the broken window. These are quite easy to find, so the roll *gains* (1d). A failure can be converted to a Success with Woe, but then it won't be possible to tell that the tracks are man-sized and indicate there was a single burglar.

If the Player-heroes want to search inside the library, they must first make a successful **PERSUADE** roll to convince Poppy to let them in. Alternatively, a Player-hero could make a **STEALTH** roll to climb in through the broken window without being noticed. A Treasure-Seeker's *Burglary* Trait would certainly be applicable to this situation. Simple failures will mean they are denied access or immediately chased out and cannot be converted into a Success with Woe in this case.

Inside, the library is a mess. There are books scattered around the room and the contents of the desk drawers have tossed onto the floor. A successful **SCAN** or **RIDDLE** roll will reveal that there are no books with green covers left in the room. On a Great Success, the Player-hero will also notice that the door to the library is open, but the key is in the lock on the hallway side. This suggests the key was used to open the door in the morning, after the break-in.

Back outside, the Player-heroes can attempt to follow the tracks using **SCAN** or **HUNTING**. The tracks are fresh and not difficult to follow because the person was carrying a heavy load, so a failure can be converted to a Success with Woe at the expense of taking much more time (most of the day). The tracks lead down Coombe valley to the old, ruined High House of Coombe. Here, the tracks are joined by those of a pony or horse, and they continue on together, northwards towards the Chetwood.

If the Player-heroes want to question any of the villagers of Coombe, they will find them very reluctant to talk. A successful COURTESY, PERSUADE or RIDDLE will be required to get any answers out of them. Then the Player-heroes will learn that nobody actually saw anything last night. If the Player-heroes mention the High House, they will be warned to stay away from it, because it's haunted – some even hint that it is the ghost of Oswald's wife!

Following the Leads

The Player-heroes now need to decide how to continue their investigations. They could immediately set off in pursuit of the thief, following the tracks towards the Chetwood. But it may be better to wait until the morning, especially if it is already late. Going back to Bree to gather their travelling gear and prepare for a journey into the wild would also give them the opportunity to ask a few questions in town.

If spending the evening in the Prancing Pony, the main topic of conversation is the burglary. Gossip is easily overheard:

"Well, I reckon it was one of them Rangers. D'you think it was a coincidence that there were none of them in the Pony last night?"

This is a commonly held view and receives many nods and murmurs of approval. A successful RIDDLE roll will get one of the regulars to reveal the following:

"I saw a sallow-faced Southerner talking with Jon-a-Leaping over in the corner there, a couple of nights ago. If half the stories about Jon are true, they were up to no good. They were talking to John Ferny later on."

The description of the 'sallow-faced Southerner' sounds like the pipe-weed merchant that was sat with some Hobbits in the Sparrow's Nest, during the adventure of *The Inheritance*. John is at his usual spot at the bar, so can be asked about the conversation he had:

"Jon said the Southerner wanted to buy a horse. Didn't catch his name, but his money is as good as yours – better, maybe! I haven't seen either of them since the following morning."

"If you think they had anything to do with the burglary, you're mad. Bert there is right – it was one of them Rangers, no doubt."

Further details about John Ferny can be found on page 184 of *The One Ring*.

If the Player-heroes make enquiries around town, a successful PERSUADE roll when talking to a gatekeeper will reveal that the Southerner was seen leaving through the West Gate the previous morning, heading south down the Greenway. Nobody appears to have seen Jon-a-Leaping since then either.

Part 2: On the Trail

At some point, the Player-heroes will want to follow the trail left by the burglar, leading north into the Chetwood. This will be a journey using the rules on pages 108-114 of *The One Ring*. However, as the Company doesn't know their destination, they won't know their Journey Path to begin with. The red line on the map below shows the trail they will be following.



The Player-heroes will need to make a successful **HUNTING** roll to advance to the next hex on the map. A failure will result in the loss of a day, while they search for the lost tracks. Any *Tengwar* rolled can be used to make haste, which allows them to Forced March for that part of the journey (see page 111 of *The One Ring*). Alternatively, a *Tengwar* could be used to gain insight, giving more information about those who left the tracks.

When the Guide makes Marching Tests to work out where Travel Events occur, count the number of **HUNTING** rolls made by the Company to follow the tracks instead of the number of hexes on the route.

Through the Chetwood

Following the tracks through the Chetwood will require two successful **HUNTING** rolls. The tracks turn east shortly after entering the woods and pass south of Archet. They eventually turn south again before reaching the Midgewater Marshes.

If the **HUNTING** roll for the second hex is a failure, apply the result of *Sinkhole* from the **Travelling in the Chetwood** table on page 189 of *The One Ring*. This will occur when the companions miss the turn to the south and venture too close to the Midgewater Marshes. It affects the Player-hero who failed the **HUNTING** roll and anyone who Supported them. Allow a successful **ATHLETICS** roll to reduce the Fatigue gained from this event by 1, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled.

This is hard terrain, and it isn't possible to ride quickly through, so it will take two days to reach the Great East Road without Forced Marching.

Using a *Tengwar* to gain insight on a successful HUNTING roll will reveal that the person they are following was not really trying to hide their tracks. They were more focused on moving quickly.

At the Forsaken Inn

The tracks emerge from the Chetwood on the Great East Road, close to the Forsaken Inn. There is no other habitation anywhere near here, so this must have been where the thief was heading for.

Jon-a-Leaping arrived at the Forsaken Inn and met his contact the evening after the burglary. Both left first thing the following morning. It will not be possible for the Player-heroes to encounter them before they leave. Even if the Player-heroes follow the tracks as soon as they find them and forced march through the Chetwood, they will only be able to reach the Forsaken Inn at about lunchtime on the day after Jon's meeting. It is more likely that the Player-heroes will arrive an evening or two later.

A detailed outline of The Forsaken Inn is given on pages 190 and 192 of *The One Ring*. When the Player-heroes arrive, they find just two other people there; the proprietor, Jack the Forsaken, and a Dwarf named Jari. If the company arrives in the evening both can be found in the bar but if they arrive earlier in the day, they will notice Jari carrying out some work on the outbuildings of the Inn.

Asking Jack for information will require a suitable skill roll – AWE, COURTESY, PERSUADE or RIDDLE could all be used, although Jack is not easily intimidated, so an Awe roll would *lose* (1d). A failure cannot be changed into a Success with Woe, but another Player-hero could attempt another approach using a different skill to the one just failed. The following outcomes are possible:

Failure: Jack says *"I mind my own business and I expect my guests to do the same. Now, what do you want to drink?"*

Success: Jack says *"Yes, there were a couple of travellers in that night. They kept to themselves. Do you want any stew before I close the kitchen?"*

Great or Extraordinary Success: Jack says *"Yes, there were a couple of travellers in that night. They left in the morning, before breakfast. If you're staying the night, I can give you the luxury bedding for an extra penny."*

Jack is not very big on conversation. Jari, on the other hand, appears to welcome the company of the Player-heroes. A conversation with him can be run as a Council:

Resistance: The Player-heroes are making a bold request as Jari apparently has little to gain, so the Resistance for this Council is 6.

Introduction: COURTESY or RIDDLE are the most appropriate skills in this situation. RIDDLE would be better if the Company doesn't want to reveal too much about themselves. If the Player-heroes choose AWE, treat this as an automatic failure.

If the Introduction Skill roll is a failure, the Player-heroes will have a time limit equal to 3. If it is a success, the time limit will be equal to 4, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled on the Success dice.

Jari introduces himself with a flamboyant bow, "*Jari, son of Jarin, at your service.*" He claims to be a noted explorer and treasure-finder but is just doing a bit of smith-work between jobs.

Interaction: Jari's default attitude will be **Open**. This will improve to **Friendly** if any of the Player-heroes offer to buy him a drink, in which case rolls *gain* (1d). Player-heroes with a Frugal Standard of Living do not have the option of offering to buy Jari a drink.

The Player-heroes may propose any interaction skills to use, but COURTESY, PERSUADE and RIDDLE are probably most appropriate. A successful INSIGHT roll will reveal that Jari is trying to learn as much as he can about the Player-heroes while they are questioning him. He will often follow his answers with a question of his own.

The following outcomes are possible:

Disaster: Jari can tell the company that he saw two men in the bar, but they won't learn any more from him than they did from Jack.

Success with Woe: Jari will tell the Player-heroes that the following morning, one of the men headed west towards Bree, but the other one didn't take the road – he headed off south, towards the South Downs. Jari has also succeeded in learning quite a lot about the Player-heroes, which he will try to sell on to Sabian sometime in the future.

Success: Jari will tell the Player-heroes about the directions of the men when they left, as above. He will also tell the Player-heroes that he overheard them talking the previous evening. He heard the name 'Sabian' mentioned and the man who headed south left with the pony that the other man brought, after handing over a large amount of money.

A successful Scan roll outside will confirm that there are fresh tracks of a man and pony leading away from the Forsaken Inn to the south.

Jari is another character from *Tales from the Lone Lands*. He has a major role in the first adventure, "A Troll-hole, If Ever There Was One".

Into the South Downs

It should be obvious to the Player-heroes that the books are being carried on the pony. Following the tracks leading south will require two more successful **HUNTING** rolls. If the Council with Jari was a Success, the first roll *gains (2d)*, but if it was a Success with Woe, it only *gains (1d)*.

Most of this part of the journey is across open ground, perfect for riding. However, it is difficult to track while mounted, so a *Tengwar* from the **HUNTING** roll would need to be spent to benefit from the extra pace of for being mounted. A second *Tengwar* could be spent to also forced march.

The Player-heroes may want to take a more cautious approach, in which case a *Tengwar* could be spent to proceed stealthily, using the natural cover of the rolling countryside.

Using a *Tengwar* to gain insight on a successful **HUNTING** roll will reveal that the person they are following appears to be familiar with the area and is moving as quickly as he can.

The final hex of the tracks that the company is following enters the South Downs, which counts as difficult terrain for travel purposes. The South Downs are described on page 198 of *The One Ring*.

If the Player-heroes set off on the trail from Coombe immediately, have not failed any of their **TRACKING** rolls and have Forced Marched all the way, then they will have almost caught up with their quarry by this stage. Lookouts can make an **AWARENESS** roll. With a successful roll they notice a man in a grey cloak leading a pony up a valley, a couple of miles ahead of them. Suddenly, the man falls to the ground and a large wolf leaps at the pony, ripping its throat out. A pair of Goblins search the man and grab the saddlebags, before slinking off out of sight, up the valley.

If the Player-heroes have had any delays to their journey, then they will start the next part of the adventure at Location #1.

Apply Travel Fatigue before proceeding to the Landmark in Part 3. Each Player-hero may make a **TRAVEL** roll to reduce any Fatigue gained and may further reduce Fatigue by the Vigour of their mount if they have one. Don't forget to apply any additional Fatigue for Forced Marching.

Part 3: Outpost of the Howling Hollows

Rumour

There's nothing but thin grass and flintstones in the South Downs. And those mists that roll over from the Barrow-downs to the west will make you sick, sure as Butterbur will forget his own birthday if he doesn't write it down!

Old Lore

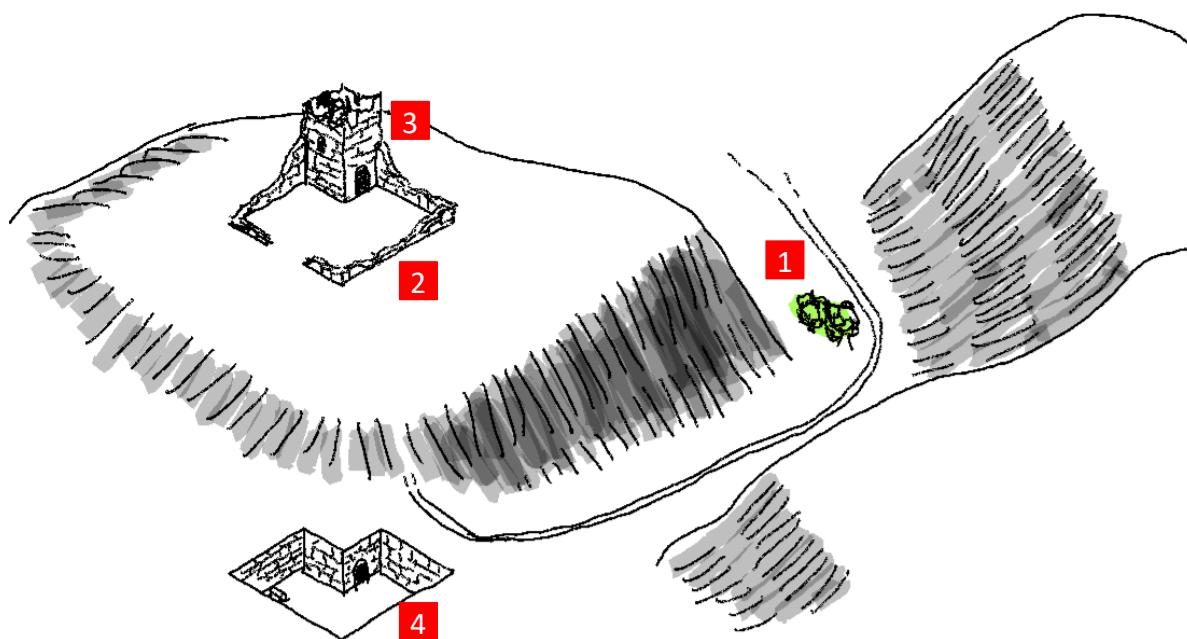
The South Downs were once on the northern borders of the old Kingdom of Cardolan. Watchtowers were built on the summits of the higher hills, to guard against attack from the sister kingdoms of Arthedain and Rhudaur. Later, they served as sentinels against the armies of Angmar. But Cardolan fell over 1,500 years ago, and all that is left in the South Downs now are crumbling ruins.

Background

The name of this place is long forgotten. It was once one of the watchtowers built by Cardolan to guard its northern borders. But it was taken by the same Orc-host that defeated the army of Cardolan and slayed their last king on the Barrow Downs in the year 1409. The forces of Angmar slighted its defences and the ruins have been left to crumble in the centuries since.

More recently the ruins have been reoccupied by Orcs and Wolves of the Howling Hollows (see pages 198-199 of *The One Ring* for more details of these enemies). The hills of the South Downs are quite bare, but these ruins offer perfect cover to keep watch on anyone approaching the caves of the Howling Hollows from the north or west. From the remains of the tower it is possible to see as far as the Midgewater Marshes and even the peak of Weathertop beyond.

Locations



1. Valley

The northern edges of the South Downs are steep, scarp slopes, imposing a moderate hindrance on any skill rolls attempted while on them, *losing (1d)*. This valley is the easiest way to travel into the South Downs at this point, offering a much gentler incline with no penalties to skill rolls.

Halfway up the valley, just as it bends round to the west, lie two bodies. The first is a man, who has been shot with two arrows. A successful **LORE** roll will tell that these are Orc arrows, and a successful **HEALING** roll will indicate that the arrows were poisoned. The man wore a grey cloak, fastened with a clasp fashioned in the shape of a white hand. It is clear that the body has been searched and anything valuable has been taken.

The second is a pony, which has been half-eaten by wolves. The saddlebags have also been taken. A successful **SCAN** or **HUNTING** roll will find tracks nearby, leading off up the valley. A Great Success or better will reveal that they were made by a pair of Wolves and a pair of Orcs.

Any failed rolls when searching the ambush site can be turned into a Success with Woe, at the penalty of being spotted by the sentry at location #3 below.

2. Ruins

Most of the walls of these ruins only rise a few feet above the ground, but they offer some good shelter. The three Wolves accompanying the Orcs have made their den here.

3. Watchtower Stairs

This is the most intact corner of the watchtower remaining above ground. A spiral staircase led up to the higher floors, which have long since collapsed. However, the top of the

staircase provides a great vantage point to spy on the surrounding countryside in secrecy. When the Orcs are present there is always a keen-eyed Goblin Archer posted here.

4. Cellar

The staircase also leads down to the cellar. This is where the Orcs can usually be found, if not on watch. The remaining garrison is another Goblin Archer and an Orc Soldier. They keep a fire lit, with a large pot suspended above it. This fire provides the only light.

The saddlebags from the pony containing the stolen books have been thrown in a corner. There are two saddlebags, each of 2 Load. There is also a chest containing a *Lesser Hoard*.

Schemes and Trouble

Approaching the Ruins

Stalking up to the watchtower without being noticed is difficult. The approach offering the most cover is up the valley. Each Player-hero must make a **STEALTH** roll. The Goblin Archer lookout's *Keen-eyed* trait imposes a penalty to rolls, which will *lose (1d)*. If any of the rolls to search the ambush site resulted in Success with Woe, the **STEALTH** rolls will *lose (1d)* in addition. However, if the Player-heroes approached location #1 stealthily on their journey then they will *gain (2d)*. Any *Tengwars* gained on successful rolls can be used to widen influence to other Player-heroes who failed their rolls.

If the Player-heroes succeed in approaching the ruins without being noticed, they may attempt to prepare for a surprise attack (see page 95 of *The One Ring*). Player-heroes may use either **STEALTH** or **BATTLE** skills and again, any *Tengwars* gained on successful rolls can be used to widen influence. These rolls will also *lose (1d)* due to the keen-eyed lookout.

The Player-heroes can also decide whether to launch their attack in daylight or under the cover of darkness. If they prepare their ambush in the dark, their **STEALTH** or **BATTLE** rolls will *gain (2d)*.

Send in the Burglar

Another alternative, if the Company has successfully approached the ruins without being noticed, is to try to sneak in and retrieve the stolen books. This would require a series of skill rolls at a Hazardous risk level, with failures resulting in immediate discovery.

A **STEALTH** roll is required to sneak into the ruins undetected. This roll will *lose (1d)* because the Goblin Archers and Wild Wolves are keen-eyed, but this penalty can be cancelled if the burglar waits until night-time and the cover of darkness. A success will allow the Player-hero to reach the entrance to the stairs undetected. They can see a dim glow of firelight from below and with a Great Success on an **AWARENESS** roll (at Standard risk level) they will hear faint shuffling from above.

Another **STEALTH** roll is required to creep up or down the stairs. This roll will *gain (1d)* because the stairs are dark. Successfully sneaking up the stairs will allow the Player-hero to

ambush the Goblin Archer sentry. This surprise attack will be too close to allow any Opening Volleys, but the close quarters attack will *gain (2d)* because the Player-hero can strike from behind. If the Goblin Archer is defeated by the first blow, the Player-hero has eliminated them silently.

If creeping down the stairs, a *Tengwar* gained for the *STEALTH* roll may be used to gain insight. This will allow the Player-hero to see the Orc Soldier and Goblin Archer by the fire, and the saddlebags flung in the opposite corner over a small chest. Otherwise, a successful *SCAN* roll will be required to see where the saddlebags are before entering the cellar. Having spotted the saddlebags, the Player-hero may attempt another *Stealth* roll to sneak into the cellar while the Orcs have their backs turned and retrieve them.

More *STEALTH* rolls will be required to go up or down the stairs again, and to sneak back out of the ruins without being noticed. The same modifiers will apply to these rolls as when sneaking in.

Assaulting the Outpost

This picket of the Howling Hollow consists of two Goblin Archers and three Wild Wolves, led by an Orc Soldier. Details of these can be found on pages 150 and 156 of *The One Ring*. This garrison may not seem large but can be a significant challenge to a fairly inexperienced company, especially if they are expecting to be attacked.

If surprised, the Orcs and Wolves will be found at the locations indicated above. If they are expecting attack because the Player-heroes' approach was spotted, the Orcs in the cellar will have joined the Wolves in their den. If the approach was not spotted but the surprise attack was unsuccessful, the Orcs in the cellar will spend the time during the Opening Volleys to join the Wolves.

Bow-armed Player-heroes may take two shots in the Opening Volleys and others may throw one spear. The Goblin Archer lookout will also get two shots if not surprised. The other Goblin Archer and the Orc Soldier will only get to shoot Opening Volleys if they were prepared for the attack.

The Goblin Archer lookout's vantage point gives them a *Moderate Advantage* for their attacks and their cover gives a *Severe Hindrance* to shots aimed at them. If prepared for the attack, the Orcs and Wolves in close combat have a *Moderate Advantage* for defending the broken walls of the watchtower (see the Complications table on page 102 of *The One Ring*).

In the first round it will only be possible to engage anyone on the ground floor in close combat. It takes a full Action to reach the entrance to the staircase and Wolves will try to attack them, using their Great Leap Fell Ability if necessary. It takes a further round to reach the Goblin Archer sentry or the cellar, and the Wolves will not follow them onto the stairs.

During the daytime, any Orcs not in the cellar or on the staircase will suffer from their Hate Sunlight Fell Ability. They are originally from Goblin Gate, so they also have the Hatred (Dwarves) Fell Ability.

The Orcs and Wolves will try to flee after three of them have been defeated or if all survivors are Weary.

Reinforcements

If any Wolves or Orcs escape from the Player-heroes' assault, they will return the following night with reinforcements. In addition to the escapees, who will be returned to full strength, there will be another four Wild Wolves carrying an Orc Guard, two Orc Soldiers and another Goblin Archer. The Player-heroes may make an **AWARENESS** roll to spot the approaching force and anyone at the top of the spiral staircase will *gain (1d)* for this roll.

The Player-heroes have a choice – defend the ruins or run.

Part 4: Homeward Bound

To Bree

If the Player-heroes did not let any Orcs or Wolves escape from the watchtower, then they will have an uneventful journey back to Bree. If any opponents did escape but the Player-heroes leave the watchtower before the reinforcements arrive, they will be pursued across the country until about 20 miles from Bree.

Run the chase as a Laborious Skill Endeavour (Resistance 6) requiring **ATHLETICS** rolls. The time limit is determined as follows:

- If the Company was at the watchtower and didn't notice the reinforcements approaching, then there is not enough time, and the time limit is equal to 3.
- If the Company was at the watchtower and spotted the reinforcements approaching, there is little time, and the time limit is set to 4.
- If the Company left the watchtower before sundown the following night there is enough time, and the time limit is set to 5.
- If the Company left the watchtower before sundown the following night and specify that that they are forced marching there is more than enough time, and the time limit is set to 6.

A Player-hero may not make a second roll to contribute to the Skill Endeavour until all other Player-heroes have made a roll. If they fail to obtain enough successes before the time limit is reached, their pursuers catch them, and they must fight a battle. Any Player Heroes who flee the battle using the rules described in the 'Fly, You Fools' insert on page 104 of *The One Ring* will be able to reach Bree safely.

Overdue Library Books?

Oswald will be delighted by the return of his books. This may be the first time that the Player-heroes have seen him smile!

"It seems that I underestimated you and owe you an apology. Consider the doors to my library open to you at any time."

Epilogue

The Player-heroes will now be entering their first Yule Fellowship Phase:

Duration

The next adventure in this campaign will be in the Spring of the following year, 2966.

Destination

There is more than enough time for all Player-heroes to return to their homes for the Winter, before reconvening in Bree in the Spring.

Updates

Players may spend any experience earned. They will have amassed approximately 1 Experience Point per hour of play during the previous adventure. They will earn additional Skill Points equal to their *WITS* rating, because it is Yule.

Player-heroes will also recover all of their Hope points.

If the Player-heroes did not allow any Orcs or Wolves to escape from the watchtower, they can be considered to have actively hindered or damaged the Enemy. All Player-heroes (including High Elves of Rivendell) can remove 2 Shadow points, except Elves of Lindon, who may only remove 1 point.

Otherwise, they may all remove 1 Shadow point.

Undertakings

This is a Yule Fellowship Phase, so each Player-hero may choose one Undertaking, plus the Company may choose an additional Free Undertaking that is allowed by the Callings of the Player-heroes.

There are several Undertakings that are only available in a Yule Fellowship Phase:

- Any Player-hero who has gained a Shadow Scar may want to remove it using the 'Heal Scars' Undertaking.
- If a Player-hero has found a Famous Weapon or Armour, they may want to choose the 'Visit the Treasury of Your Folk' Undertaking to unlock additional Qualities.
- A Player-hero who wants to change one of their Distinctive Features may choose the 'Recount a Story' Undertaking.
- A Player-hero may choose the 'Raise an Heir' Undertaking, but their first Yule Fellowship Phase is probably a bit early for this.

If any of the Player-heroes choose the ‘Gather Rumours’ Undertaking, they may hear the rumour described at the beginning of the *Star of the Mist* Landmark from *The One Ring*. Another possibility if there is an archer in the Company is that they may hear about the reputation of Archet Hunting Bows.

Alternatively, they may hear the rumour described at the beginning of the *Mines of Brockenbores* Landmark written by Ryan of the North. Note that one of the key protagonists of *Mines of Brockenbores* is called Erling Goldworthy. He must have been related to the late Tobias Goldworthy, which provides the Loremaster with another hook for this Landmark.

New Fellowship Undertaking: Research Lore

This Undertaking may be used to research obscure lore, such as the Old Lore for Landmarks. The Player-heroes carrying out the Undertaking must be at a location with an appropriate source of learning, such as a library, a group of wise elders or perhaps a Patron. Players specify the subject they are researching and the Loremaster gives them the relevant information. If the information is not available at this site, the Loremaster confirms this, but may instead provide details about where the information could be found.

This is a Standard Fellowship Undertaking and counts as a Free Undertaking for Scholars.

Player-heroes may use the new ‘Research Lore’ Undertaking to follow up on the rumour about the *Tindailin – an Elven Refuge* Landmark from *Ruins of the Lost Realm*, they may learn the Old Lore about that Landmark. This could be learnt from Goldberry by someone staying in Bree, by an Elf of Lindon returning to the Grey Havens or by a High Elf in Rivendell.

The Player-heroes may also wish to research more about the Ring of the Seven Jewels in Oswald Brecker’s library. If so, they will learn from the Green Book that the ring was a plain band of gold, and that Berelas was the only person who could safely carry it without being attacked by the Cold Shade. However, the Shade would also be summoned if she tried to use it. Berelas had once visited Gorlanc’s fortress up in the North Downs, but she was being escorted to his new base, which was somewhere in the northern Weather Hills. Further research will be required to find out more about Berelas and what happened after the adventures of Tobias’ Company.

The ‘Meet Patron’ Undertaking could also be used to talk to any of the company’s current Patrons. This can be used to change their nominated Patron before their next adventure.

The Passage of the Years

If the Loremaster is intending to use any of the campaign ideas in *Ruins of the Lost Realm*, they may provide the players with relevant information for 2965 from the ‘Dark Designs’ sections of *Chapter 2, A Gathering Storm*.

Any Player-heroes that returned home to Wilderland will hear that Dwarves have discovered gold in the Mountains of Mirkwood, and that travel in the Upper Vales of Anduin is safer than it has been for many years.

Strangely, nothing more is heard of the Orcs and Wargs encountered by the Player-heroes in the South Downs. It is generally assumed that they must have been part of a scouting party that has returned to their dens in the Misty Mountains.

Where To Next?

If you want to run the adventures in this supplement as a self-contained mini campaign, then run the next adventure will be Firework Theft, which can take place in the Spring of 2966. However, if you intend to broaden the scope of your campaign, Firework Theft can be delayed until the Summer. This gives time to insert another adventure beforehand.

Three suggestions are given here, but you should be led by the direction that your players appear to be going in. This may be indicated by choices made in previous Fellowship Phases and could be influenced by the Company's Patrons.

Suggestion 1: Tindailin – An Elven Refuge

This Landmark is contained in *Ruins of the Lost Realm*. The Player-heroes may want to investigate it themselves if they have already heard rumours about it, and even more so if they have researched its Old Lore. The Loremaster could give the Player-heroes an extra nudge in this direction if they have an appropriate Patron:

- Goldberry may ask the Player-heroes to investigate the area, because her mother is worried about an old friend.
- Círdan may ask the Player-heroes to go, as he his foresight tells him some of his people will need their help.
- Gilraen may ask the Player-heroes to investigate. The Rangers watching Sarn Ford have noticed disturbances in the area, but she does not want them to reveal their strength in the area.

A successful outcome to this adventure would provide further plot hooks that could be followed up after the completion of the Green Book campaign.

Suggestion 2: Mines of Brockenbores

This Landmark is written by Ryan of the North and is freely available to download. The Player-heroes may already have heard rumours about it and Patrons like Bilbo or Gandalf may ask them to get involved.

Perhaps the simplest way for the Loremaster to steer the Player-heroes in that direction is to have Erling Goldworthy to contact them directly. As a nephew of Tobias, he could have heard about the Company and they would sound like just the people he needs to discreetly investigate recent events.

Suggestion 3: Quest for an Archet Hunting Bow

If the Player-heroes are interested in acquiring an Archet Hunting Bow, the Loremaster could devise a short adventure based on the information provided on page 188 of *The One Ring*. This could involve a Council with Fitch Talltree, a short Journey through the Chetwood (perhaps with an event from the table on page 189), then a Skill Endeavour to track their quarry, culminating in a Combat that is complicated by the need to protect Fitch.

It is not forbidden to undertake more than three adventures per year, so more than one adventure could be inserted before the next one in this supplement. However, a Loremaster should consider how additional Adventure and Fellowship Phases before the next Yule Fellowship Phase will affect the Player-heroes. For example, it could have a significant impact on a High Elf of Rivendell who can only remove Shadow at Yule, or a Ranger who recovers Hope at half the rate of other Player-heroes in normal Fellowship Phases.

Firework Theft

The talk in common room of the Prancing Pony for the past few weeks has been dominated by news from the Shire. The social event of the year, the wedding of Drogo Baggins to Primula Brandybuck, is fast approaching and supplies have been making their way to Buckland from all over the Shire and beyond. Businesses in Bree have benefited, and some merchants have come from as far as Dale, across the Misty Mountains. The family connections between Drogo and the famous Bilbo Baggins have been discussed, leading to telling many versions of the story of his adventures with the dragon!

What is not so well-known is that the increase in traffic has attracted the attention of a number of unsavoury characters. A gang of bandits has recently set up operations between Bree and the Bridge of Stonebows and so far, the Rangers have not noticed them...

Part 1: Tales from the Taproom

The Player-heroes find themselves in the Prancing Pony one late spring or early summer evening. The increase in traffic through Bree, for which the upcoming wedding in Buckland is more than partly responsible, finds the Common Room full to overflowing and the Taproom has been opened to accommodate the overspill. Among the more notable locals, Fitch Talltree (see page 188 of *The One Ring*) is sharing a drink with Cole Pickthorn (see page 184 of *The One Ring*), and Barnabas Butterbur is doing his best to pay more than his fair share of attention to the Reeve's table. In a shady corner of the other side of the room John Ferny is drinking with a few other residents of the East Row. The little folk are well represented by several Tunnellys from Staddle, ostensibly in Bree to make arrangements for the Summer Smoke Ring Festival on behalf of Grandmother Tunnelly, the head of their family.

The Tunnellys are having a loud, good-natured debate about the merits of different types of pipe-weed with a small company of visitors from Buckland. Sitting nearby and contributing a comment or two is a party of Dwarves who are returning from the east. Smoke rings intermittently rise above the heads of all three groups. Player-heroes who wish to join in the conversation may find themselves challenged to an impromptu smoke ring blowing contest (use the rules on page 4 of *The Shire* supplement from the Starter Set, or 'The Summer Smoke Ring Festival' insert on page 187 of *The One Ring*).

Anyone not discussing pipe-weed and smoke rings seem to be talking about the upcoming wedding, especially the Hobbit drinkers. Several residents of Bree-land have cousins from Buckland and there is much speculation about who has (and hasn't) been invited. There is also interest from the Big Folk, but this is more focused on who is being asked to provide services and catering supplies.

A Shocking Interruption

At some point in the evening there is a sudden commotion at the entrance. Three Dwarves burst into the room, helping a couple of men who are clearly shaken. One of the Dwarves loudly announces, “There’s been a robbery on the road!”

The eyes of most people naturally turn to the table where the Reeve and the Forester are sitting for a response. Cole stands up and greets the Dwarves, who introduce themselves as Ail, Alni and Alvir. Ail is the eldest and acts as their spokesman.

“We found these two about forty miles west of here, bound and blindfolded by the roadside.”

Ail and Alvir are two more characters from *Tales from the Lone Lands*. They both have minor roles in the fifth adventure, “Wonder of the Northern World”. If you intend to run that campaign, Alni could be one of the dead bodies discovered in that adventure.

When Cole asks the two men who they are, they say they are Reinald and Egil, two merchants from Dale.

“We set out from Bree three days ago, with a cart full of merchandise ordered by Gandalf the Wizard. He warned us not to be late, but we were ambushed by a gang of bandits hiding behind the hedge!”

There is loud murmuring in the room and John Ferny can be heard saying “That’ll be them Rangers, I shouldn’t wonder” to general agreement. Meanwhile, Cole and Fitch glance at each other.

A successful **INSIGHT** roll will reveal that the Reeve and the Forester would like to help but can’t seem to say this. A Great or Extraordinary Success (or a successful **RIDDLE** roll afterwards) will tell the Player-heroes that this is because the crime occurred beyond the borders of Bree-land. Either way, they would really like someone to volunteer to help.

Something Must Be Done

At this point, the Player-heroes may want to step forward and talk to the witnesses directly. If they need any prompting, the Reeve will ask “Is anyone here willing to help these people recover their property?” If they remain quiet, someone will point at the Company and say “What about them? Didn’t they solve the break-in at Oswald Breker’s house last year, over in Coombe?” All eyes will now be on the Player-heroes and the rest of the interaction will be run as a Council.

Resistance: The default Resistance for this Council is 3. However, if the Player-heroes think to ask for a substantial reward (equivalent to a Greater Hoard), this would be a Bold Request, increasing the Resistance to 6.

Introduction: *COURTESY* or *AWE* would be especially appropriate in this situation. If the Company stepped forward without any prompting, this roll will *gain (1d)*.

If the Introduction Skill roll is a failure, the Player-heroes will have a time limit equal to 3. If it is a success, the time limit will be equal to 4, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled on the Success dice.

Interaction: The default attitude will be **Reluctant** because the Bardings are still shaken up by their experience, so rolls will *lose (1d)*. This will improve to **Open** if the Player-heroes offer the Bardings a strong drink or ask Barnabas to use one of his private rooms. It will improve to **Friendly** if they do both, in which case rolls *gain (1d)*.

The attitude of the Dwarves will be **Open** if the Player-heroes talk to them.

ENHEARTEN, *PERSUADE*, *INSIGHT* and *RIDDLE* are all skills that could be especially useful. For each success gained while talking to the Bardings, one of the following pieces of information is learnt:

- More than half of the merchandise on their cart was a consignment of fireworks made to Gandalf's specifications.
- The Bardings sensed there were a lot of bandits (at least twice as many as the Player-heroes), but didn't get a good look at any before they were blindfolded.
- Reinald says he would recognise the two who leapt out of the hedge to stop them, if he saw them again.
- Egil heard one of them say "Ned, take the cart back to the camp with the others. Jon – come with me."

If the Player-heroes obtain any successes while talking to the Dwarves, they will learn the following:

- The Dwarves did not pass anyone on the road after they left the Shire, before seeing the Bardings.
- The tracks of the cart clearly showed that the bandits had left the road and taken it north.

The following outcomes are possible:

Success: The Reeve promises to pay the Player-heroes a reward (a Greater Hoard if that is what they negotiated, or a Lesser Hoard if not). The Bardings also offer a Lesser Hoard as a reward for returning their stolen goods and escorting it to Buckleberry. In addition, if the Player-heroes initially stepped forward without any prompting, Fitch will invite any archers among them to Archet on their return, to

give them the opportunity to prove themselves worthy of an Archet Hunting Bow (see page 188 of *The One Ring*).

Success with Woe: The Reeve will only agree to pay the Player-heroes Lesser Hoard as a reward. The Bardings will also offer another Lesser Hoard as a reward for returning their stolen goods and escorting it to Buckleberry.

Disaster: Cole and Fitch are unimpressed by the Player-heroes. However, the Bardings are desperate and will still offer a Lesser Hoard as a reward for returning their stolen goods and escorting it to Buckleberry.

Part 2: On the Trail Again

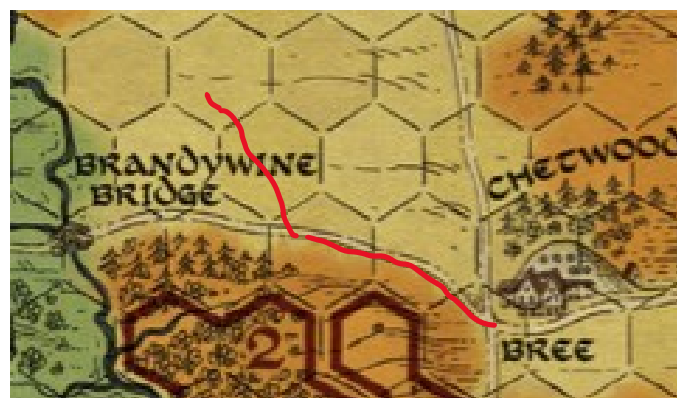
The Player-heroes now need to plan their hunt for the bandits. The obvious first step is to travel to the scene of the crime, where the bandits ambushed the Bardings on the East Road. Reinald and Egil will accompany the Player-heroes unless they are specifically asked to stay in Bree. However, they don't have any weapons or useful equipment (this was all taken from them by the bandits).

On the East Road

The site of the ambush is about 40 miles to the west of Bree, on the road leading to the Shire. It would normally take two days to reach. If the Player-heroes all have fast mounts, or if they decide to forced march, they could get there in one day. If they have fast mounts and forced march, then they could get there in half a day.

Remember that if Reinald and Egil are accompanying the Player-heroes, they don't have any mounts of their own. However, they will both be keen to make haste and will press the Player-heroes to go as fast as they can. Egil will constantly remind them that "You don't want to keep a Wizard waiting!"

The journey will use the rules on pages 108-114 of *The One Ring*. The Company doesn't know their final destination when they set out, but the red line on the map below shows the trail they will be following.



A few miles before they reach the ambush site, the Player-heroes will notice a large flock of crows in the hedgerow to the south of the road. They caw loudly while flitting from tree to tree, seemingly following the company. Just before the Company reaches their objective, the crows suddenly take to the sky and fly off to the south, into the Old Forest.

At this point the Company may resolve their first Travel Event, if their Guide failed the first Marching Test. The Event occurs in a Wild Land and the Company is on a road, so the roll to resolve it would *gain (1d)*.

When the Company reaches the site of the ambush, they may make a *SCAN* roll to search for clues. They will *lose (1d)* if they took more than one day to reach the site, but they will *gain (1d)* if the Bardings are with them. A failure could be changed into a Success with Woe, so the following outcomes are possible:

Success with Woe: The Player-heroes spend some time trampling over any remaining clues before identifying where the cart was pulled off the road to the north-west.

Success: In addition to the cart tracks, the Player-heroes identify some of the hiding places used by the bandits, confirming the story that the Bardings and Dwarves told them. This includes the information that the bandit gang is about twice the size of the Company.

Great or Extraordinary Success: In addition to the above, the Player-heroes identify where a couple of horses were tied up behind the hedgerow to the south. They see that two bandits made off on horseback, heading east.

Hedgerows and Hillsides

The Player-heroes will need to make a successful *HUNTING* roll to follow the cart tracks beyond the road and another to advance to the next hex on the map. A failure will result in the loss of a day, while they search for the lost tracks. Any *Tengwars* rolled can be used in the following ways:

- To make haste, which allows the Company to Forced March for that part of the journey (see page 111 of *The One Ring*).
- To go quietly, allowing the Company to avoid being noticed.
- To gain insight, giving more information about those who left the tracks, such as the precise number of bandits they are following.

When the Guide makes Marching Tests to work out where Travel Events occur, after leaving the road count the number of *HUNTING* rolls made by the Company to follow the tracks instead of the number of hexes on the route.

It is possible for the Company to follow the bandit tracks back to their camp without triggering any travel events if the Guide rolls a Great Success on their first Marching Test and the Company succeeds at both *HUNTING* rolls. Apply Travel Fatigue before proceeding to

the next part of the adventure, remembering to add Fatigue for any days Forced Marching even if no Travel Events occurred.

Part 3: The Old Hunting Lodge

Rumour

Nobody lives in the hills west of Bree anymore, apart from the sheep. The ghosts of the folk who built Deadmen's Dike still haunt the few houses they built there. People who wander too close to those ruins often disappear.

Old Lore

The land between the Greenway and the Brandywine north of the Great East Road was once part of the Northern Dunedain kingdom of Arthedain. The area was only sparsely populated but was a popular area for hunting. A few old hunting lodges have survived remarkably intact, due to their strong construction. When the kingdom finally fell to the forces of Angmar, some of these places saw the desperate last stands of small groups of soldiers who had become separated from their King's army.

Background

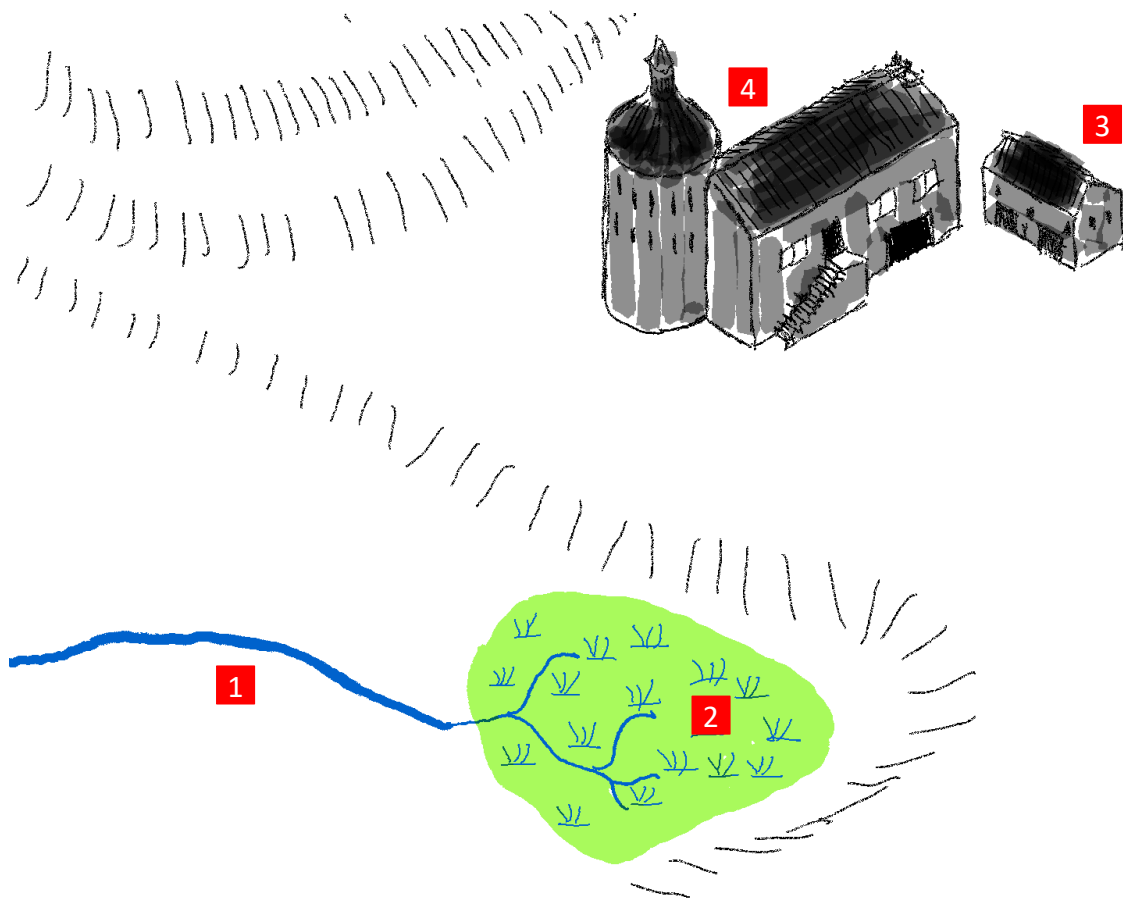
The Old Hunting Lodge is known to the Rangers of the North and in the past was sometimes used by them when travelling through the area. However, they now prefer the greater secrecy of their new sanctuary on Girdley Island.

Recently, a gang of bandits has taken up residence in the Lodge. They have just started to begin operations on the East Road to the south. Their first robbery was a great success, and their leader has left with a sample of their loot, to make arrangements for the gang in Tharbad. The gang is waiting for his return before their next job.

The leader of the bandits is an outlaw called Osmer who is another character from *Tales from the Lone Lands*. He is a major character in the "Kings of Little Kingdoms" adventure. He will not be encountered in this adventure, but the Player-heroes may learn his name and if they play through "Kings of Little Kingdoms", they may realise where he got his fireworks from.

Osmer is being accompanied to Tharbad by Jon-a-Leaping, who was responsible for the burglary of Oswald Breeker's library. Although not encountered here, the Player-heroes may learn a little more about another major character from *Tales from the Lone Lands*.

Locations



1. Stream

This stream meanders in a roughly south-westerly direction for about 20 miles, until it reaches the Brandywine River near Girdley Island.

2. Bog

This bog is the source of the stream. It is the one area in the valley that offers some cover to hide from anyone watching from the Hunting Lodge. However, physical activity is hindered by the sucking mud and all relevant tests will *lose (1d)*.

3. Kennels

This building once housed the hounds used by the residents of the hunting lodge. The bandits have scavenged materials from here to make some basic repairs to the main building. It is now an empty shell, which is home only to a barn owl.

4. Hunting Lodge

This was a well-constructed two-story stone building with a small tower in one corner. It has only recently been reoccupied after several centuries of abandonment. However, it is still largely intact.

The ground floor is a stable. There is currently one carthorse here, along with the cart that was stolen from the Bardings. There are several large barrels also stored in here, which are marked with a Gandalf Rune. These contain the fireworks that Gandalf had ordered. One of the barrels has been opened and some of the fireworks removed.

The only entrance to the first floor is via a set of steps on the outside of the building. The door has been roughly repaired by the bandits and can be barred from the inside. It is left open during the day. The windows are all broken, but the wooden shutters have also been roughly repaired.

Inside, there is just one room with a large fireplace at one end. This is now the bandit's main living quarters. Their bedrolls are laid out on the floor, and they have a makeshift kitchen area by the fireplace.

There is an open doorway at the other end of the room, which leads to the tower. The first-floor tower room is used as a storeroom by the bandits. As well as food, firewood and kindling, there is a Lesser Hoard here. If any Player-heroes take a share of this treasure, they will gain 1 Shadow (Greed).

Stairs run up and down around the walls of the tower, open to the room. The room below is the well-room. A four-foot-wide well is sunk into the centre of the floor and a couple of buckets are secured to the wall with coils of rope tied to iron rings.

The room above the storeroom provides the best views of the valley. There is always at least one bandit Footpad on watch here, making it very difficult to sneak up on the Hunting Lodge (any attempts *lose (2d)* during daylight). There is a rope hanging from the centre of the ceiling and the sentry will pull on this to ring the bell above when raising the alarm.

Schemes and Trouble

Stalking the Hunting Lodge

The Hunting Lodge lies in a steep valley and can't be seen from a great distance. It is easy to approach from the surrounding hills without being seen (no skill rolls are required) and look down on the site from above. However, it is very difficult to enter the valley from these directions and any **STEALTH** rolls will *lose (2d)* during daylight. It is easier to approach closer from down the valley, by sneaking up along the stream and hiding in the bog.

Anyone watching the Hunting Lodge from a vantage point will see several bandits outside during the day, including some who go into the stable to look after the horse. They all go inside as evening falls and the door is shut after dark.

The Player-heroes may try to steal the cart and its cargo back under cover of darkness. Any Player-hero attempting to reach the stables undetected must make a **STEALTH** skill roll, and any *Tengwars* rolled can be used to cancel the failure of another Player-hero. If anyone fails, they are spotted by the sentry in the tower, who will raise the alarm by ringing the bell.

If the Player-heroes reach the stables undetected, they must undertake a Skill Endeavour to prepare the cart. This is a Laborious task (Resistance 6) and they only have a short time, so the Time Limit is 4. Each of the following skills may be used up to once during the Skill Endeavour:

- **SCAN** to find the horse tackle and cargo
- **ATHLETICS** to load the cart
- **ENHEARTEN** to calm and prepare the horse
- **TRAVEL** to lead the cart out and set off on a safe path

The Risk Level of these rolls is Hazardous, and the Player-heroes may attempt the first three in any order they like. Any failed roll will result in Failure with Woe – they make too much noise and a couple of bandits (a Footpad and a Highway Robber) will be sent to check on the horse. If this happens, the Player-heroes have two choices:

Immediately try to hide. All Player-heroes in the stable must pass a **STEALTH** check (any *Tengwars* rolled can be used to cancel another player's Failure).

- If anyone fails, they are spotted, and the bandits immediately raise the alarm.
- If everyone succeeds, they may wait for the bandits to go back upstairs, or they may attempt to ambush them. Both bandits must be defeated before the end of the first round of combat to avoid the alarm being raised. An ambush should be considered a Misdeed worth 2 Shadow points

Attempt one more roll for the Skill Endeavour before the bandits reach the stables. The Player-heroes will be automatically discovered but may complete the task.

If the Player-heroes succeed in the Skill Endeavour, they will be spotted by the sentry as they make their getaway. From this point, the chase is on (see The Bandits, below).

The Bandits

There is one Footpad and one Highway Robber per Player-hero. If confronted during the day, half will defend the stable, throwing up a makeshift barricade across the entrance. This will moderately hinder anyone attacking them, and only two can be engaged in close combat at once. The rest will bar the door and shoot from the windows if attacked. Ranged attacks against archers at the windows are severely hindered and the bandit archers have a height advantage, so gain a moderate advantage.

The bandits will not strike first. They will ask what the Player-heroes want and are willing to parley from behind their defensive position. This is more to play for time, as they reason that they have sufficient supplies to outlast a short siege, after which they could leave and find a new hideout. This can be run as a Council and the bandits' main negotiator will their leader, a Ruffian Chief called Ned-in-the-Hedge.

Ned-in-the-Hedge is a minor character from *Ruins of the Lost Realm*. He could be encountered again later, to provide a link to “The Old Dwarf Mines” Landmark.

Resistance: The Resistance for this Council is 9, as the bandits are likely to consider any request the Player-heroes make (such as “Hand over your loot and surrender”) to be outrageous.

Introduction: AWE or RIDDLE would be appropriate in this situation. Count any attempt to use COURTESY as an automatic failure.

If the Introduction Skill roll is a failure, the Player-heroes will have a time limit equal to 3. If it is a success, the time limit will be equal to 4, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled on the Success dice.

Interaction: The bandits’ attitude will be **Reluctant**, so rolls will *lose (1d)*.

AWE, PERSUADE, INSIGHT and RIDDLE are all skills that could be especially useful.

The following outcomes are possible:

Success: The bandits agree to surrender the horse and cart, together with its cargo, to the Player-heroes.

Failure with Woe: The negotiations carry on fruitlessly for most of the day. This gives the bandits ample time to spy out the Player-heroes, letting them gain (1d) in the opening volleys of any attack instigated by the Player-heroes.

Disaster: The sun is starting to set. In addition to the results from Failure with Woe above, a bandit begins to ring the tower bell, to bring all of the bandits to alert.

If the Player-heroes decide to attack the bandits without trying to negotiate with them first, this should be considered a Misdeed that earns them 1 Shadow point each.

If they are set on violent confrontation, a Player-hero with an appropriate tool (an axe or a mattock?) could attempt to break the door down using their weapon proficiency or an appropriate skill (ATHLETICS or CRAFT) as a main action during a combat round. The Resistance of the door is 6 and there is no Time Limit. Instead, the Player-hero makes one roll per combat round, during which time they will be the target of at least two defending archers.

If the Player-heroes have successfully got the cart out of the stables before the bandits notice anything, then there will be a chase. This will be a Skill Endeavour using the ATHLETICS skill. This is a Laborious task (Resistance 6) and they only have a short head-start, so the Time Limit is 4. The Risk Level of these rolls is Hazardous, so any failed roll will result in Failure with Woe. In this case, they will be shot at by two bandits armed with bows.

If the chase Skill Endeavour is a failure, then the bandits catch up with the cart and a battle ensues. If it is a success, then the Player-heroes succeed in outrunning their pursuers.

The bandits will ask for quarter or give up the chase after half of them have been defeated.

The Return of the Residents

If the tower bell is rung at any point, it will summon the original residents of the Hunting Lodge. These were Dunedain warriors from the Kingdom of Arthedain. They were slaughtered by the Witch-king's army while making a last stand at the Hunting Lodge and their bodies were thrown into the bog. Now they rise again as Marsh-dwellers.

Three rounds after the bell has been rung, the Marsh-dwellers rise stealthily from the bog. There are twice as many Marsh-dwellers as there are Player-heroes and anyone hiding in the bog must make an **AWARENESS** roll to avoid being ambushed by them. The primary focus of the Marsh-dwellers will be anyone who appears to be attacking the Hunting Lodge, which is likely to be the Player-heroes.

More Marsh-dwellers (at least four) will climb up the well inside the Hunting Lodge tower. The bandits will notice these after another three rounds, when they are attacked themselves. The Player-heroes will hear shouts for help from inside and Ned-in-the-Hedge will agree to a parley if they suggest it. This will be run as a Council, with one roll allowed each combat round, which can be considered as a secondary action. During this time, no bandits will fight the Player-heroes unless a Player-hero attacks them.

Resistance: The Resistance for this Council is 3, as the bandits think it is entirely reasonable that the Player-heroes help them fight off the Marsh-dwellers.

Introduction: **AWE**, **COURTESY** or **RIDDLE** could be appropriate in this situation.

If the Introduction Skill roll is a failure, the Player-heroes will have a time limit equal to 3. If it is a success, the time limit will be equal to 4, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled on the Success dice.

Interaction: The bandits' attitude will be **Open**, so rolls will not be modified.

The following outcomes are possible:

Success: The bandits agree to fight alongside the Player-heroes and let them into the Hunting Lodge. They will surrender to the Player-heroes after the fight.

Success with Woe: The bandits agree to fight with the Player-heroes, but not to let them into the Hunting Lodge. They will surrender the horse and cart, together with its cargo, to the Player-heroes after the fight.

Disaster: The bandits refuse to treat any further with the Player-heroes. Each group is on their own.

What shall we do with the prisoners?

Depending on the outcome of the encounters at the Hunting Lodge, the Player-heroes may find themselves with several bandit prisoners on their hands. This could pose a dilemma for them. There are no prisons in Bree or the Shire. If the Player-heroes tried to take them into the Shire, they would be turned away at the border.

If the Player-heroes take them back to Bree, then the bandits would face the justice of the Reeve. The Reeve's options for punishment are limited to fines, corporal punishment, banishment or in extreme cases capital punishment. This would be a time-consuming process and the Player-heroes would be needed as witnesses.

The Player-heroes may suggest handing the prisoners over to the Rangers. However, if any Player-heroes are Rangers themselves, the Loremaster should point out "You are the Rangers." Those Player-heroes could also be advised that the Rangers aim to drive away bandits from the borders of the Shire and Bree-land, so banishment would be the objective.

Perhaps the best solution for the Player-heroes would be to get the bandits to swear an oath. These bandits did not kill the Bardings but tied them up and left them where they were likely to be found. They also did their best to avoid starting any fight with the Player-heroes. So, they're clearly not entirely evil – doesn't everyone deserve a chance of redemption?

Part 4: A Warm Reception

The Player-heroes should now be in possession of the stolen cart with its cargo of fireworks and party goods. They may decide to return to Bree, in which case this return journey can be handled "off-screen". However, if the Bardings are with them, they will urge the Player-heroes to head straight to Buckland, as there isn't much time left before Gandalf expects his delivery. They say it's not wise to keep a Wizard waiting!

Barrels to Buckland

If the Player-heroes returned to Bree, they may recover up to 2 points of Fatigue as they stay a couple of nights at the Prancing Pony. Reinald and Egil will be keen for them to set out for Buckland as quickly as possible, once business in Bree is concluded. The Journey rules on pages 108 to 114 of *The One Ring* will be used. This is a journey of 4 hexes, all by road. The Bardings will insist that they forced march, so remember to add the additional Fatigue for each day of travel. The cart can only travel at walking pace, so the maximum distance per day will usually be 2 hexes. When calculating Travel Fatigue at the end of the journey, any Player-hero without a mount may reduce their Fatigue by an additional 1 point as the cart can carry some of their travel gear.

If the Player-heroes head directly to Buckland from the Hunting Lodge, the journey is entirely on the map of the Shire from the Starter Set. So, the rules for Hobbit Walks on page 10 of *The Shire* supplement from the Starter Set can be used. One roll is required, checking for Fatigue on the 'Summer and Spring' column. Each Player-hero may make a TRAVEL roll to reduce any Fatigue gained and may further reduce Fatigue by the Vigour of their mount if they have one, or by 1 point if they don't as the cart can carry some of their travel gear.

The journey will take the Player-heroes south of the East Road before reaching the Bridge of Stonebows across the Brandywine, then through the High Hay at the North Gate into Buckland. The guards there will direct the Player-heroes on to Newbury, where they can stay at Hugo's Gruff, the local inn. The Loremaster may roll on the table on page 47 of *The Shire* supplement from the Starter Set, to see what topics of conversation there are at the tiny inn, other than the upcoming wedding.

The Player-heroes will set out on the final day of their journey after a fine breakfast at Hugo's Gruff and arrive at their destination by late morning. The lanes leading to Bucklebury are very busy and Brandy Hall is a hive of activity. Several pavilions have already been raised in a field nearby and among the multitude of Hobbits is an old man with long white hair and a silver beard, dressed in grey robes and wearing a tall blue pointed hat. Gandalf greets Reinald and Egil, along with the Player-heroes:

"Ah, there you are – and not before time! Well, come along, there's work to do. You can help me to prepare. There will be plenty of time to talk later."

Gandalf will appear to be rather annoyed if many of the fireworks that he ordered are missing. However, any Player-hero making a successful roll of INSIGHT will know that he is more relieved that Reinald and Egil are safe and sound.

Celebrations and Conversations

Gandalf keeps the Player-heroes busy for the rest of the day. After dinner, he settles down with his pipe to enjoy the evening sun as it begins to set over the Brandywine.

"Now, tell me all about your adventures. Something tells me that you have quite a tale to tell."

Gandalf listens carefully to what the Player-heroes say. He doesn't talk much, just the occasional question to prompt them to tell him more. After they have finished, he will blow a single perfect smoke-ring from his pipe, before saying:

"Hmm, there is a lot to consider, and I don't have all the answers. It would be good to know where Berelas ended up. I liked old Tobias, but he didn't tell me everything. However, Tobias was a popular Hobbit, and you may be

able to learn more from some of the wedding guests tomorrow. Why not enjoy the party and see what you can learn?"

The following morning dawns on what promises to be a perfect summer's day. The Player-heroes are privileged to witness the joy of a grand Hobbit wedding. The main ceremony takes place in a field next to Brandy Hall in the morning and the reception begins in earnest with lunch. The Player-heroes all recover 1 point of Hope as their hearts are lifted.

In the afternoon the Player-heroes have an opportunity to talk to some of the wedding guests and ask them about Tobias, as Gandalf suggested. There are many guests, but four are of particular interest to the Player-heroes:

Rorimac Brandybuck: Rory to his friends, he became Master of Buckland three years ago, after his father died. He has just given his sister's hand in marriage and is now has a broad smile on his face as he watches his eldest son, Saradoc, dance with Esmerelda Took. *"They will be the next to get married, if I'm not mistaken."*

Bilbo Baggins: Although still considered a little odd by many, Bilbo was invited as a cousin of the groom and current head of the Baggins family. *"I hear you've been talking to Gandalf. Be careful – who knows where that could lead?"*

Hamson Smallburrow: Hamson has brought his wife and children all the way from the Westfarthing. *"I'm related to the groom by marriage. My good wife, Gilly, was a Bolger when I married her, and she's a cousin of Drogo's mother."*

Posco Puddifoot: Posco has been invited personally by Rory, as thanks for the help he has provided with the preparations for the wedding. *"Hello friends! It's so good to see you – you must come and visit me again soon!"*

Questioning the guests is a simple Skill Endeavour with a Resistance of 3. The Time Limit is 4 (one roll for each guest). Players may choose any skills from **ENHEARTEN**, **PERSUADE**, **RIDDLE** or **SONG**. A Player-hero may not make a second roll for a guest unless all other Player-heroes have already made a roll, but any Player-hero may spend Hope to assist another.

If the Player-heroes succeed at the Skill Endeavour, they will learn the following information:

After Tobias settled in Crickhollow, he made several trips to the Northfathing. He said this was for the golf. Some of these trips lasted for several weeks. One time he was seen with a lady who was wearing a long green cloak, heading towards Long Cleeve.

If the Player-heroes fail the Skill Endeavour, this will be changed to a Success with Woe. They will learn the same information as above but will not be allowed to make the following **AWARENESS** check:

- Ask all Player-heroes to make an **AWARENESS** roll. This roll *loses (1d)* for each roll failed in the preceding Skill Endeavour.

Anyone who succeeds will remember seeing Otho or Lobelia Sackville-Baggins nearby when they were talking to one of the guests. They get the distinct feeling that they were being eaves-dropped on.

At this point, everyone's attention is drawn to the evening sky as Gandalf's fireworks display begins. When it ends half an hour later, the Player-heroes can talk to Gandalf again, to discuss what they have learnt. Gandalf smiles.

"The old rascal! If I'm not mistaken, Tobias took Berelas to Eskerdale, under the cover of one of his golfing holidays. I suggest you go back to Bree and see what more you can learn from Oswald's library. I think we should begin to plan a little expedition for you, into the Hills of Evendim."

If asked about the Sackville-Bagginses, Gandalf says:

"I shouldn't worry too much about them. Lobelia is a well-known busybody and I've learnt that it's if Hobbits have one fault, it's a weakness for gossip!"

Epilogue

The company will now be entering another Fellowship Phase:

Duration

The next adventure in this campaign is set a few weeks later, in the autumn of 2966.

Destination

The Company will be returning Bree. There, they will be able to collect any rewards promised to them in the previous adventure.

Updates

Players may spend any experience earned. They will have amassed approximately 1 Experience Point per hour of play during the previous adventure.

Player-heroes will also recover Hope points equal to their **HEART** score, (apart from Rangers, who only recover half of their **HEART** score, rounding up).

High Elves of Rivendell do not remove any Shadow points. If the bandits were banished, it can be considered to have actively hindered or damaged the Enemy, so all other Player-heroes can remove 2 Shadow points, except Elves of Lindon, who may only remove 1 point.

Otherwise, all Player-heroes (except High Elves of Rivendell) can remove 1 Shadow point.

Undertakings

This is not a Yule Fellowship Phase, so the Company may choose one Undertaking, plus a second Free Undertaking that is allowed by the Callings of the Player-heroes.

The Player-heroes may choose the ‘Meet Patron’ Undertaking to add Gandalf as a company Patron, if he isn’t one already. It could also be used to talk to any of the company’s current Patrons and to change their nominated Patron before their next adventure.

If the Player-heroes choose the ‘Gather Rumours’ Undertaking, they may hear the rumour described at the beginning of the *Star of the Mist* Landmark from *The One Ring*.

Player-heroes may use the new ‘Research Lore’ Undertaking to research anything else in Oswald’s library that could be related to the story in the Green Book. If so, they find the Journal of Talandil. This appears to be the journal of an old Ranger who took part in the attack on Gorlanc’s base in the Weather Hills. It corroborates some of the details of the tale told in the Green Book. However, it makes no mention of Gorlanc’s old fortress in the North Downs – it’s as though the Rangers were completely unaware of it.

Where To Next?

If you are running the adventures in this supplement as a self-contained mini campaign, then run the final adventure, The Prodigal Daughter, which can take place in the Summer of 2966. If on the other hand you inserted an additional adventure before this one, The Prodigal Daughter can take place in the Autumn of 2966.

However, The Prodigal Daughter can be delayed further if you wish to insert another adventure beforehand. Two suggestions are given here but let yourself be guided by the direction that your players appear to be going in, if it feels more appropriate.

Suggestion 1: A Troll-hole, If Ever There Was One

This is the first adventure in *Tales from the Lone Lands*. If you intend to run this campaign, then this adventure would fit quite well here. The Player-heroes will get to meet Jari the Dwarf again, who they first encountered at the Foresaken Inn during the Library Looting adventure.

Suggestion 2: Star of the Mist

This is the Landmark from *The One Ring*. It is Sabian’s base of operations for keeping an eye on the Southfarthing and there are numerous ways that the Player-heroes may have heard rumours about it:

- They may have overheard some Hobbits talking about it at the wedding reception, after a few drinks.
- They may have heard stories in the Common Room of the Prancing Pony, from travellers coming up the Greenway.

- Gilraen may ask the Player-heroes to investigate. The Rangers watching Sarn Ford have noticed the strange lights but need to keep a watch on the road.

If the Player-heroes do investigate this Landmark, try to keep Sabian alive for the final adventure.

The Prodigal Daughter

If this adventure follows directly from the events in Firework Theft, then it is now the Autumn of 2966. If not, it is winter, very early in the year 2967. The Player-heroes have now gathered enough information to set out on the trail of Berelas, and to finally track down the hidden treasure of Gorlanc.

As promised at the wedding of Drogo Baggins to Primula Brandybuck, Gandalf has been helping the Company to prepare the expedition. He visits the company at the Prancing Pony to discuss their plans.

“My advice is to set out as soon as possible. I hear whispers on the wind that you are not the only party interested in Berelas, and Gorlanc’s treasure. I fear that others may not have such good intentions as you.”

Gandalf’s hunch is correct. Sabian has been busy using Saruman’s growing spy network to gather information about the Player-heroes. This adventure will introduce the Eye Awareness rules on pages 169 to 173 of *The One Ring*, to adjudicate the effectiveness of these spies.

The Company’s starting Eye Awareness should be calculated normally, as described on page 170 of *The One Ring*. Eye Awareness will also increase normally, as described on that page.

The Loremaster should make a note of the area that the company is travelling through, as the Hunt Threshold will change according to the table on page 172 of *The One Ring*. They start in Bree, which is in Wild Lands, so the base Hunt Threshold will start at 16. However, they are travelling into Dark Lands, where this will drop to 14. The Hunt Threshold will also be modified as a result of previous events:

- If the Player-heroes noticed nothing at the wedding of Drogo and Primula (they did not get to roll for AWARENESS after talking to the guests), then Sabian knows their goal and the Hunt Threshold is modified by -4.
- If the Player-heroes were more alert at the wedding (they rolled for AWARENESS after talking to the guests, whether or not it succeeded), then the Hunt Threshold is only modified by -2 because of their growing renown.
- If the Player-heroes noticed the Sackville-Bagginses eaves-dropping on them at the wedding, then Gandalf will bless them before they leave, applying a modifier of +4 to the Hunt Threshold.

It is possible for the Player-heroes to gain an additional +2 modifier to the Hunt Threshold if they think to take additional precautions to be more discreet and unobtrusive.

Each section of this adventure will include suggestions for Revelation Episodes if the Company’s Eye Awareness reaches the Hunt Threshold.

Riddles Revealed

It has become clear that Tobias Goldworthy withheld some key details from his memoirs recorded in the Green Book of the Southfarthing. He left clues to these secrets, so that they would remain hidden from casual readers, but could be discovered by someone carefully studying the book and following the signs.

Piecing together the clues

The Player-heroes should have learnt the following during their previous adventures:

- Tom Bombadil gave the Ring of the Seven Jewels back to Berelas.
- Some time later, Tobias took Berelas to Eskerdale.
- Eskerdale is a village somewhere in the Hills of Evendim. Tobias' old companions, Oswin of Eskerdale and Becky Treare, retired there.
- When the Rangers drove Gorlanc from his base in the Weather Hills, they were unaware of his old fortress in the North Downs.
- Berelas previously met Gorlanc in the North Downs.

The plan seems to be simple. Go to Eskerdale and find Berelas. Ask her to give them the location of Gorlanc's old fortress in the North Downs. Then find the fortress, recover the treasure and return home. Gandalf has a word of caution:

"I have never been to Eskerdale, but I hear that it is a difficult place to find. You should visit some friends of mine, Beinion and Arin who live to the south of Lake Evendim, near the ruins of the old city of Annuminas. They tell me that Oswin is now Chieftain of Eskerdale. They should be able to give you directions. I'm afraid that I can't go with you, as I have urgent business to the east."

Part 1: Expedition to Eskerdale

The first leg of the journey will take the Player-heroes from Bree to the ruins of Annuminas on the southern shore of Lake Evendim. This will use the Journey rules on pages 108 to 114 of *The One Ring*.

Journey Path

There are two obvious routes to choose from:

- Either north up the Greenway towards Deadmen's Dike and then east to Annuminas, following the upper course of the Brandywine for the last part.
- Or, West into the Shire, then north through the North Moors to the southern shores of Lake Evendim.

However, players should be free to choose any route they like.

Marching Tests

It is either late Autumn or Winter, so each event will occur one hex into the journey if the Guide fails their first TRAVEL test. The length of this leg of the journey is likely to be about 10 hexes, so the Loremaster should try to prepare at least four or five events.

Event Resolution

Roll for the target of the event and then roll on the Journey Events table on page 112 of *The One Ring*. This second roll will be *Ill-favoured* if the event is in a Dark Land, or *Favoured* if the event is in a Border Land. This can be adjusted if the target of the Event is an Elf with the *Memory of Ancient Days* Cultural Virtue, or if the Company's Patron is Gilraen the Fair.

Eye Awareness Revelation Episodes

It is unlikely that the Company will trigger a Revelation Episode on the first leg of their journey. However, it is still possible with a series of unlucky rolls and failed travel Events that gain the Player-heroes Shadow.

If the Company does trigger a Revelation Episode, use *A Weariness of the Heart* (example #5 from the insert on page 173 of *The One Ring*). All Player-heroes will be Weary until the end of this leg of the journey, including rolls to reduce Fatigue at the end of the journey.

End of the Journey

Each Player-hero may make a TRAVEL roll to reduce any Fatigue gained and may further reduce Fatigue by the Vigour of their mount if they have one. Apply Travel Fatigue before the following encounter.

Appointment in Annuminas

When the ruins of Annuminas come into view, poking above the waters by the southern shores of Lake Evendim, the Player-heroes notice a lone figure standing among the gorse bushes on a nearby hillside. He is holding a great bow and has an arrow strung, ready to draw, but seems to be waiting for the Player-heroes to notice him. This is Beinion (see page 180 of *The One Ring* for details of Beinion and Arin), who Gandalf advised the Player-heroes to seek out, for directions to Eskerdale. The encounter should be run as a Council:

Resistance: The Resistance for this Council is 3, as asking for directions is a reasonable request.

Introduction: COURTESY would be the best option here, allowing the roll to *gain (1d)*. Attempting AWE would be a bad choice and the Player-heroes would *lose (1d)* for the roll in this case. There would be no advantage or disadvantage if RIDDLE was used.

If the Introduction Skill roll is a failure, the Player-heroes will have a time limit equal to 3. If it is a success, the time limit will be equal to 4, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled on the Success dice.

After the Introduction Skill roll, another hooded figure will stand up, not far from Beinion. He will introduce Arin, who was hidden behind some thick gorse bushes.

Interaction: Beinion and Arin's attitude will be **Open**, unless the Player-heroes mentioned Gandalf's name in the Introduction, in which case their attitude is **Friendly**, and rolls will *gain (1d)*.

The following outcomes are possible:

Success: Beinion and Arin agree to give the Player-heroes directions to Eskerdale. They also invite the Player-heroes back to their home on the edge of the ruins of Annuminas, to rest the night. This will allow each Player-hero to recover 1 additional point of Fatigue.

Success with Woe: Beinion and Arin agree to give the Player-heroes directions to Eskerdale. However, they advise the Company to press on as far as possible before sundown. The Player-heroes are not invited to stay with Beinion and Arin that night.

Disaster: Beinion and Arin refuse to provide any directions to Eskerdale. They advise the Player-heroes to return home, as it is far too dangerous to venture that far north at this time of year.

Eye Awareness Revelation Episodes

If the Company triggers a Revelation Episode during the encounter with Beinion and Arin, use *Lathspell* (example #2 from the insert on page 173 of *The One Ring*). The Player-heroes are treated coldly: the Resistance of the Council rises to 6 and Beinion and Arin's attitude will decrease by one level (from **Friendly** to **Open** or **Open** to **Hostile**).

If the Player-heroes are invited back to Beinion and Arin's home, Arin will entertain them with songs and rhymes of the city of Annuminas in its days of glory (see pages 178-9 of *The One Ring* for details). These tales will include the story of the Twilight Ships that can be seen from the Western Tower, and she will suggest that the Player-heroes look for them that night. If it is autumn, Beinion will show the Player-heroes a small boat that is hidden by the shore in the ruins. If it is winter, the lake is sufficiently frozen for the Player-heroes to walk out to the tower. See the insert "The Twilight Ships" on page 180 of *The One Ring* for more details.

If Beinion and Arin provide directions to Eskerdale, the Player-heroes will *gain (1d)* for each roll of the Skill Endeavour to find the village described on page 179 of *The One Ring*. If not, they will just know that Eskerdale is somewhere to the northwest of Lake Evendim.

Trekking Into the Twilight

The Player-heroes now need to set off on the next leg of their journey. If it is Autumn, winter appears to be coming early. The hilltops are capped with snow and the lower slopes have a light dusting. The snow is not much deeper if it is winter, but it is bitterly cold.

Journey Path

This is shorter than the first leg and there is only one route to take, following the western shores of Lake Evendim to its northern-most point, then heading west into the Hills of Evendim to search for the village of Eskerdale.



Marching Tests

It is either late Autumn or Winter, so each event will occur one hex into the journey if the Guide fails their first **TRAVEL** test. The measured length of the journey is 6 hexes, but for Marching Test purposes add 1 to this total for each roll taken on the Skill Endeavour to find Eskerdale. The Loremaster should try to prepare three or four events, due to the length of the journey.

If a "Chance Meeting" Event is rolled while on the western shores of Lake Evendim, it could be another meeting with the Dwarves Ail, Alni and/or Alvir, who the Player-heroes first met at the beginning of the Firework Theft adventure. Although evasive about what they are doing in the area, they will happily provide directions to Eskerdale, allowing the Player-heroes to *gain (1d)* for each roll of the Skill Endeavour to find the village.

Event Resolution

Roll for the target of the event and then roll on the Journey Events table on page 112 of *The One Ring*. This second roll will be *Ill-favoured*, as the event is in a Dark Land. This can be adjusted if the target of the Event is an Elf with the *Memory of Ancient Days* Cultural Virtue, or if the Company's Patron is Gilraen the Fair.

Eye Awareness Revelation Episodes

If the Company triggers a Revelation Episode during this Journey leg, use *Out of the Frying Pan...* (example #1 from the insert on page 173 of *The One Ring*). Player-heroes will *lose (1d)* for all rolls until the end of this leg of the journey, due to the weather turning against them with sudden flurries of snow.

End of the Journey

The journey will end when the Player-heroes find Eskerdale. This will require them to complete the Skill Endeavour to find the village described on page 179 of *The One Ring*. The Company can make one roll each day after they reach the northern tip of Lake Evendim.

If they exceed the Resistance of the Skill Endeavour, they can continue to make rolls. However, in addition to increasing the length of the journey as described above, each Player-hero will suffer a Moderate Endurance Loss from Extreme Cold (as described on page 134 of *The One Ring*) for every additional roll.

When they finally find Eskerdale, each Player-hero may make a TRAVEL roll to reduce any Fatigue gained and may further reduce Fatigue by the Vigour of their mount if they have one. Apply Travel Fatigue before the following encounter.

Part 2: The Chieftain's Wife

The village of Eskerdale is hidden in a steep-sided valley in the Hills of Evendim. There are pine trees on the slopes above the village and a stream runs down the valley, eventually emptying into Lake Evendim. The village itself consists of a dozen or more stone cottages and one larger hall. Thin wisps of smoke rise from the chimneys and are quickly dispersed on the breeze. A flock of sheep searches for tufts of grass sticking out through the thin snow in the valley below the village.

An Audience with the Chieftain

The Player-heroes have come to find Berelas and seek information about the location of Gorlanc's northern fortress. As they approach the village, they will be directed to the great hall, where they can seek an audience with the Chieftain. The Player-heroes will notice that the villagers are reticent to say anything else and many look at the Company suspiciously.

A door warden ushers the Player-heroes straight into the hall, which is lit by a large central pit fire and many rushlights hung on the walls. There are about twenty villagers in the hall. As their eyes become accustomed to the light, they see a man and a woman sat on a raised dais at the other end of the room. The woman asks

"Who enters the hall of Oswin of Eskerdale? State your business."

This audience will be run as a Council.

Resistance: The Resistance for this Council is 6, as the Company is making a bold request that benefits them more than the people of Eskerdale.

Introduction: AWE, COURTESY or RIDDLE could all be used without penalty.

If the Introduction Skill roll is a failure, the Player-heroes will have a time limit equal to 3. If it is a success, the time limit will be equal to 4, plus 1 for each *Tengwar* rolled on the Success dice.

After the Introduction Skill roll, Oswin will introduce the woman sitting beside him as his wife, Rebecca. Ask all Player-heroes to make an AWARENESS roll. Anyone who succeeds will notice a striking similarity in appearance between Rebecca and Oswald Brecker. If they rolled any *Tengwar*s they may spend one to Gain Insight, otherwise they may make a RIDDLE roll. If the Riddle roll was successful, or they Gained Insight, they realise that Rebecca is Oswald's long-lost daughter, Caty. The Player-heroes now understand Oswald well enough to know that he would love to see his daughter again, although he doesn't believe she is still alive.

A clever player may have worked this out already, as Becky Treare is an anagram of Caty Brecker. The Loremaster may wish to reward this with a bonus Adventure Point, if the player is able to use this information smartly.

Interaction: Oswin's attitude will be **Reluctant**, so rolls will *lose (1d)*. However, interactions with Rebecca will be **Open** if the Player-heroes bring news from Bree and especially Coombe.

Oswin will ask the Player-heroes about the events that have brought them to Eskerale, which they can relate with SONG.

The Player-heroes can use PERSUADE to ask to see Berelas, and ENHEARTEN to try to get the crowd on their side.

A RIDDLE roll may be used to work out that Tobias asked Oswin to shelter Berelas. Pointing out that they were indirectly guided here by Tobias themselves will improve Oswin's attitude to **Open**.

If the Player-heroes have realised that Oswin's wife is Caty Brecker, they will need to decide how best to use this information. A successful INSIGHT roll will reveal that she is feeling a little homesick. Suggesting that she visits her father will earn an automatic additional success.

The following outcomes are possible:

Success: Oswin beckons forward a woman who was concealed in a shadowy corner of the hall and introduces Berelas.

“You have been listening carefully to our visitors’ tale. What say you?”

Berelas looks carefully at each of the Player-heroes in turn and replies:

“A shadow descended on our village over a year ago. I see now that the time has come for someone else to take on the burden that I have carried all these years. This is the only way to lift the shadow.”

Then she looks at the Player-hero carrying the Naugantdolen and says:

“Perhaps you will be able to find a way to banish the shadow for good.”

Then she reaches forward, opens the locket and places a gold ring inside. When she closes the locket, the room seems to brighten. Oswin announces that there will be a feast tonight in honour of the guests and the villagers stir into action to make the preparations. Berelas asks the Player-heroes to follow her back to her cottage, where they can talk further in private.

Berelas’ house is the smallest cottage, on the upper edge of the village. There are drying herbs hanging from the beams and lots of jars of different sizes sitting on shelves. After they enter the cottage, Berelas will answer any questions to the best of her ability and can provide the following specific information:

- A rough map showing the location of Gorlanc’s fortress, about 50 miles northeast of Fornost.
- A basic description of the fortress, which is actually a partially ruined observatory called the Seer’s Tower. This includes the Rumour for the Landmark.
- Advice not to remove the Ring of the Seven Jewels from the Naugantdolen until Gorlanc’s curse has finally been removed.

The Player-heroes will learn that Berelas has become the midwife and wise-woman of the village, using the Ring of the Seven Jewels to help her. Oswin and Caty are protective of her, since she helped Caty through a difficult childbirth. Since a darkness fell over the village just over a year ago, she has had a recurring dream that she will have to give up the Ring to lift the darkness. She will also tell the Player-heroes that she has dreamt that the key to removing the curse will be found in Gorlanc’s old fortress.

Success with Woe: Oswin’s initial response is the same as for Success above, as is the reaction of Berelas. However, instead of ordering a feast in honour of the Player-heroes, he says:

“These people must be given every assistance to speed their departure, so that the fortunes of our village can be restored.”

Berelas will speak privately with the Player-heroes in her cottage later, as above.

Disaster: Oswin raises his hand and says:

“I have heard enough. I cannot take you to Berelas. You must seek your goal without her help. You must leave tomorrow. Do not return to Eskerdale seeking a warm welcome.”

If the Player-heroes told Oswin’s wife about her father, she will wait until her husband is busy before leading the Player-heroes to Berelas’ cottage. Otherwise, Berelas will wait until night-time and come to find the Player-heroes when they are sleeping. She will seek out the bearer of the Naugantdolen and try to talk to them on their own if possible. Either way, this will allow the Player-heroes to have the same conversation with Berelas that they would have had if they succeeded in the Council.

Eye Awareness Revelation Episodes

If the Company triggers a Revelation Episode while in Eskerdale, use *Do not tempt me!* (example #3 from the insert on page 173 of *The One Ring*). This will target the Player-hero carrying the Naugantdolen, after Berelas gives them the Ring of the Seven Jewels to bear. They will gain 3 points of Shadow (Greed) as they resist the urge to take the ring from the locket and wear it themselves.

The rest of the Player-heroes’ stay in Eskerdale will also depend on the outcome of the Council.

Feasting and Farewells

If the Council was a Success, the Player-heroes will be the guests of honour at a feast of mutton that evening. They will be welcome to stay for up to a week to rest up before the next leg of their journey, which will allow them to remove up to 7 points of Fatigue each. The Player-heroes will also *gain (1d)* for the resolution of the next Travel Event, as the people of Eskerdale give them advice about the region.

If the Council was a Success with Woe, there will be no feast and the Player-heroes will only be able to stay in Eskerdale for a single night, recovering 1 point of Fatigue. However, they do not spend enough time in the village to learn anything from the locals about travelling through the region.

If the Council was a Disaster, the Player-heroes will only be able to stay in Eskerdale for a single night and they are not made to feel welcome, so don’t recover any Fatigue.

Part 3: Over the North Downs

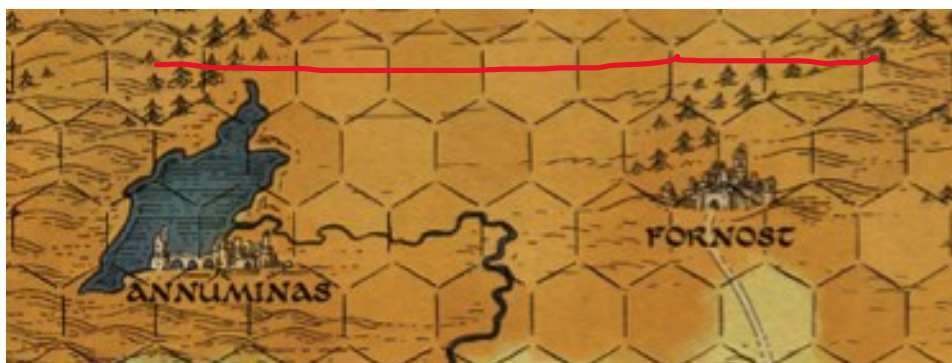
The Player-heroes will now set out for the Seer's Tower, either with the best wishes of the people of Eskerdale, or their relief at their unexpected guests' departure.

Across the Lone Lands

The Player-heroes now need to set off on the next leg of their journey. If it is Autumn, the wintry weather continues. Tufts of grass still show through the thin snow and cold winds from the north cut through to the bone. The snow cover is full if it is winter, and it is bitterly cold.

Journey Path

The Player-heroes need to head due east from Eskerdale, across the plain between the Hills of Evendim and the North Downs. Then they will climb up into the downs, heading for the tower that Berelas has described to them.



Marching Tests

It is either late Autumn or Winter, so each event will occur one hex into the journey if the Guide fails their first **TRAVEL** test. The length of the journey is 8 hexes. The Loremaster should try to prepare three or four events, due to the length of the journey.

Event Resolution

Roll for the target of the event and then roll on the Journey Events table on page 112 of *The One Ring*. This second roll will be *Ill-favoured*, as the event is in a Dark Land. This can be adjusted if the target of the Event is an Elf with the *Memory of Ancient Days* Cultural Virtue, or if the Company's Patron is Gilraen the Fair.

Eye Awareness Revelation Episodes

If the Company triggers a Revelation Episode on this leg of their journey, or when they are at their next destination, use *Deadly Strife* (example #9 from the insert on page 173 of *The One Ring*). The band of ruffians led by Sabian will gain an extra pool of Resolve, equal to the roll of one Success die. The Loremaster can spend Resolve from this pool before using the individual Resolve of any of these Ruffians.

End of the Journey

The journey will end when the Player-heroes reach the Seer's Tower. Each Player-hero may make a TRAVEL roll to reduce any Fatigue gained and may further reduce Fatigue by the Vigour of their mount if they have one. Apply Travel Fatigue before the following encounter.

Part 4: The Seer's Tower

Rumour

In the days of the King, the Men of the West built towers on the hills of the North Downs to study the stars of the northern sky. But one by one they fell to the sorcery of the Witch-king. There could still be treasures of hidden in these ruins, if anyone has the courage to brave the ghosts of the past.

Old Lore

Malborn the Seer was a royal advisor to the last two kings of Arthedain, who was famous for having a powerful gift of foresight. He had a tower built in the North Downs, to be an observatory away from the distractions of the city. Many of his prophecies came to him after spending time alone here, contemplating the stars. There may still be some ancient lore left here, waiting to be rediscovered.

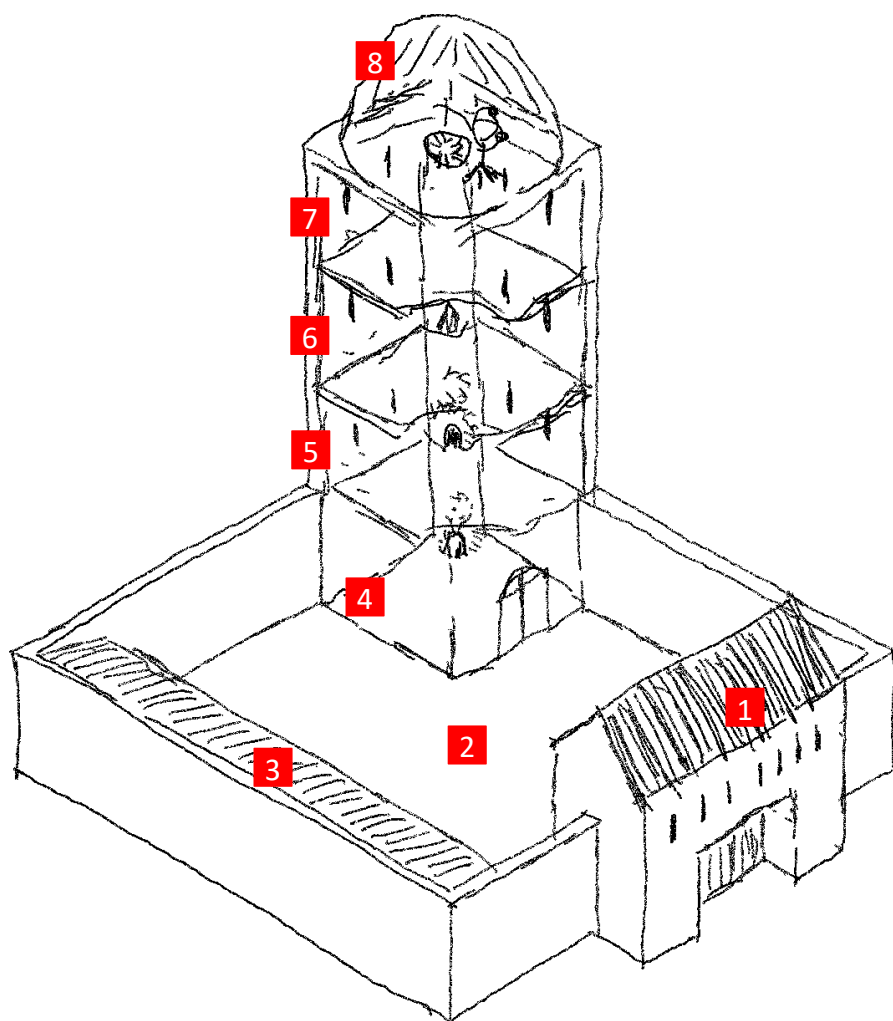
Background

Malborn had his tower built on one of the highest points in the North Downs, 16 Leagues from the city of Fornost. The tower was designed to be an observatory and from the top there are unbroken views of the skies of Eriador in all directions. Malborn had special instruments of Dwarven make and designed to his own specifications, installed in the tower. With these he spent countless hours studying the stars.

When the forces of the Witch-king's armies finally overran Arthedain, they found the tower abandoned. This may explain why it is still remarkably intact, despite the looting that occurred.

The tower remained unoccupied for centuries, until it was found by Gorlanc, the leader of a band of tomb-robbers that were looting their way across Eriador. He recognised the strength of the place and took it as a secret stronghold. However, he needed another base for his band further south, closer to where they usually operated. So, the tower remained undiscovered when the Rangers finally brought an end to Gorlanc's reign of terror.

More recently, a new occupant has taken up residence. The Old Troll has been drawn here a year ago, by a fate he doesn't understand. This is the Troll that Tobias and his company encountered and bargained with in the South Downs, sixteen years ago. He is so old that he cannot even remember his true name, but he does vaguely recall fighting in some war or another.



1. Gatehouse

The Gatehouse building is largely intact, but the gates are broken. The entrance faces to the south. There is a doorway opening on a spiral staircase on each side of the entrance, leading to the first floor of the gatehouse from the courtyard. There is a portcullis mechanism here that has rusted up, but it could be repaired with a successful **CRAFT** roll and the appropriate tools.

2. Courtyard

The courtyard is surrounded by high walls, with a building for stables and stores along the entire western side and the tower in the northeast corner. Scattered throughout the courtyard are dozens of precarious-looking large piles of bones. These are the traps set by the Old Troll.

3. Stables

This long building is empty and stripped of anything useful long ago. The thick cobwebs show that it hasn't been used for many years, but the structure is sound. It would take very little effort to return the building to its original use.

4. Ground Floor

The entrance to the tower is on its south side. This is the Old Troll's main lair, and it has begun to smell like one. His larder is here, which surprisingly includes a few barrels of beer! There is a spiral staircase leading up in the northeast corner.

5. First Floor

The Old Troll has used this room as his treasury and set a few more of his bone-piles to guard it. He has collected a Marvellous Hoard in his time roaming Eriador, which will almost certainly include some magical treasure.

6. Second Floor

The Old Troll does not trust the tower to bear his weight beyond the first floor, so he hasn't climbed this far up. This room was used by Gorlanc as a bedchamber and the threadbare remains of once luxurious bedroom furniture remains.

There is a book on the table by the bed. It is very fragile, but some of it can still be read. It appears to be a journal of random observations, written by Malborn. The book has been left open at an entry that reads, *"The Hill shall not be laid to rest until the Maiden has arisen."*

The prophecy above provides a potential link between the Hill of Fear from *Tales from the Lone Lands* and the Hill of the Sleeper from *Ruins of the Lost Realm*.

7. Third Floor

Gorlanc kept his most valuable treasures here. There is another Marvelous Hoard here, within three large, locked chests. Magical treasure can also be found here, including one item placed prominently on a large table against the south wall – a large lamp.

The Beacon of Vinyalonde

This large lamp is a Wondrous Item with Blessings for TRAVEL and EXPLORE. It is very heavy and has a Load of 6. The case is crafted in gold and bears inscriptions written in Quenya. It holds a crystal with its own dimly shining light.

The Beacon of Vinyalonde has a long history. A Numenorean called Baranor from the Guild of Venturers commissioned the lamp for a new lighthouse in Vinyalonde, in about the year 1480 of the Second Age. It was made by Ormal the Lampmaker in Ost-in-Edhil.

Much later, the lamp was removed by astrologers from Lond Daer Enedh, as its light interfered with their observations of the stars. Later still, it was found by Gorlanc in one of the towers on the northern shore, opposite the current town of Lond Daer.

If the lamp is restored as a beacon to Lond Daer, its light will be visible up to 20 leagues away. Anyone on board a vessel who can see the light, can use the Blessings of the lamp. This is "the light of hope restored" needed to remove the curses of Ill-luck and Ill-omen on the Naugantdolen and Ring of the Seven Jewels.

8. Observatory

The top of the tower is an observatory for the stars. The domed roof can be drawn back to expose a quarter of the sky and rotated to look in any desired direction. There is a complex mosaic on the floor, depicting a map of the stars, which appears to always be aligned with them.

There is also an orrery on a stand in the centre of the room. The mechanism is broken but can be repaired with a successful **CRAFT** roll. If it is fixed and aligned correctly at night-time with a successful **RIDDLE** roll, then the user can make a **LORE** roll to observe the stars:

- A successful **LORE** roll will allow the Player-hero to reroll all of the dice in one future roll, plus one additional future roll per Tengwar, during the current Adventuring Phase (this is mechanically like Cirdan the Shipwright's Patron Advantage and the Ranger Cultural Virtue "Foresight of Their Kindred").

Only one roll is allowed per night and the observatory can only be used successfully once per Adventuring Phase.

Schemes and Trouble

The Old Troll

This creature is the main obstacle to anyone wanting to explore the Seer's Tower when they first arrive. He is perhaps the oldest Stone Troll remaining in all of Eriador and still bears the chainmail armour and long knife issued to him when he served in the Witch-king's army. Unusually for a Troll, he has also learnt one or two tricks from the sorcery of Angmar.

The Old Troll

Cruel, Suspicious

ATTRIBUTE LEVEL

ENDURANCE

80

MIGHT

2

HATE

10

PARRY

0

ARMOUR

4

COMBAT PROFICIENCIES: Troll Knife 3 (3/16, Pierce) – a Short Sword

Club 3 (6/16, Break Shield)

Crush 2 (6/12, Seize)

FELL ABILITIES: *Hideous Toughness.* The creature is unaffected by unarmed attacks. Additionally, when an attack inflicts damage to the creature that would cause it to go to zero Endurance, it causes a Piercing Blow instead. Then, if the creature is still alive its Endurance score is set back at half its maximum rating.

Dull-witted. Player-heroes can attempt a special combat task against the creature while in Forward stance. The acting player makes a **RIDDLE** roll as the main action for the round: on a success, the Troll loses 1 point of Hate, plus 1 point for each Tengwar rolled.

Hatred (Dwarves). When fighting Dwarves, all rolls are *Favoured*.

Horrible Strength. If the creature scores a Piercing Blow, spend 1 Hate to make the target's Protection roll *Ill-favoured*.

Deadly Misfortune. If a character rolls an Eye on any roll while in the vicinity of the Old Troll's lair, then he may spend a point of Hate. If he does, then one of the piles of bones suddenly slips and collapses on top of the character, crashing and clattering down very loudly. The Troll *gains (2d)* against that foe. This ability is only usable when the Old Troll is near his lair, currently the Seer's Tower.

Great Leap. Spend 1 Hate to attack any Player-hero, in any combat stance, including Rearward.

The Old Troll has survived long enough to know that it is sometimes better to talk than to fight. However, anyone trying to negotiate with him would need something he wants, to bargain with. The Old Troll likes treasure, but at the moment he would like some fresh meat even more.

The Old Troll has set up his piles of bones in the tower courtyard, with more on the ground floor of the tower. He spends his time in the tower when the sun is shining but doesn't go above the first floor. At night, or when it is cloudy, he will roam the surrounding area and will often be found in the courtyard.

When fighting, the Old Troll will try to take advantage of his traps at every opportunity. He is also surprisingly quick and agile for a Troll and can use his Great Leap to strike at any target he chooses. Something has drawn him to the Seer's Tower, and he will not flee from a fight here.

Sabian and the Slavers

Sabian has been on the trail of the Player-heroes and finally catches up with them, soon after they have dealt with the Old Troll. His band consists of one Highway Robber per Player-hero, plus three Footpads (see page 147 of *The One Ring*). He believes that the Player-heroes have come to the Seer's Tower to retrieve the Ring of the Seven Jewels and he has come to claim it. He is prepared to use violence this far from civilisation.

On the way, Sabian has met up with another band of Ruffians. These brigands are slavers and they have teamed up with Sabian. There is another Highway Robber per Player-hero, plus two Footpads, led by a Ruffian Chief (see page 147 of *The One Ring*). They have agreed to split any treasure and take all prisoners as slaves.

This could offer the Player-heroes a significant challenge, as they are likely to be outnumbered at least three to one and some of them may be hurt after the encounter with the Old Troll. Sabian may try to assault the tower if the Player-heroes have not taken any

precautions, but he is willing to lay siege if the players are more prepared (for instance, if the portcullis has been repaired). Perhaps the best option is to try to drive a wedge between the two factions with some clever negotiations. This could lead to the Slavers revealing who their other friends are...

The Orcs of Mount Gram

The Slavers are working for the Orcs of Mount Gram. They sell captured slaves to the Orcs in exchange for old Dwarven treasures the Orcs have found there. The Slavers have secretly sent word to the Orcs of their current expedition. If the Player-heroes are besieged for more than a day an Orc Warband will arrive.

The Orc Warband consists of one Orc Soldier and One Goblin Archer per Player-hero, plus two Orc Guards, and led by an Orc-chieftain called Gorbag (see page 150 of *The One Ring*). Their intention is to take the tower as a forward outpost, take any prisoners back to Mount Gram as slaves and claim any treasure. Their Slaver allies will be suitably rewarded.

The Player-heroes will see the Orcs arrive and will no doubt think that the situation has just got even worse for them. They will see Sabian approach the Orc-chieftain and they appear to talk together for some time but are too far away for the Player-heroes to hear anything. Suddenly, Gorbag thrusts his spear through Sabian's stomach and out through his back. He lifts the spear up into the air and Sabian's body slowly slides down the shaft. All Player-heroes gain 2 Shadow (Dread) as they witness the gruesome killing and see the Orcs begin to attack Sabian's band.

The outbreak of fighting provides a distraction that the Player-heroes could use to make their escape. Fleeing from the Seer's Tower can be run as a Skill Endeavour using **ATHLETICS**. The Resistance is 6 (a Laborious task). The Time Limit will be set by an initial **BATTLE** roll, to determine the best time to make a break for it:

- If the **BATTLE** Roll is a failure, the Time Limit is 3 (not enough time)
- If the **BATTLE** Roll is a success, the Time Limit is 4 (only a short time)
- If the **BATTLE** Roll is a success and any Tengwars are rolled, add 1 to the Time Limit for each Tengwar

Each Player-hero can only roll once for this Skill Endeavour until everyone else has rolled at least once. If an individual roll is failed, one Goblin Archer gets close enough to take a shot at that Player-hero. If the Skill Endeavour is failed, then the Player-heroes must fight a battle with half of the Orc Soldiers and Goblin Archers from the Warband, led by an Orc Guard.

Part 5: Back to Bree

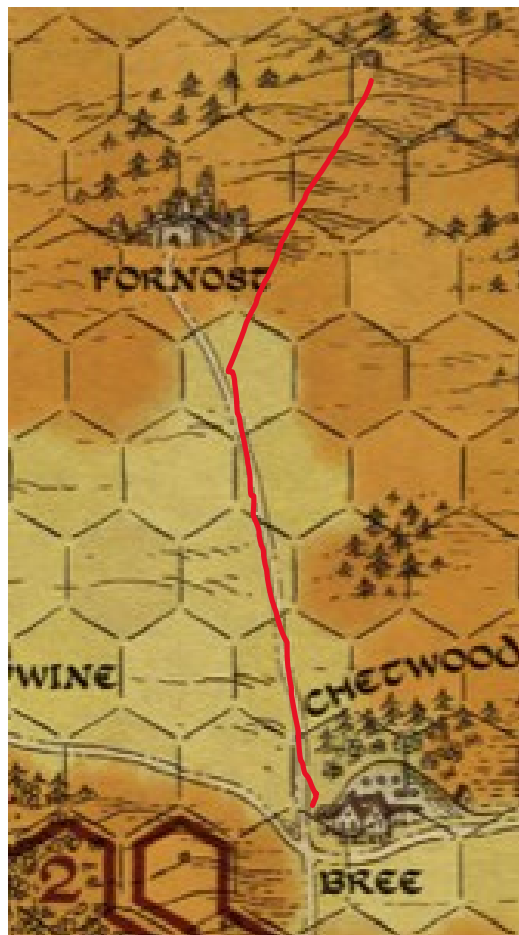
If the Player-heroes escape the Seer's Tower with their lives, they will want to get back to Bree as quickly as they can. There will almost certainly be Orcs and Bandit Slavers hunting for them, at least until they get south of the North Downs.

Return to Civilisation

This return journey should be run using the Journey rules, because the Player-heroes are being pursued.

Journey Path

The Quickest route would be to head south-southwest until reaching the Greenway about 20 miles south of Fornost. Then follow the road south to Bree.



Marching Tests

It is either late Autumn or Winter, so each event will occur one hex into the journey if the Guide fails their first **TRAVEL** test. The length of the journey is 7 hexes, so the Loremaster should try to prepare three or four events.

If a "Chance Meeting" Event is rolled, the Player-heroes could meet Talandil, a veteran Ranger and the self-appointed guardian of Fornost Erain, mentioned on page 196 of *The One Ring*. It is possible that one of the Player-heroes read his journal in Oswald's library during the last Fellowship Phase.

Event Resolution

Roll for the target of the event and then roll on the Journey Events table on page 112 of *The One Ring*. This second roll will be *Ill-favoured*, if it occurs in the first two hexes as the North

Downs are a Dark Land. However, once they get to the Greenway they will be in Wild Lands and the roll will be unadjusted. This can be modified if the target of the Event is an Elf with the *Memory of Ancient Days* Cultural Virtue, or if the Company's Patron is Gilraen the Fair.

Remember that Player-heroes *lose* (1d) for Event Resolution rolls when in hard terrain like the North Downs, but *gain* (1d) if they are on a road.

Eye Awareness Revelation Episodes

If the Company triggers a Revelation Episode on the final leg of their journey, use *A Will That Lends Speed* (example #6 from the insert on page 173 of *The One Ring*). The vanguard of the band of Orcs pursuing the Player-heroes will catch up with them and they must fight a battle.

If the journey is interrupted for any reason, calculate Fatigue gained as normal before the encounter.

Epilogue

The Player-heroes will now be entering another Fellowship Phase, which may be their second Yule Fellowship Phase:

Duration

The Player-heroes have just completed the last adventure in this campaign, so the Loremaster will need to decide what is going to happen next. They may be guided by choices and suggestions from the Player-heroes.

Destination

The immediate destination is Bree. If this is a Yule Fellowship Phase, there is more than enough time for all Player-heroes to return to their homes for the Winter, before reconvening in Bree in the Spring.

Updates

Players may spend any experience earned. They will have amassed approximately 1 Experience Point per hour of play during the previous adventure. If this is a Yule Fellowship Phase, they will earn additional Skill Points equal to their **WITS** rating.

If this is a Yule Fellowship Phase, Player-heroes will also recover all of their Hope points. Otherwise, they will recover Hope points equal to their **HEART** score, (apart from Rangers, who only recover half of their **HEART** score, rounding up).

If the Player-heroes recovered the Beacon of Vinyalonde from the Seer's Tower, they may remove 3 Shadow points. Otherwise, they may all remove 1 Shadow point.

All Player-heroes (including Elves) may recover one bonus Shadow point if they reconciled Oswald and his daughter (their Council with Oswin must have been a Success *and* the Player-heroes must have talked to Caty about Bree and her father).

Undertakings

If this is a Yule Fellowship Phase, each Player-hero may choose one Undertaking, plus the Company may choose an additional Free Undertaking that is allowed by the Callings of the Player-heroes. Otherwise, they may choose one Undertaking, plus a second Free Undertaking that is allowed by the Callings of the Player-heroes.

There are several Undertakings that are only available in a Yule Fellowship Phase:

- Any Player-hero who has gained a Shadow Scar may want to remove it using the 'Heal Scars' Undertaking.
- If a Player-hero has found a Famous Weapon or Armour, they may want to choose the 'Visit the Treasury of Your Folk' Undertaking to unlock additional Qualities.
- A Player-hero who wants to change one of their Distinctive Features may choose the 'Recount a Story' Undertaking.
- A Player-hero may choose the 'Raise an Heir' Undertaking, but their first Yule Fellowship Phase is probably a bit early for this.

One of the Player-heroes may choose the 'Study Magical Items' Undertaking to research the Ring of the Seven Jewels and the Beacon of Vinyalonde. They will learn more of the relevant information from the inserts on pages 35, 57 and 104 above.

The Passage of the Years

If the Loremaster is intending to use any of the campaign ideas in *Ruins of the Lost Realm*, they may provide the players with relevant information for 2966 from the 'Dark Designs' sections of *Chapter 2, A Gathering Storm*.

Any Player-heroes that returned home to Wilderland will hear that Dwarves have established a mining camp near the source of the Enchanted Stream, and that there has been friction between some prospectors and the Elves.

Where To Next?

The campaign of the Green Book is over, but further adventure awaits in Eriador and beyond. If you are intending to run the adventures in *Tales from the Lone Lands* as a campaign, then the Player-heroes now have a reason to travel to Lond Daer which can lead to the second adventure, "Messing About in Boats". It could also be a good time to introduce the Eye Awareness rules from pages page 169 to 173 of *The One Ring*, maybe after one of the Player-heroes has their first dream about the Hill of Fear.

If you are not intending to use *Tales from the Lone Lands* but are going to use *Ruins of the Lost Realm*, then Lond Daer could still be the Player-heroes' next destination, leading to "The Queen's Hall" Landmark. Either way, their journey will also probably lead to their first visit to Tharbad.

Other breadcrumbs dropped during the campaign of the Green Book may lead the company to seek “The Hill of the Sleeper” Landmark from *Ruins of the Lost Realm*. Perhaps the best clues to the location of this Landmark are hidden in Moria, in the chambers of Hanar?

Before the company leaves Bree, they may meet Beinion and Arin again, after they retire from their watch on Annuminas. They could tell the Player-heroes the rumour for “The Shrouded Islets” Landmark from *Ruins of the Lost Realm*.

There are plenty of other possibilities – another chance for the Player-heroes to show their quality!

Appendix

When I wrote this mini campaign, I was inspired by the writings of Tolkien, to create an ancient history behind my story. It is not necessary to know the details of these events to run the adventures, but I have included them here in case anyone is interested. I have borrowed characters from both *Ruins of the Lost Realm* and *Tales from the Lone Lands*. So, feel free to use any of this, or just treat me as another unreliable narrator, as you see fit.

The History of the Beacon of Vinyalonde and the Ring of the Seven Jewels

The following table is a timeline of events from the Second Age:

Year	Events
1450	Nethig forges the Ring of the Seven Jewels.
1500	Nethig assists Celebrimbor and Annatar in the forging of the Rings of Power.
1580	Baranor of Numenor travels to Ost-in-Edhil to ask the Elves to make a new lamp for a beacon in Vinyalonde. He meets Nethig and they fall in love.
1585	Nethig asks Hanar of Khazad-dum to make the Naugantdolen to carry the Ring of the Seven Jewels.
1588	Ormal the Lampmaker completes the Beacon of Vinyalonde and Baranor returns to install it in a tower. Nethig gives the Ring of the Seven Jewels to Baranor before he leaves.
1589	Annatar approaches Nethig, as described in <i>Ruins of the Lost Realm</i> . Baranor returns and asks Hanar to build a palace for Nethig in Swanfleet. Baranor begins to search for a cure for Nethig.
1590	The Seven and the Nine are complete and Sauron returns to Mordor in secret. Celebrimbor begins to forge the Three.
1600	Sauron creates the One Ring and his plans are revealed to Celebrimbor.
1650	Baranor meets an Elf called Mirwen, who agrees to help him find a cure for Nethig.
1690	Baranor and Mirwen sail to Tol Fuin on their quest for the cure.
1695	Sauron's forces invade Eriador. Baranor is caught at the defence of Tharbad while returning with the cure. He flees into the Swanfleet after the defenders are defeated but is killed by pursuing Orcs.

Glossary of Names

Annatar: Alias used by Sauron in Eregion.

Baranor: A Numenorean man and member of the Guild of Venturers.

Hanar: A Dwarf craftsman. Resident of West Moria and friend of Nethig.

Mirwen: An Elf maiden. Mentioned in the “Tindailin – An Elven Refuge” Landmark from *Ruins of the Lost Realm*.

Nethig: A High Elf maiden. A key character in “The Hill of the Sleeper”, another Landmark from *Ruins of the Lost Realm*.

Ormal: An Elven craftsman. A key character in the 1st Edition books, *The Heart of the Wild* and *The Darkening of Mirkwood*.